Please don't remember me

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/37781029.

Rating:
Mature

Archive Warning:
No Archive Warnings Apply

Category:
F/F, F/M, Multi

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationship:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Bow/Glimmer (She-Ra), Mermista/Sea Hawk (She-Ra), Entrapta/Hordak (She-Ra), Perfuma/Scorpia (She-Ra), Netossa/Spinnerella (She-Ra), He-Man | Adam/Teela, Angella/Micah (She-Ra), Kyle/Lonnie/Rogelio (She-Ra), Light Hope/Mara (She-Ra)

Character:
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Glimmer (She-Ra), Bow (She-Ra), Mermista (She-Ra), Perfuma (She-Ra), Frosta (She-Ra), Scorpia (She-Ra), Entrapta (She-Ra), Mara (She-Ra), Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra), Light Hope (She-Ra), He-Man | Adam, Teela (He-Man), Angella (She-Ra), Micah (She-Ra), Double Trouble (She-Ra), Octavia (She-Ra), Spinnerella (She-Ra), Netossa (She-Ra), Marlena (He-Man), Randor (He-Man), Swift Wind | Spirit, Finn | Adora/Catra Child (She-Ra), Hordak (She-Ra), Wrong Hordak (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
Adorable Adora (She-Ra), Adora Needs Therapy (She-Ra), Adora (She-Ra) Needs a Hug, Lesbian Adora (She-Ra), Lesbian Disaster Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra) Needs a Hug, Lesbian Catra (She-Ra), Human Catra (She-Ra), Queen Glimmer (She-Ra), POV Catra (She-Ra), Adora is in Love with Catra (She-Ra), Catra is in Love with Adora (She-Ra), Catra Needs Therapy (She-Ra), Catra Has Issues (She-Ra), Catra is Bad at Feelings (She-Ra), Bisexual Bow (She-Ra), Bisexual Glimmer (She-Ra), Oblivious Adora (She-Ra), Best Friend Squad (She-Ra), Bisexual Mermista (She-Ra), Human Scorpia (She-Ra), Scorpia is a Good Friend (She-Ra), Trans Perfuma (She-Ra), Autistic Entrapta (She-Ra), Entrapta Being Entrapta (She-Ra), Adora (She-Ra) and He-Man | Adam are Siblings, Warning: Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra), Manipulative Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra), Good Parent Angella (She-Ra), Good Parent Micah (She-Ra), Useless Lesbians, I Wrote This While Listening to Taylor Swift's Music, Amnesia, Temporary Amnesia, Car Accidents, Fluff and Angst, Friends to Lovers, POV Adora (She-Ra)

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by adoraasword

Summary

Amnesia;The loss of memories, information and experiences. Typically caused by traumatic events that damage the Hippocampus;the part of your brain that is responsible for memory.

Or, which adora is in a car crash, resulting in the loss of her memories and old friends.

Notes

Almost a year after the dreaded accident, the memory still haunts Catra even in her sleep. // Adora thinks she has a recollection before she lost her memory.

See the end of the work for more notes

Chapter 1

Sirens flashed.

The red and blue had taken over her fogged vision. Everything was clouded, there was a ringing in her right ear and she felt dizzy, unable to move. She was cold. Her knees had begun to turn red, she could feel the blood seeping through her jeans, staining the snow beneath her. Her hands shook. She felt no pain, not an ounce of ache in her fragile body although she struggled to stand up, nearly tripping over her own feet. Hands that did not belong to her, but to the paramedics that surrounded her clamped onto her arms, their blurred voices tried to get her to sit back down and allow them to assess her, but she swatted them away and tumbled towards the crowd of medics surrounding her body.

And there she was. As beautiful as ever. She was as delicate as a flower and as fragile as glass. The flower that had once described her was now wilted and the petals had fallen. Her glass-like structure now cracked like a teacup that was dropped against a hard surface. She was lying on the ground, her face as white as the snow that lay beneath her and the only warmth that covered her cold body had been of her own blood. Dark cruor had trailed out of both sides of her nose, and down the sides of her face and into the snow. Her hair was now stained with a crimson colour that matched the liquid that poured out of her nose and out of the laceration that was across her head.

The medics had shaken their heads, grave looks on their faces as they began to remove themselves from the ground. Her world was spinning, she felt sick. She felt her body fall limp as they called;

"T ime of dea-"

Catra bolted upright in her bed, a hoarse scream cutting through her throat like glass to skin as she fisted the sheets in her hands, sweat coating her body. Her clothes were stuck to her skin, her hair clung to her forehead and she felt the bile creeping up her throat, making its way up to her mouth. Catra leant over her bed, her hair balled in her hands and gaped her mouth, where a plastic white bowl lay on the ground, waiting for the drop but it never came and instead, Catra's bedroom door swung open and a woman wearing black raggedy shorts, a large gray jumper and her wild, brown hair pulled back into a ponytail came in, fast on her feet. *She* was Catra's mother.

"Catra?" Cyra quickly turned on Catra' s light, momentarily blinding the two of them as she stridden over to her daughter. Catra had tears streaming down her face, and her mouth was hung open as silent cries begged to come out. However, nothing but a weak whine was audible. Cyra sat down on the bed beside her daughter and pulled her into her chest where Catra fell limp, her head resting against her. Her hands still held a firm grip on the maroon comforter that enveloped her. "Oh, Mija.."

Cyra ran a hand down Catra' s hair, flattening the girl's mane as she gently rocked her back and forth, a soft and comforting shushing as Catra let out a choked sob. Her body rocked. "I cant- I cant-" Catra tried to speak, but she couldnt push out another word. She was unable to speak, unable to move. It was her fault. It was *all her fault*. She should have watched the road. She shouldnt have driven that night.

"Catra, look at me."C'yra placed her hands on her daughter's face and tipped her up to look at her. Catra's eyes were swollen and red, her face was stained with red marks of irritation, the act of nails clawing at the skin. Catra's lip quivered, and her body trembled.

"Mami I didn't... I didn't mean to hurt her ... I.. " Catra cried as she brought a hand up to her eyes and screwed the tears away, body shaking from fear and sweat clinging to her body despite the fan blowing in the corner of her room. C'yra looped an arm under Catra' s legs and pulled the fragile girl onto her lap with ease and wrapped her arms around her. Catra allowed her mother to cradle her. *Pathetic.* "I know . I know, baby. It's okay, *she's okay. You're okay.* " Catra's hearing was muffled and it sounded as if she was underwater. Her neck was stiff, almost as if she had slept with it at a bent and unpleasant angle.

She tilted her head to look up at C'yra, who was talking to her . She didn't know what she was saying but by the large intakes of breath, then a long exhale, she wanted Catra to *breathe*. Slowly, Catra took in a slow, struggling breath. Her chest paused as her lungs began to tighten whilst she held the air inside for a moment until she no longer could. She exhaled, then repeated. Catra's hearing had begun to clear and her breathing was stronger now instead of weak and wavering like before.

Catra bobbed her head, allowing herself to move away from C'yra as she slid off of her lap, and onto her mattress. She pulled her knees up to her chest. "What time is it?"The brunette asked, and C'yra simply shook her head. "It doesn't matter , you should try to go back

to sleep, my love.”Catra did not protest, only gave her mother yet another node and lied back down. C'yra rested a hand on Catra's back. The two stayed silent for a moment. Catra hated how weak she was. She hated that she struggled to make it through the night without waking up screaming and covered in a slick sweat.

C'yra exhaled, then bent down to place a sweet kiss on the crown of Catra’s head. Catra attempted to smile, but it barely met her lips. She had yet to notice the silent tears that slipped down her cheeks and onto the pillow below her until C'yra cupped her face, and wiped them away with the pads of her thumbs. Catra brought her hand up and swiped the remaining drops. She was tired of crying. After bidding goodnight to her mother, she tossed the covers off of her and let out a yawn that shook her body. The alarm clock on her bedside table read 5:37 AM in bright green.

There was no way she would be able to fall back asleep now that she was up, so she decided to do the one thing that seemed to pass the time. Catra slowly slid the chair out from under her desk and sat down. She would paint. Her body wouldn't allow her to fall back asleep, no matter how much Prazosin she took to tame the night terrors. So, instead, she started to paint. Her guidance counselor had agreed on the idea and Catra had always loved to paint. She loved how the weight of the pencil or the brush felt in her hand, and she loved how smooth her paint strokes were and how easy it all felt.

She felt more relaxed when she was keeping her hands busy and focusing on something other than the fear of falling asleep. Whenever she closed her eyes, all she could see was *her* dead body. The medics and police surrounded her, Catra being

questioned while someone tried to stitch up the gaping cut that shot across her jaw and assess the broken bone in her arm. It was funny. She didn't feel any pain. She felt as though she did now. Nothing. All she could see, all she was reminded of was how she hurt the one person she promised she'd never hurt. And a year later, she still couldn't close her eyes without seeing flashes of red and blue.

Catra hadn't even noticed that the sun had begun to creep up, peering through the slot in the closed curtains and shining onto her. The brunette dropped the paintbrush and stared down at her work. Against the crumbled and yellowed paper;a wilted flower stared at her. It was pink. The colour of the sky when it hits sunrise. With the flushed colour, it was alive. The flower bloomed and was vibrant. And as the red began to blend in towards the bottom, the flower began to wilt and decay. Almost as if time had caught up to it.

Her alarm blared, engaging that it was now 6:45 AM. Catra nearly hopped out of her seat in fear, not expecting the sudden noise. The girl groaned and brought her hands up to her sunken eyes. Catra couldn't recall the last time she slept. The brunette stood up from her chair, and shoved the crumbled painting among the others in the corner of her desk, before walking over to the full-length mirror that stood in front of her. Catra stared. The black sweater and red, plaid pyjama pants hung loosely on her hips and shoulders, nearly falling off of her already slim figure. Her cheeks were sunken in, and the eye bags under her eyes were staring back at her, being a constant reminder of her sleepless nights, and her clothing being the constant reminder of her ceased appetite.

Sighing, Catra hiked up her loose-fitted pants, hiding the bunched-up waist band underneath her sweater, making it look as if the cloth fit her perfectly as she left her bedroom. She could hear her mother and aunt talking in the kitchen, whispers being shared amongst them. Catra knew that it was about her. It was *always* about her. So, she slowly crept down the stairs, making sure to take the memorized path so as to not make a sound as she neared the bottom, her body pressed against the wall, and her ears alert.

"Sharon, you know how bad this year has been for her . Do you really think putting the stress of bills will help that?" her mother asked, hushed as if she was sharing a secret. But what was being said was no secret. Everyone knew it, she was a terrible mess. Cyra had a hand on her hip as her fingers danced on the counter and her bottom lip was pulled between her teeth. She shook her head. Sharon clicked her tongue and brought the red mug up to her lips as she drank from the glass. She was unamused.

"She' s nearly eighteen, Cyra. And you're lucky I'm only talking about her beginning to pay bills. She should have begun helping out when she turned the legal age to work. It has been a year. That girl is alive, is she not?" Catra bit down on her tongue at her aunt's harsh words slicked with venom. "She is. So I suggest that you talk to Catrina about moving on, and growing up."

Catra's eyes fluttered, and a frown pulled across her lips. She knew that her aunt was right, she knew that her mother knew that too because Catra knew it. It had been a year, and she was alive. And as long as Catra was out of her life, she was *okay*.

"She got into a car crash with her best friend and ' *that girl* ' lost her memory. That isn't something that you can get over in a year . She was a kid- they were both *kids* ."Cỳra cursed. Catra felt her heart quicken a few paces, and it had gotten sickeningly harder to breathe. She felt like she was going to throw up. The bile was slowly creeping up her throat. Catra clamped a hand onto her mouth and broke past the barrier between her and the two women in her kitchen as she ran into the bathroom, her knees smacking against the tile as she used her free hand to lift the porcelain lid. The contents of her stomach emptied in the form of chunks. Her throat burned as she earned more acid than anything. Cỳra ran after her , calling after her. "Catra!"

Cỳra fell to the floor beside Catra, her hand on her back as she held her daughter's hair back. Catra's body shook as she retched her empty stomach. Catra's throat and stomach burned, and she stayed arched over the toilet, her hands holding the bowl. Cỳra turned to look at Sharon, Her eyebrows pulled together as she rubbed Catra's back. Sharon simply raised an eyebrow, shrugged then turned back into the kitchen. Cỳra clicked her tongue and stood up, her footsteps echoing through the hallway and suddenly, the sound of a tap running cut through the choking that flowed out of the bathroom. Cỳra returned with a glass of water . Hesitantly, Catra pushed herself up from the floor and flushed the spit-up down. She graciously took the glass from Cỳra and placed the rim of the cup to her lips.

Cỳra was staring at her with a concerned expression and slowly grew uncomfortable as she set the glass down and pushed in front of her mother to grab her toothbrush, avoiding the observing eyes in the mirror. "Catra, when' s the last time you ate something?"

Catra grabbed the toothpaste and squeezed the crest onto the soaked bristles. "Last night." She answered as she placed her toothbrush into her mouth so that she had an excuse to not talk anymore. It wasn't a lie, she did eat supper. It wasn't as if Catra was purposely skipping her meals, more so just couldn't bear the thought of the chewed food slipping down her throat and into her stomach, only to be regurgitated at five in the morning after waking up from the same recurring thought.

Cyra sighed and placed a hand on Catra's shoulder and this time, Catra looked up for the first time and met her mother's eyes. Cyra was a couple of inches shorter than Catra, and her hair was much more curled whereas Catra's was frizzy and dead, due to her lack of care as a child and her hatred for hair brushes. Although Catra and Cyra looked similar, they did not share most of the same features as one another. Catra had been forced to sport the same nose and eye shape as her father, whom she had not heard from in over eight years. The only features she and her mother shared were their lips- both full and pouted and the shape of their eyebrows- sharp and structured. Catra quickly dipped her head back down, no longer wanting to stare at her own face as it had begun to turn into someone that wasn't her as she spits out the toothpaste.

"I know that the one year is coming up," Cyra announced, breaking the silence. Catra stiffened, and she felt her stomach churn. One year. It had already been a full year when the accident only seemed like it was yesterday. Catra rinsed her brush off and dropped it back into the plastic cup, her eyes flickering up to her mother. "Is that why your night terrors are coming bac-"

Catra turned around. "No." She cut Cyra off, suddenly growing angry. Her hands were clenched, her nails digging into the skin of

her palms and leaving crescent shapes. "I don't want to talk about it. Okay? That isn't it. I am *fine*."The brunette growled and pushed out of her mother's way and hurried up the stairs, ignoring her mother's protests and shouts for Catra, who ignored her words and slammed her bedroom door shut. She didn't want to *talk* about it. She didn't want to *think* about it. Once Catra was in her room, she allowed herself to crumble like a piece of paper.

She ran.

The air was chilled. Not cold, yet not warm either. Just *chilled*. But she could hardly tell from the way sweat clung to her crisp skin and from the adrenaline that pumped through her body, her blood hot. With aching legs, the girl slowed to a stop, her feet still moving but not going nearly as fast as she once was as she rounded the familiar corner.

Adora Gray's heart was pounding against her ribcage in such a manner, she was sure that if she kept going, it would have burst in her chest. The girl lowered herself down and rested on the side of the road as she waited for her heart rate to settle down before even thinking about continuing the walk to her house. One thing that her surgeons recommended after the accident was not to push herself. She had no idea what the hell Amnesia had to do with running, but she never asked. She was also told she couldn't play soccer anymore.

Running? She could deal with cutting back. Soccer? She wished the car accident had killed her. After months of hell, she bit down on her

tongue and got used to sitting on the benches. Her calves were burning, and her feet felt like they were going to fall off if she tried to stand as the girl rested her forehead on her knees: her hot breath forming a cloud as she exhaled. Then inhaled, then exhaled again to regulate her choppy breathing. The air nipped at her exposed skin, leaving her with her body slowly growing numb as the temperature around her dropped (or maybe, it was always cold and she just hadn't noticed from how long she was running).

Slowly, the blonde placed her hands against the concrete and pushed herself up, her body wavering underneath her weight. Adora shoved her hands into the pockets of her cherry red sweater and began down the street. She looked both ways, before crossing the street as she made her way to the large home. She was immediately greeted by the warmth hugging her body as she kicked off her sneakers, and walked down the hall to the kitchen where her mother was standing beside the counter, a whisk in her left hand and a glass bowl in the other as she whisked what Adora assumed to be eggs.

Adora began unzipping the sweater that clung to her body, shedding it off. "Did we always have big breakfasts every morning or are you trying to impress me?" The blonde joked, allowing a laugh to slip past her lips as Marlena looked up from the bowl, and her father, Randor looked up from his spot, arched over a sizzling pan of bacon. Adora sits down at the kitchen table, her hands placed on top as she twisted her own fingers. Marlena rolls her eyes playfully, and Randor lets out a husky laugh. "Why? Is it working?"

Marlena asked, half joking, but Adora could tell that she wasnt entirely. Her parents have tried so hard to get her to remember anything, even the smallest detail. And no matter what they did, no matter how many home videos and photo albums they showed her,

nothing worked. Nothing clicked in her head and it was so frustrating. All of these people told her all of these stories, expecting her to remember that she was the little girl in these stories but she couldn't, and she didn't. In all of these stories, there was a little blonde girl who had her hair in a high ponytail with mud on her hands and face, smiling wide with a space between her top teeth. A little boy stood beside her, except he had a gap in his bottom teeth and he wasn't nearly as muddy as the little girl. Adora had been told that the little boy was her twin brother, Adam.

But Adora never remembered him. You would think that the one person who could get to her would be her own twin brother. But he wasn't. He could teach her their secret language, handshakes and show her every hiding spot they found together but nothing clicked. Nothing happened and all it did was make her feel frustrated with her own mind to the point where she wanted to scream until her throat bled. Scream until she couldn't anymore, scream until she felt her lungs running out of air and till her vision burned with black spots.

She knows that this is who she is;Adora Gray , eighteen years old, daughter of Marlena and Randor Gray and twin sister of Adam Gray. But who was she? Really? She felt like a chunk of her was missing, yet everyone is telling her differently. “ *Your memory is still recovering, it's normal to feel like that* .”Her doctor had told her . And who better to trust, than the neurosurgeon who had seven years of schooling *plus* years of experience?

Her family, and her friends, it’s what they always remind her when she tries to beat herself up over the fact that she can't remember, and when she brings up how she feels like she was missing something, *someone*. She ȷust can't remember who or what and no one will help her. Maybe it was ȷust part of the process. Maybe it was

just all in her head. She knew who her family was, she knew that this was her home and that the third door on the right was her bedroom, her best friends are named Bow and Glimmer and she was a left-handed soccer player who was known as 'she-ra' on her team. *A stupid nickname.* Adora thought *Who the hell picked that?*

She knew all of this information, yet she knew nothing at all.

Adora was pulled from her thoughts by a white blur running across her eyes. She focused back in and realized that it was in fact a plate of food. Two eggs, and three strips of bacon as well as a small bowl of strawberries by her side. The food looked delicious, and she knew that her parents spent a long time on it, but her entire appetite had vanished the more she thought about her state of affairs. Adora looked up at her parents, who were now seated at the table. Randor on her right, and her mother in front of her.

The empty seat beside her belonged to Adam, who was late as usual. Her father flicked open the newspaper and sipped his coffee. Pure black, no cream or sugar. Her mother was on her iPad, her glasses propped in front of her eyes as she scrolled through her Twitter feed filled with the news and updated statuses from her favourite celebrities and politicians. Adora lifted her fork and stabbed a cut strawberry. She raised the red berry up to her eyesight and stared at it.

The longer she stared, the more her head began to ring. Her vision began to blur, and it was as if she couldnt look away . She was entranced, her head was stuck and her eyes had stopped working. Everything around the berry had blurred and flashed. When the new

light had dimmed, the ringing in her head had quieted down and instead, she heard laughter. It was her mother, and someone she recognized, but didn't know. She was sitting beside Adora, but the blonde was unable to turn her head to look at who was beside her. All she saw was the crossed legs covered by a pair of ripped, black skinny jeans and a tanned hand resting across her thighs. Her nails were painted black, and she had rings on every finger and bracelets covering her wrist. The girl's laughter was sweet sounding, and high... She sounded happy, ecstatic even. Something about the scene unfolding before her seemed so familiar, but Adora couldn't put her finger on it, *or* the girl.

The sound of the girl's laughter was music to her ears and made her heart swell in her chest. Adora never wanted to come back to reality. She felt so warm, and safe in her daydream. It felt important, and like it was begging Adora to act on it. It felt so familiar, that it was on the tip of her tongue. Everything around her began to blur, the girl's laughter getting quieter and quieter, almost as if she was fading out and a new voice was fading in.

"Adora?"

Adora blinked, and she was back in her kitchen. The familiar hum of the ceiling fan was loud, almost too loud. A hand was placed on Adora's shoulder, and the blonde flinched, her body recoiling away from the hand. With wide eyes, she looked up from the berry, and to the eyes staring at her as if she was a wild animal. Her mother had looked up from her tablet, and the crinkles by her eyes were more prominent as she studied Adora with worry. Her father has fingers on his chin, staring at her with sorrow in his eyes. And Adam, the one that the hand belonged to had pulled back. Adora slowly turned her head to look at him. His eyes were soft. He wasn't looking at her with

sorrow or worry, instead, he was looking at her with an almost *'I'm sorry'* look on his face.

Adora dropped the fork, the metal clanking against the white plate as she blinked continuously at it, before turning her attention to the spot beside her where the girl sat in her daydream. It felt all so real. She was sitting beside her, the girl was so close to her that Adora could almost smell the perfume that clung to her clothes but she didnt know what it smelled like. All she knew was that it was sweet. Like her laughter. Adora didnt know if she was experiencing a memory , or if it was another daydream. She often got them, but when she asked her parents if it happened, they frowned and shook their heads. Hours later she would hear her mother weeping in her bedroom and her father consoling her. She always got their hopes up, so what was the point in telling them if it was only going to break their hearts more?

"Dor? Y ou okay?"Adora' s eyes flickered up to Adam, who had now placed his hand on the back of her chair. The blonde swallowed the growing lump in her throat as she opened her mouth to speak, then turned to look at her parents, who were staying silent, almost asking the same questions with their eyes and still movements. Adora quickly gave them a smile and nodded her head, her eyes flickering between the three pairs of eyes surrounding her. "Y eah. Yeah no Im fine. I just"…

Adora placed her hands on the table, and stood up, her eyes shutting. "Im sorry . I need to take a shower."She informed them, shooting a finger behind her towards the stairwell. Adora turned her back and nearly smacked into her chair as she quickly scampered up the stairs, her head down and her arms pressed to her sides. It technically wasnt a lie. She did have to shower before school.

Adora's body relaxed once she got to her bedroom. She had never felt more comfortable with four white walls than the ones in her bedroom. She still didnt remember ever decorating her room. Or if *she* did.

Adora shut her bedroom door, and for the millionth time, began examining every inch of her bedroom as if she had never seen it before. Her bedroom wasnt much. She had a standard bed with a large white blanket and light purple sheets and pillowcases underneath. There was a white desk on the opposite wall, with a large shelf above it that held a small television set. Beside it was a bookcase. But instead of books, there were trophies lined up. Starting from the age of seven to seventeen. From Gymnastic tournaments to Soccer tournaments. There were medals, trophies, and even a soccer ball signed by her entire team alongside a picture of them.

Besides the few picture frames of her and her family and friends, her walls were empty. It looked as if someone had ripped pictures off of her walls from the paint chips and she wondered if she did that. And if she did, why? What had happened? Adora puffed out her cheeks as she pushed off from her door, and walked over to her dresser. She pulled it open, and grabbed whatever was in the top, before walking over to her bathroom.

Adora grabbed her phone from her pocket and pulled it out. Messages from her friends, her mother and notifications from other apps flooded her feed but she ignored them all and clicked on Spotify. She shuffled her liked songs. Seven' by T aylor Swift began playing, the music bouncing off of the walls of the small bathroom as Adora set her things down and stripped out of her clothing, before

turning on the shower and stepping in, not bothering to wait for the water to warm.

The water streamed down her body, flattening her blonde hair and pressing it to her body as the water trickled down her face. The steam began to rise, fogging up the glass door as Adora reached for her Cherry Blossom body wash and the blue loofa that hung on her soap rack. The blonde quickly washed her body and moved onto her hair. Massaging her scalp, and running her nails gently through her hair before finally rinsing the conditioner out. By the time she was done, her bathroom mirror was fogged over, and the counters were wet from the condensation.

Adora quickly dried herself off and wrapped the towel around her head, before getting dressed. What she had grabbed from her dresser turned out to be a pair of light blue, high-waisted flare jeans and a white long-sleeved top. She got changed into a new set of clothes, blow-dried her hair and put it into a high ponytail, pinning a small bump in the front. She had apparently cut her bangs with her best friend Glimmer and immediately hated the idea. *Old* Adora anyways. *New* Adora sort of liked the shorter pieces.

Once she was done getting ready, Adora grabbed her phone and shut off the music. The time was only 8:17 AM, but Glimmer and Bow were to pick her and Adam up soon. The blonde blew air into her cheeks and exited her bathroom and jumped onto her bed to scroll through Instagram for the time being.

Catra trudged down the hallway, her hands shoved deep into the green, flannel jacket that she wore draped over her body.

Her headphones were loud in her ears, Kiss with a Fist' by Florence + The Machine playing into her ears. As the song switched, Catra pulled her phone out of her pocket and checked the time. It was only 8:41, and class started in fifteen minutes. Catra shoved the cracked device back into her pocket and made a sharp right toward the row of lockers pressed against the walls.

She twisted her combination to the lock and pulled it open with a click. Her locker was filled to the brim with loose papers, her binders and books, as well as water bottles she had forgotten to take home. Over and over again. She dipped into the stuffed locker and pulled out the red binder as well as her Hamlet' book. She had English, which wasn't so bad. Her teacher, Netossa Rotullë, wasn't so bad. She wasn't as strict as some of the teachers that taught at Bright Moon, and her wife, Spinnerella was also Catra's Guidance Counselor so perhaps there was a conflict of interest. But Catra didn't care, she actually liked being in English this time around.

Walking down the halls of Bright Moon High was like walking down the street in Los Angeles. Couples making out, Friend groups gossiping, and the halls were never empty. And the lurking eyes and whispers never seemed to stop. Catra avoided looking anywhere but the ground. She could tell the surrounding bodies were staring at her, maybe even whispering. No one talked about the accident directly anymore, but there were still a few who glared at the brunette and put filthy words in her name.

Catra twisted her body, slipping through the cracks in the hall as she turned into her English class where Netossa was writing things on

the whiteboard, and Spinnerella was sitting on her desk. They were laughing and smiling but stopped once the taps of Catra's shoes interrupted them. They turned towards the door, where Catra stood. She gave them an awkward smile and a small wave as she began to dart toward the back of the class where she sat. But, she was stopped by a voice calling after her.

"Catra!" She turned around to spot Spinnerella walking towards her. The first thing about the woman that she noticed was that her purple hair was now accessorized with lighter strands of purple. Catra pulled out her earbuds and hid them in her pocket. "How are you feeling? How was your weekend?" she asked as Catra set her binder down to her desk, and her bag to the ground. She shrugged. "It was okay. Didn't do much," she said as Spinnerella nodded her head.

"And *you*?"

Catra avoided eye contact just like how she wished she could avoid the question. Catra knew why she was asking, and she wasn't going to bite. Everyone knew that the one year was coming up, even people who didn't know her.

"Yeah." Catra looked up at her and gave her a smile. "Yeah, I'm okay. Still got a beating heart." She tried to joke, but it did not succeed as Spinnerella only nodded and gave her an almost sad look. Catra felt awkward, and she knew that Spinnerella knew that she was lying. After seeing her for almost two years, the guidance counsellors start to pick up on your tells. But, Spinnerella did not push on the matter and Catra was thankful for that.

"Okay . Ill see you tomorrow at lunch?" She asked, and Catra gave her a confirming nod and smile. The purple-haired woman returned it and went to turn back to her wife, placing a kiss on her cheek before bidding her goodbye. She always saw Spinnerella on Tuesday during lunch, and sometimes she would give her an excused absence to fourth period if she felt it was necessary. Catra didnt hate talking to Spinnerella. The woman was actually extremely kind and always listened to her, and even gave her chocolate bars on her bad days. The point was, Catra wasnt so embarrassed to be seeing her and she was much more open with her. Especially after she started to open up to Catra too. Maybe it was because she trusted Catra, or maybe it was because she just wanted Catra to open up. Either way, the small gesture earned her bonus points.

Catra sat at her desk and puffed out her cheeks as she leant back in the seat, and turned her gaze to the window . Catra had her knee propped up, the bone pressing against the wood of the desk, but she didnt bother to move it. Instead, she watched the raindrops slide down the window. Catra plagued a race on the two mentally rooting for the one on her right to win, but the left took a splat to the window sill first. Catra frowned. The stupid little game had been made up by her and a long-ago friend. Together, the two of them would bet on which raindrop would win the race. It didnt matter where they were; either in the classroom or on a family road trip together. That was how they passed the time. Catra missed it. As stupid as it seemed, she missed-

"*Adora*!"

A voice shrieked, and Catra's head shot up. She hadnt even noticed that the bell had rung, nor had she noticed the class now filled with students. In the doorway, stood two girls and a boy with rain drenching their bodies. The boy, who she had recognized from her science class, was wearing a long, dark gray coat as well as a pair of denim jeans and an orange cropped shirt. The much shorter girl stood beside him, her face was pulled into a crinkle as she desperately tried to fix her short and dampened strands of pink and purple hair.

She wore an obnoxiously bright pink dress, with a purple knitted sweater with one button in the middle done up. She smacked the girl next to her, almost in annoyance and Catra's heart sputtered. And there she stood, so beautiful and smiling brightly. Catra had always loved Adora's smile. She had a dimple that protruded on the left side of her face, and she got a small wrinkle in the outer corners of her eyes. The blonde wore a pair of light flare jeans, a white undershirt and a cherry red sweater with cigarette burns in the pockets. Catra's eyes flickered and she bit down on her tongue. She recognized the sweater. And that was because it was *her* sweater. She had left it at Adora's house one night in the tenth grade, and she never got it back. The sleeves of the sweater always hung off of her hands as it was far too big for her, but it fit Adora perfectly. And she looked *beautiful* in it. Catra pulled her gaze away from the blonde girl, who was giggling with her new best friends as they walked down the aisles between the desks, and sat down in their designated spots.

Adora was only an aisle away from her, and from there Catra could smell the Vanilla Bean Sugar perfume that she used. It was always her favourite. Adora had loved it so much that whenever they were in the Lush'store at the mall, she always went to grab it. So naturally , Catra had to get it for the blonde. Another memory *gone*. *She probably thinks Glimmer bought it for her,* Catra thought bitterly. The brunette crossed her arms over her knee and turned her head away.

"Tragedy provoked madness. Madness provokes tragedy. We see this in the Shakespeare play Hamlet" and since we just finished the screenplay, this should be an easy question." Netossa started, glancing around the classroom. "So, what is the main message in Hamlet?" Netossa picked up the red-covered book and held it up to show the class. Most of the students stayed silent, not wanting to answer. Catra couldn't blame them. She didnt want to answer either.

"Okay come on guys, we just had the test and this was the big question." Netossa let out a laugh as she placed her hands on her hips and stared at the students. "Dont make me randomly pick because I know all of you know this." She pointed at them with the book, before a hand was raised, and a name was called. Catra looked up, as Netossa spoke. "Adora. Thank you for speaking up. What do you think the main message or key theme would be?"

Catra turned her head to the right and watched Adora. She was leaning forwards in her seat as she fiddled with her fingers and bounced her knee. Her blonde hair was damp, small strands pulled from her ponytail and falling to the sides of her face. Her jaw was clenching and unclenching, almost as if she was nervous. *of course, she was nervous. The idiot had never been good with public speaking.* Catra thought. "I think that one of the key themes is that indecision can lead to personal tragedy." She answered almost flawlessly as if she believed it in her bones. Netossa nodded. "Okay . Elaborate on that."

And that was where shit hit the fan. Adora slowly leant back in her seat, her mouth opens a bit as she was not expecting there to be

more to the question. The girl was freezing up, and Catra could see the fear swimming around in her eyes as she turned to her friends for help, but they too stayed silent. *Some friends.* Catra bit down on her tongue, before dropping her knee and leaning forwards.

"Hamlet's inability to take a decisive course of action ultimately resulted in many of the characters dying, including himself. If he didnt wait to kill Claudius and use the chance he had to do so, he wouldnt have gotten his mother , Ophelia and how many others killed." Catra answered, drawing the attention from Adora to the brunette. Catra's eyes flickered to Adora, who was already staring at her, Catra bit down on the inside of her cheek as she quickly let her head drop. "But in the end, if Hamlet did do so, then he would have been killed for treason. For killing a king." Netossa added on, and Catra shrugged. "At least he would have gotten vengeance for his father. And he wouldn't have killed his mother, supposed wife and many innocents." The answer was simple, and Catra watched Netossa's eyes shimmer as she smiled at her.

"Very good. Thank you, Catra. Was that the point you were making, Adora?" Netossa asked, causing Adora to reel from her thoughts and turn to Netossa. The blonde gave her a tight-lipped smile and nodded her head.

"Yeah. Spot on."

For the rest of the class, Adora had been taking glances at the girl who sat only a row away. When she answered the teacher's question, she wasnt expecting a follow-up. And she had only

answered because Bow and Glimmer had encouraged her to. After getting the nod of approval, Adora was at ease. Until she asked her to explain. Her mind had short-circuited, and she had no clue what to say next. She couldnt elaborate. She didnt think that far ahead. Her stuttering had caused her heart to begin beating faster and she felt her cheeks grow hot at all the peering eyes. Until Catra had spoken up.

Adora was taken aback, as it was one of the first times she had heard Catra talk in class. Her voice was not as raspy as Adora had thought of it to be. Instead, it was almost sweet sounding with a *slight* rasp to it. Adora found herself liking the sound and how she had a slight lisp that clung to her words. She thought that it was cute. She thought *she* was cute. But the first thing Adora had noticed about Catra was her eyes. One was blue, with hints of green in them and the other was a golden amber color. Both are strikingly beautiful and both are so uniquely different. Her hair was flat against her back and across her shoulders, small curls poking through and lying against her tan and freckled cheek. Catra's hand was resting against her face as she leant in it, her eyes fluttering shut and it was then that Adora had noticed the black painted nails and rings. Much like the one in her daydream. But the rings werent the same so maybe, it was a coincidence. A damn *close* one.

Catra felt a pair of eyes staring at her. Scowling, the brunette lifted her head and gazed around the classroom, before locking eyes with a pair of gray-blue. Adora had been staring at Catra, her eyes on Catra's hand, before noticing that the brunette had moved and was now too, staring at her. Adora's face flushed and burned a bright red as she quickly looked away, a small smile struggling to be hidden as she brought a hand up and scratched her temple, attempting to hide her face. Catra snapped her eyes away from her and rolled her eyes. She tried not to smile, and she tried not to let her eyes wander back to the blonde. She and Adora weren't friends anymore. And Adora

didnt even recognize who she was. She completely forgot about her . And that seemed to be the best damn thing to happen to her. So, Catra shoved her earbuds in her ears and blasted her music as she avoided Adora completely.

The class ended in an hour. She could wait that long and then, she didnt have to see Adora again until the last period. She had done it every day since the accident, one day with eye contact and informal communication wasnt going to throw her of f track. She had one goal in mind. Get through her classes, go to the diner, work her shifts, and then go home to wallow in self-pity. Easy, right?

Chapter 2

Chapter Summary

> Adora learns about the dark secret that is Catra Dŕiluth // Catra catches up with a ghost from the past

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Wrong.

She had never been more wrong in her entire life. The day was only half over, and Catra had been thrown through more hoops than she could handle. First, the Adora incident in English class, then she and Adora were paired up to do a small assignment. Catra had jµst finished it by herself, barely letting Adora get a word in. Which wasnt a problem considering Sparkles and Arrow boy had practically held her to their side the entire time.

Which *also* wasnt a problem for Catra. But she couldnt help but feel rejected. Adora' s friends were holding her away as if Catra was a parasite. But that was what she asked them to do, wasnt it? Thankfully, it was now lunch time and she didnt have to deal with Adora until her last-period class, which was Math. Catra had practically avoided every hall, every class the girl might have in hopes of completely clearing the way. She did not want to have another run-in with the blonde.

One small interaction between the two of them had spent Catra down a spiralling tunnel of doors she thought were once deadbolted shut. That door was Adora Gray herself. Catra often found herself doing of f with a certain blonde on her mind. She wondered how she was doing if she was able to play Soccer again. She wondered how Adam was, Marlena and Randor. Her second family. Of course, those questions could be answered if Catra decided to go down a quick walk down the quad and take the path to the giant field that was shared by the soccer and football players.

Adora would have been easy to spot on the field. She was tall, blonde and had the tendency to cheer loudly for her teammates even during practice. It was probably what helped her get voted to be Captain. Catra always loved how enthusiastic the blonde was. It didnt matter who or what she was cheering for , her presence and warm energy brought the spirits of everyone around her up. She could probably find out how Adam was doing if she responded to his texts, or even reached out in their shared classes. And as for the parents of the girl whose memory was wiped by her? They probably wanted nothing to do with her. Catra was still questioning why Adam would randomly text or snap her to strike up a conversation. She never responded unless the boy started to spam her.

"Catra!" A voice shouted. A very familiar voice. Catra seemed to freeze in her steps, her eyes wide and her heart in her ass. She bit down on her tongue, and spun around, spotting the blonde-haired girl attempting to catch up with her. Catra stops in her place, her hands holding tightly onto the straps of her bag as she looks down at the ground. *What did she want?*

I wanted to say thank you."Adora is out of breath, her voice shaky as she sucks in the air around her. It was as if Adora had answered Catra's question, although she had never actually asked it. *Just like she used to do.* "Why?"Catra asks, her head snapping up. Her tone was sharper as she stared at Adora. She didn't mean to sound rude, it had just happened. But maybe if Catra appeared like she didn't want to even be in the same room as Adora, which she *didn't*, maybe she would get the hint and leave her the hell alone. But of course, typical Adora wouldnt do that. She was too kind for her own good.

"Well,"Adora shrugged as her head bobbed almost happily . "I didnt get to thank you after class because, well, you're really fast."Adora exasperated. "Like, really fast. And you saved me back there- kind of- unintentionally- you know what I mean."She stumbled over her words and began rambling. Catra felt her heart flutter. Oh, how she missed her *stupid* rambles she did when she was nervous. It was one of Catra's favourite things about her. But at that remembrance, she turned to leave, only to be followed by the girl who had picked up her pace to keep in line with Catra.

Why was she so fast? Adora was puzzled. She couldnt help but wonder if she was on the track team. She's never seen her when she goes to run laps, but maybe she just has a different schedule.

"So- thank you-"Catra shrugged, and mumbled a quiet 'whatever'. It was one thing for them to help each other out in the classroom, but right now they were in the middle of the hall with peering eyes following their every move and whispers surrounding them. And

Catra *hated* it. She was already the center of attention for all of the wrong reasons and slowly she had started to depart from them. But Adora? She was popular. Even before the accident, she was always more popular than Catra. Being a soccer star had its perks. And even then, she never left Catra in the dirt. And Catra was thankful for that. But things had changed. They aren't the same people anymore. They were always in the light wherever they went, eyes followed. That never changed. It was just for *completely* different reasons.

Everyone loved Adora. No one loved Catra. Hell, they barely even liked her. They were probably confused as to why the pair were even together. She knew they were wondering about them. Ever since the accident, Catra had people coming up to her asking why she wasnt hanging out with Adora anymore. The truth was too painful so she ignored them. Then eventually everyone found out the truth. Adora didnt remember her . Her peers didnt know if they should have laughed in her face or pitied her for losing the one person who stuck around the longest. No one had told Adora the truth. Catra was grateful for that.

"I'm Adora." The blonde shoved an arm out in front of her , offering Catra a wide smile. The simple action caused Catra's heart to drop. Her best friend was re-introducing herself to her and Catra never thought she would have ever felt a pain worse than the crash. Until she did. It was then that everything set in for her. Adora didnt remember her. She was a completely new person to the blonde, there was no history between them. Of *course,* there wasn't, Adora's brain had reset all of her memories and Catra knew that. So why the hell did she feel like crumbling to the ground?

Catra’s eyes fluttered and she forced back the tears by biting down on the inside of her cheek as she extended a shaking hand, taking Adora’s in her own. Adora’s hands were soft, yet she could feel the building calluses from playing sports and she assumed lifting weights. Adora had always been obsessed with working out and the amount of times she had tried to convince Catra how fun working out was, she never succeeded. They were also so much bigger than Catra’s and *so* much warmer. A tingling path trailed all the way from the tips of her fingers to the bottom of her toes as she held Adora’s hand. She never wanted to let go. But as quick as the feeling ignited, it was torn away as she pulled her hand from Adora’s, and introduced herself to her best friend.

"Catra," she whispered, and something in Adora’s eyes flickered, her smile slowly faltering but she kept it up. Catra placed her hands in her pockets as the two simply stared at one another. Adora had grown taller. She used to only be two inches taller than Catra, but now Adora was nearly towering over her. She had to be at least 5'8" to Catra’s measly 5'2". It was a wonder how the hell she had shot up so fast in less than two years. Catra would have enjoyed it more if she wasn't pretending to be completely oblivious to her and Adora’s history. Catra then turned on her heel and began darting down the hall once again. And *once again*, Adora was practically hot on her trail.

"Why are you walking so fast?" Adora asked. Catra could hear the soles of Adora's sneakers scraping against the floor as she easily kept her pace. *Stupid* soccer players. *Stupid* Adora.

"Why are you following me?" Catra retaliated, quickly turning her head to look behind her shoulder at Adora, watching her face twist before looking back ahead. "Because I- I-" Adora stuttered. T o be honest, she didn't know what to say. She didn't know *why* she was following Catra and so she stopped. It didn't take a moment, only a second for Catra to notice that the blonde was no longer following, due to the overbearing (but *heavenly*) sugar perfume that wafted over her entire body. Catra turned around, spotting Adora standing a few feet away. A frown etched on her face.

"What?" Catra asked. Adora simply shrugged as she held the binder closer to her chest, almost as if it were a shield to protect her. "Nothing, I just don't have any reason to follow you."

Oh. Why did Catra's stomach slowly sink at Adora's words? As if she was disappointed that Adora had realized that there was no point in following behind like a lost cat. *No*. She couldn't be disappointed because what good reason would there be to justify that? There was none. That was what she *wanted*, wasn't it? Catra's eyes flickered from Adora to the ground as she nodded her head. "Alright.." Adora's eyes slightly widened, and there was a hint of a glint in them as if she was hoping Catra would give her a reason to stay. But she didnt. The glow disappeared with Catra's next words. "I'm going then. *alone* ."

"Oh- uh oh-okay ." Adora hesitated as she gave Catra a soft (and awkward) smile, waving bye at the girl. Catra didn't bother to smile back as she turned away, and stalked down the hall. When she had turned down the next hall, a small smile formed. She couldn't help it

and it didn't matter how hard she fought it. Talking with Adora was like coming back up for fresh air from the murky waters that drowned her. She missed it. She missed *her*.

Adora's smile fell as she hugged her binder tighter to her chest, her cheeks puffed out. She didn't understand why she was a bit disappointed when Catra told her that she was going alone, it wasn't as if they were friends. Hell, Adora didnt even know her . But something inside her clicked when Catra told her her name. Adora felt as if she remembered her somehow. But that was a stupid thought. They had gone to school together practically for their entire lives. *Yeah. That's it.*

"Hey!"Startled, Adora jumped at the voice as a hand clamped down onto her shoulder. She spun around, only to see Bow and Glimmer looking at her with concerned looks. Adora quickly smiled at them as Bow returned it. "Hey , Dor-"

"W e saw you talking to Catra."Glimmer immediately said, cutting Bow off as her eyes followed the path Catra took. Adora shrugged her shoulders, and let a small smile play across her lips. "*Okaay*?" She dragged out the first word, unsure of why Glimmer sounded so… *upset* with her. "I was just thanking her for helping me out in class."The blonde explained as she turned her head, almost wishing that Catra would pop back up into her line of sight so that she could talk to her again. She heard Glimmer sigh and have her hand slip off Adora's shoulder. She turned back to her friends, her ponytail swinging as she frowned at their pulled faces.

‘What?” She asked. Glimmer opened her mouth to speak, but shut it and turned to look back at Bow, who did the same thing. Adora’s eyebrows furrowed as she stared down at her two friends, completely confused. ‘Why are you two acting like that?”

She asked, growing a bit frustrated with her friend's sudden quietness. Bow exhaled through his nose, before opening his mouth to speak, his words coming out hesitantly. ‘Look, Adora Catra just… Isn’t someone you should be talking to.” He said, glancing back down at Glimmer who nodded her head in agreement. Adora pulled back, and opened her mouth to speak, but shut it again. ‘And why shouldn't I talk to her?”

That question clearly, was not one Bow and Glimmer had prepared for as they stood in the middle of the hall, stuttering messes. Suddenly, the bell rang and Adora swore she saw them exhale in relief. The three of them began walking away, and Bow put a comforting hand on her shoulder. Adora looked at him. ‘W ell tell you at lunch, okay?” He says, and Adora nods. She cant help but feel like whatever her friends were going to say, wasnt going to be good.

Adora was eagerly waiting for lunch to roll around.

Not because she was shamelessly starving and threatening to bite down on her wooden pencil, but because she wanted to know what the hell her friends had to say about Catra Dṛiluth. They had made it to be such a big thing, that made Adora grow anxious jµst thinking about what it could be. Finally, the bell had rung and Adora nearly jµmped out of her seat, her bag strapped to her back and her binder pressed to her chest as she ran out of the classroom to meet up with Bow and Glimmer who were standing in front of Glimmer's locker, whispering harshly about something. They were obviously having a disagreement, but immediately stopped and began smiling as Adora neared.

"Hey Dor!" Glimmer greeted, her voice shrill as she gave the blonde a large smile, and slammed her locker shut. Adora flinched at the loud sound. She didn't bother to say hi' back. "What were you two whispering about jµst now?"

She asked, and her two friends suspiciously looked at one another as Bow blew a raspberry and waved his hand in front of his voice. "Oh nothing, jµst a small disagreement on our English report." He lied. Adora clenched her jaw but stayed silent. If Bow were to lie, it would have to be scripted and rehearsed or else he would fumble the entire thing. That was how Adora could tell that he was lying. She had gotten good at reading people and Bow? He was an open book if he was caught off guard.

"So, are you guys going to tell me why I can't talk to Catra?" Adora asks as she pushes open the double doors leading to the already crowded and rowdy cafeteria room. Glimmer tutted her finger. "Nope! Not until we get out food because I," She paused as she grabbed a plastic tray and handed it to Adora who graciously took it as she grabbed her own. "Am *starving*." Glimmer exasperates as the three of them stand in line to get their lunch. Adora scrunched her face up at the short pink-haired girl, practically glaring down at the back of her head. Bow was already holding a small, brown paper bag of his pre-packed lunch but he stood idly by.

"Adora, just." Glimmer starts as she turns and stares up at the blonde, before pausing. "Let's just get out food, find our table and then we can talk. Because it's a lot. Okay?" Adora pulls her bottom teeth between her lips, before nodding, not bothering to push further. And besides, she *was* starving. The cafeteria was handing out small bowls of either vegetables or fruit, as well as the choice between cheese pizza or french fries. Adora grabs herself one of everything, as well as white milk as she thanks the lunch ladies, before following behind Glimmer and Bow as they darted through the crowd to find their table. Every lunch, they sat with the same group of people. All were part of some school team or extracurricular. The most popular being Soccer.

The first girl they befriended was a girl named Perfuma. She was 100% a stoner but she was nice and an amazing midfielder despite her extremely delicate and cheerful personality. Next was Mermista. She was also a midfielder as well on the swim team. Adora wondered how the hell she managed not to fall down on the field after coming back from swim practice and she sort of envied her for it. Adora was athletic, but Mermista was almost built with leg muscle. Bow was their forward, and also second striker. Frosta was a junior

that they had somehow adopted into their group. She was Glimmer's younger cousin and practically looked up to the pink-haired girl. When Glimmer had dyed her hair pink, Forsta immediately begged her to dye hers blue.

When Glimmer joined the team as a defender , so did Frosta. Glimmer claimed to hate it, but they all knew she secretly loved it. Sea Hawk (His real name was Sebastion, but forbade his friends from using it) was surprisingly the only one at their table who wasn't on the Soccer team. Instead, he found himself more drawn to the side of Football. He only really sat with them because he and Mermista had a *thing* going on. And then there was Adora. Somehow, she was the team captain and the first striker. Their coach, Huntara and second in command Netossa practically refused to give up Adora's spot. While she was on bed rest, Bow acted like the Vice-captain and Mermista was subbed in as the second Striker. The blonde felt guilty having to make her entire team rearrange their positions, but they all made sure that Adora knew that they didnt care about the team being rearranged.

Sure, a couple of other players also made it known that they *did* mind, but Adora had ignored them. Soon enough, she would be cleared to play soccer and her team would be back to how it was. She hoped. Sitting down on the benches and watching her team play just wasnt enough for her . She *needed* to be out on the field.

"Hi, Adora!" Perfuma greeted with a wide smile and a large wave. The trio sat down, Adora sitting beside Frosta with Glimmer on her opposite side. Adora returned the greeting with a smile. "Hey , Fuma." Almost immediately, her team began engaging with one another and

picking at their food. Sea Hawk was aimlessly flirting with Mermista, his arm around her shoulders as the tanned girl was slumped in her seat with an annoyed look on her face, accompanied by a blush. Frosta and Glimmer were bickering about *whatever* family bickered about, most likely the way their hair was styled as both girls had white headbands strapped in their hair. Adora puffed out her cheeks as she picked up a grape, and tossed it into her mouth, allowing her eyes to wander around the cafeteria, before landing on a certain brunette.

Catra stood in line, a blue tray in hand as she held it against her hip, her phone in hand as she scrolled through what Adora assumed to be Instagram. Catra's hair had fallen in front of her face, blocking Adora from seeing the glint of amber that shadowed her eyes. Adora rested her head in her hand as she imagined how it would feel to push the brunette's hair behind her ear, her fingers stroking against her freckled cheek. The people around her slowly grew silent, their eyes following where Adora's starstruck gaze had landed, concerned looks on their faces as they saw who she was blushing at. Glimmer cleared her throat, although Adora hadn't heard it.

"Adora!" Glimmer finally snapped, drawing Adora's attention away from Catra, who was now grabbing her food. Adora's face grew a bright red as she snapped her daze away from Catra and to the short, and annoyed pink-haired girl. Adora gave them an almost weak smile, not daring to meet her friends' eyes as she looked down.

"Uh. Why are you like, staring at Catra like that?" Mermista asked, and Adora saw Sea Hawk lean down to whisper something in Bow's ear, but the Boy quickly shook his head. Glimmer frowned. Adora's head shot up as she furrowed her eyebrows, completely forgetting about the dark secret that was Catra Driluth. "I wasn't. I wasn't staring." Adora lied, her face growing red with each passing moment. Glimmer sighed as she looked to her friends for help, but no one met her gaze.

"Are you going to tell me whatever it is that you have on Catra now that you have your food?" Adora asked. Glimmer popped a grape in her mouth and chomped down on it and Adora swore she saw the colour wash from her face. The blonde's eyes flickered up to meet someone else's, except she didn't. They were all staring down at their food, almost completely avoiding the topic altogether. Adora's eyebrows knit together. Glimmer finally inhaled deeply, before turning her body to look directly at Adora as she placed her hand gently across Adora's that was resting on the table. Adora's eyes flickered to her hand, then up to Glimmer.

b/ oh.

"Adora look. Catra." Glimmer hesitated. "Last year , Catra got into a car crash. With her best friend." Glimmer explained, her voice dropping. "Her best friend. didn't make it." Glimmer finished and Adora felt her heart drop. She looked down and slid her hand away from Glimmers as she allowed it to drop to her own lap. The blonde stayed silent for a moment, processing what had happened, before raising her head as she looked around the cafeteria. Maybe that was

why Catra was so weird around her. Maybe she reminded her of her best friend who died. Adora had gotten into a car crash, but she made it. She still had a beating heart. Maybe that's why Catra was so cold to her. Adora looked back towards the food line, spotting a head of brown hair. But she frowned when the girl turned around and it was in fact, *not* Catra.

"That's...W ow." Adora swallowed the lump in her throat, her friends now looking up at her. "That's not a reason to tell me not to talk to her, Glimm. She lost someone close to her. That doesn't make her a bad person!" Adora defended, and Glimmer sucked in a breath as she clenched her jaw. "Adora, that wasn't the part I was worried about." Glimmer said through gritted teeth and Adora looked at her, confused once again. She didn't understand *why* that was any reason for her not to talk to Catra. She got into an accident, experienced something traumatic and now *she* was the bad guy? *Accidents happen.*

Hell, look at Adora. She was in an accident that caused her to have a break of Amnesia and she was in a coma for a short while. But she didn't blame her mother for her accident. Because accidents *happen*. Her mother didn't *mean* to get into that crash, and she was sure that Catra didn't either. Adora didn't know why she felt the strong urge to defend Catra, or why she felt herself growing annoyed with Glimmer for only telling her what she asked.

"Catra was drunk." *Oh.* There it was.

Glimmer said. “She and her friend were coming back from a party , and they had both been drunk. Catra wasn't looking where she was going, and she killed her best friend.” Glimmer ’s voice was now angry as if she held a personal grudge against the teen. It only made Adora feel more for the girl. “Glimm... Who was she?” Adora asked, eager to learn more. Glimmer stared at her, her eyebrows pulled together. “What?”

“Who was the girl?” Adora asked again when Glimmer had failed to answer the first time. She went pale, and was now fiddling with her fingers as she opened her mouth to speak, but immediately shut it again. “She and Catra went to Horde High. Y ou never met her.” Glimmer shut her eyes, and turned away, telling Adora that she didn't want to talk about it anymore. Adora could sense her friends growing uncomfortable with the situation, so she decided to stop asking about it for that day. She wouldn't budge on the story but still, she had so many questions. She decided she would ask Adam after school since she knows that he shares a few classes with Catra. Surely *he* had to know who she was.

Catra stalked down the hall, a plastic tray placed across her hands as she made her way to the science lab. Lunch, believe it or not, was not Catra’s favourite time of the day. Sure, she got away from her teachers and peers and had an entire hour to be by herself, but it still wasn't her favourite. Mainly because of a certain girl who somehow was *always everywhere*.

Loud machinery, the buzzing of saws and torches being lit with the familiar sound of metal clanking filled the near-empty hall. "*Come on, Emily!*" The loud shrill of a girl's voice echoed as Catra grabbed hold of the metal handle, placed the tray across her left arm, and twisted the rather large and heavy door open. Catra raised an eyebrow as she walked in, and spotted a frizzy, purple-haired girl handling a large pair of clampers in one hand, and a torch in the other. The large gloves made it hard to tell where her hands *actually* were.

"Entrapta?" Catra called. The girl, Entrapta, spun around. She was wearing large, brown overalls with oil stains all over them as well as a pair of thick goggles that covered her entire face. She looked like a mad scientist which *wasn't* a very far stretch for Entrapta Dryl. "Catra!" Entrapta turned off the torch and set both tools down as she lifted her goggles, to reveal her grease-stained face. "HI!" the girl shouted, making Catra flinch at the sudden loudness before she replaced it with a smile as she walked over to the girl, who was wiping her hands off with a napkin.

"Whatcha doin?" The brunette asked as she tipped on her tiptoes to peer over Entrapta's shoulder, staring down at the table covered in hard equipment, oil spills and random chunks of metal and wiring *way* too close to a bottle of water than Catra was comfortable with. She slowly reached over and moved the open plastic away from the frayed wiring.

"I'm working on a scientific experiment!" Entrapta flailed her arms and jumped in excitement. "OH! How rude of me!" Entrapta shouts, and Catra winces. Entrapta was... *loud* . She didn't have a range so she could either be too quiet, or too loud. She quickly gets out of the way, allowing Catra to see the creation on the metal table. The brunette drops down to her flat feet and kicks her head to the side. On the table, was a circular bot, with purple markings decorating the washed-out green metal. The bot only had two legs, but the other two were lying down beside it with wired red and blue poking out. The metal scraps looked more like something you would find inside of a garbage truck after being crushed and compressed.

"Meet, Emily!" Entrapta passionately waves her arms toward the bot. Catra tips her head to the side, her eyes meeting Entrapta's.

"I thought you already had a program named Emily?"

"Well, yes"

"So why did you name this one Emily too?" Catra asks curiously as she points a finger toward the hunk of metal sprawled out. Entrapta shrugs. "I like the name Emily!" she answers and Catra decides not to ponder more. She had learned not to when Entrapta went into detail on when the first ever machine was built and how it was built.

"Oh! And also I'm connecting the *program* Emily from my tablet to *robot* Emily so technically it's just *one* Emily!" Entrapta explained, her tone flat and rather dull as if she expected Catra to understand what she was saying. She didn't look up from the thick tablet in her hands and her fingers moved fast as she tapped at random things. Catra nodded, although she had *no idea* what Entrapta was saying and set down the tray of food on a clear spot on the table. She had to move some tools, but it was better than being placed on an oil pile.

"Well, I brought you lunch, figured you'd be doing *something* insan-"

"Yup! Thanks, Catra!" Entrapta looks up from her tablet and takes the apple slice off of the tray and bites into it almost immediately. "You're the best!" Catra only smiled at her friend and bid her goodbyes to allow the girl to continue her work. She heard the purple-haired girl shout in excitement about her tiny food. Entrapta only ate small foods and Catra knew the girl wouldn't eat if her pizza wasn't cut into bite-sized pieces. Look, Entrapta was her *friend*. And she only had two of them. Entrapta and Scorpia. So the least she could do was make sure they didn't *die* on her. And plus, she knew that Entrapta most likely wouldn't have gotten lunch and she would have stayed till the school shut at 7 pm only to then go home and continue *more* research. When Entrapta was working on something new, she didn't put it down until it was finished.

Catra shut the door behind her, and found herself wandering the halls. Maybe she would find Scorpia? No, she was at home sick. Catra frowned. She missed Scorpia. Don't get her wrong, Entrapta was great!But there's only so much you can talk about with her before she goes back to either talking about machines or building them. Catra soon ended up aimlessly wandering the halls, not sure where to go for most of her remaining lunch hour. At one point, she had decided to hide in the bathroom stalls with her feet pulled up as she played 'Geometry Dash' on her phone. But it wasnt long until she bolted out when a group of (she assumed) cheerleaders walked in. Their perfume was enough to cause Catra's head to spin and the entire room smelt as if the tacky aroma had begun chemically infusing to the walls, lingering. And now, there she was, aimlessly wandering the halls of Bright Moon with her cheeks puffed and her arms swinging.

She could go back to the lab with Entrapta, but the smell of burning wires made her nose crinkle. She certainly couldn't go back to the cafeteria. She would rather walk around BMH than go back to the crowded and rowdy space. Plus, cafeteria ≠Adora. And Catra did *not* want to run into her. *Again*. So, she decided to sit in the stairwell by the Northern corner. Not many people used the stairs because they only led up to the band room as well as some dainty storage rooms. To get back to civilization, you had to take another hallway and push through one last set of doors. It was more of a hassle to use those stairs than to go the long way. Catra's hands were in her pockets as she fiddled with a piece of lint, an earbud dangling from her ear and Paramore' playing in her right eardrum.

It was odd how silent that part of the building always was. Even during break, the northern part of the school always seemed to be nearly silent. Catra placed her hands on the push handle, and

pushed the heavy door with her body weight, not noticing the head of blonde hair staring up at her. "W ell well well. Look what the cat dragged in."

Catra's head shot up, her eyes slightly widened and her lips parted as she stared at Adam, a playful smirk across his lips. The boy was sitting on the steps, a glossy, white oak guitar sitting in his lap and a black notebook resting on his knee. Catra mustered up the best smile that she could. "Adam, hey ."The brunette avoided any and all eye contact as she stared up at the ceiling. It looked rather interesting at that very moment, was that gum on the ceiling? Oh *god,* Catra wanted to run.

Adam stood up, resting his guitar back in the black bag that rested on the ground, and set his notebook aside. The sudden movement caused Catra to look away from the ceiling, and finally at him. Adam looked.well he looked exactly the same as he did a year ago. He was still taller than her, as he always had been and his hair is still shaggy and sweeping across his eyebrows. Around his neck, dangled a three-piece Lego set necklace. The sight of the necklace was almost a punch in the gut as she hadnt seen it in so long.

She felt winded, her words were stuck and plastered to the back of her throat as she stared at the piece of plastic. She had hers trapped in a small box under her bed along with all of her other possessions that gave away her past relations. Aka her friendship with Adora. She had every picture, every drawing, every exchanged note hidden away in a small wooden box. The only thing that she still had on her was a small, braided black bracelet that Adora had given her on her

fifteenth birthday. Adora had read her a stupid speech about how much she meant to her and then gave her the bracelet in a small, velvet baggie. From the looks of it, it was rather expensive and Catra hated that she had spent that money on her. But she cherished it *and* her. She never took it off. Not once had she had the courage to shove it in the box with everything else.

Catra licked her lips and breathed out. She opened her mouth to speak but was cut off by a pair of arms wrapping themselves around her small frame. Adam's face was buried in her hair, and his hands were placed on the top of her back. The action caught her off guard, and she even gasped a bit due to the surprise. She didn't expect Adam to hug her, hell she expected him to call her out and run away. But then again, this was Adam she was talking about. Slowly, Catra allowed her body to relax from its stiffened state, as she too wrapped her arms around the boy's torso. "I missed you, Driluth." Catra choked on her words, and she swore she felt her eyes start to glaze over, but she pushed them away as she let out a desperate chuckle.

They pulled away. "I missed you too, Grayskull." And it was true. The old twist on their last name flowed off of her tongue with ease as if it was meant to be and Catra hadn't realized just how bad she missed her ex-best friend's twin brother until he had his arms wrapped around her and held her close. Hesitantly, she wrapped her arms around him and returned the hug, her nose burying into his chest. She missed all of them. She missed Adam and her 'gossip' sessions, she missed helping Marlena cook because Adora couldn't for the *life* of her. She missed Randor helping in her Math classes and teaching her how to properly throw a ball because he was the closest thing she had to a dad.

Adam pulled away, and Catra let her arms fall to her side, suddenly missing the contact as she to the ground. Adam sat back down on his spot on the staircase and grabbed his guitar as he began plucking at the strings. Catra just stood and stared, her body fidgeting in her spot as she kicked around the idea of leaving and ignoring Adam again or staying and talking. Both options were great to her, but for some reason, she chewed down on her bottom lip and couldn't decide which course of action to take.

Adam looked back up at her and noticed her tensed stature. "Sit down, dumbass." He teased as he rolled his eyes and looked back down at his guitar. Catra couldn't help but smile, and her mind had been made up. Catra sat down beside him, her knees pulled up to her chest and her arms resting across them. She and Adam used to be best friends. They were almost as close as she and Adora were. *Almost*. It all started in the fifth grade when Adam had randomly texted Catra about his 'extreme crisis that he can't tell Adora'. Said crisis being his crush on his twin sister's (*other*) best friend, Glimmer. From that day on, Catra had suddenly become his Wingwoman' and then in the seventh grade, Catra told him that she liked girls. Even *before* she told Adora.

There was something that held Cara back from telling Adora first and perhaps that was because of the big fat crush that Catra had on her and the fear that Adora would ditch her because of it. But of course, she was proved wrong when the dumb, blonde lovable dick suffocated her in cuddles and then proceeded to ask her a million questions and finally put together why Pirates of the Caribbean' was her favourite movie. And it wasn't just because Catra loved the action. Kiera Knightley was *also* hot. But after confiding in Adam first,

he became her Wingman', always pointing out girls who were staring at her and giving her flirting advice. She quickly learned to *never* trust Adam when it comes to flirting.

"Oh fuck you, Grayskull."Catra pushed out an arm and smacked Adam in the shoulder, only making the boy retaliate as they laughed their asses off. They almost immediately fell back into place, almost as if nothing had happened. They talked, they caught up, Adam told her about this girl who he liked but refused to tell her the name of said girl. All she knew was that it *wasn't* Glimmer this time and that she had Adam *begging on his damn knees.* And then, Adam began to show Catra some notes that he was working on. It was a song, and Catra immediately recognized the tune to be the one they all made up as kids. Except this time, they weren't humming it and singing god awfully with their cracking voices and lisps. The soft tune brought a wash of comfort, and nostalgia to Catra as she listened closely. Adam had a way with the guitar and she would happily admit that she took 100% of the credit for it since *she* was the one who taught *him*. Except now, he had outranked her.

"Okay no"Catra starts as Adam stops strumming, his eyes flickering up to hers. "That' s not fair. How are you better than me? *I taught you!* "She cried and Adam laughed. Catra only glared as he gave her a cocky smile. "I'm just a natural, Driluth."That earned him a punch to the shoulder. The two of them began quietly laughing to themselves as they began packing up their things due to the bell ringing soon. The two of them wandered the hallway, their pace slow and in sync, as they stayed silent. It was a comfortable silence. And Catra didnt mind it. Until Adam spoke up and Catra felt the hairs rise on the back of her neck.

"You should talk to her."Catra knew exactly who Adam was talking about, and she bit down on her tongue and fought back to urge to lash out at him. "She misses you, you know ."As if Adam couldn't have ruined the moment anymore, Catra was proved wrong. *So, so wrong*. She could feel Adam's eyes on her, but she stayed staring straight forwards, her tongue sharp as she spoke;"How the hell can she miss someone she doesn't remember?"Adam laughed, and that caused Catra to whip her head to look at him. She was shooting daggers at the boy as he stopped, placed his hands on her shoulders and forced her to stop in her spot, spinning her around to look at him. But she held her gaze to the ground.

"I didn't know your sister's Amnesia was funny to you, Adam."Catra bitterly said as Adam's laughter came to a slow stop. "It isn't funny , you're right. What's funny is that she *does* miss you. She may not remember you, but she talks to you all of the damn time."Catra furrowed her eyebrows at this newfound information. "There is not a day that goes by where she *doesn't* talk about the 'mystery person' that she can't seem to remember, but is always on her mind. She's always trying to remember by asking us questions."Catra felt her eyes begin to water, and a stray tear slipped from her eye as she bit down on her bottom lip to stop anything from coming out. Adam brought a hand to her face and swiped her tears away.

"Cat, we miss you."Adams' voice was soft and without a hint of teasing or malice. He was being serious. Genuine. Catra didn't know which one would have hurt more. "She's always asking and it breaks us to have to tell her that there's no one that she's missing. But she

is. Mom and Dad miss you, they ask about you all of the time because they know that we share classes and I always text you. Hell, even Swifty and Cringer miss you."Catra felt a bubbled laugh exit as she wiped her tears, a small smile forming. Swift Wind was Adora's Harlequin Great Dane. He was a huge, white dog with gray patches and he had no mean bone in him despite towering over Catra when he stood up on his hind legs. Catra didn't even *like* dogs but Swift Wind was the exception. Except when he put his entire body weight on top of her and fell asleep. And Cringer was Adam's Toyger cat. A mix of orange and brown with black stripes, much like a Tiger who loved to sleep on top of the refrigerator and watch everything from above.

"She reintroduced herself to me today ..."Catra whispered, scared that if she was any louder her voice would crack and waver. Adam stayed silent, not saying anything at all until he pulled her back into a tight hug, his hand stroking the back of her head as she wrapped her arms around his torso, and allowed herself to break down. Adam knew it would come eventually, and so did Catra. But that didn't stop her from feeling like she had lost the last string that connected her to the Adora she knew, and the new Adora that was a stranger to her. Catra sobbed, her cries muffled by her own teeth biting down on her lip and by being pressed up against Adam as he consoled her. "That' s a good thing, Cat."He told her , and Catra pulled away as she sniffled, and wiped her now red eyes.

She hugged her own body as Adam let go of her. "That means she wants to be your friend. That means that maybe when you're ready, you can tell her the truth."Catra felt sick just thinking about it. She shook her head. "No. No, I c-can't. What if she hates me? What if I just lose her again? I would rather her not know me and not hate me than know me and hate me. I don't know what I would do if she-"

Catra was rambling, and so she snapped her mouth shut. "Catra, are you dumb? Adora could never hate you. *Ever* . You're her *best friend*. And no one blames you. At all. It was an accident, but you guys are okay."Adam explained. "How the hell can you say no one blames me when I caused your sister to have Amnesia? She forgot who you were!Forgot who everyone was!Because of me."Catra was biting down on the inside of her cheek. It was her fault and she knew it. "Because I looked back too late..."Her voice cracked. More tears streamed, and she took a step back and forced Adam's hands away. She felt her nails dig into the palms of her hands, but she didn't stop.

"Because it was an *accident*, Cat. Because you were in the hospital for a *brain bleed* and a broken arm."Adam said and Catra squeezed her eyes shut. It was true. She had also been in the hospital, but her injuries weren't as extensive as Adora's. She wasn't in a coma for five months, she didn't forget everything about herself. Sure, Adora didn't have to relearn how to talk and walk, but she *could* have. She forgot about who she was, and who the people in her life were and it was Catra's fault. Because she wasn't looking at the road. If she had looked a second before, they would have been able to avoid the truck. But she *didn't* and it cost her almost *everything*.

"If you don't want to talk to Adora, at least try to reach out to my parents, okay?"Adam placed a hand on her shoulder , and Catra looked up at him. "They miss you a lot and it might be easier for you. But if you aren't comfortable with it and *truly* don't want to, then I can't force you to do anything. Okay?"Catra nodded her head and pulled Adam back in for a hug which he happily returned. The hug

lasted for longer than the two of them had realized, and only pulled away and the bell had rung and the sound of students filling the corridors reached their ears. Catra brought a hand up to her eyes and wiped them, before pulling out her phone and checking if her makeup had been ruined. Adam assured her that it wasn't, but of course, he had lied. Her mascara was smudged and bits of eyeliner had touched her eyelid. Catra rolled her eyes as she wiped the excess product away.

"I take it back. I don't miss you." Catra says as she tucks her phone away, and Adam sticks his tongue out as he shoves his hands in his pockets and began walking backwards. "I missed you too, Dhiluth!" Catra only shoved a middle finger into the air as the both of them smiled. Catra turned around and shoved her earbuds in her ears with a small smile playing on her lips. Something in her felt warmer and she felt.safer .

Almost as if things would be okay. And maybe they would be. Maybe Adam was right and maybe it was time to come out of her shell and reconnect with Adora. And maybe she wasn't ready to connect with her again, maybe it was still too much right now but she could try to talk to Marlena and Randor. They always came into the diner and Cyra and Marlena were still friends. So maybe, just maybe things would turn around.

Chapter End Notes

Catra: *breathes*
Adora: gaygaygaygaygaygay

Chapter 3

Chapter Summary

Adora &Catra meet up again

Chapter Notes

surprise chapter?
It's currently 11:05 so yall are getting a new chapter 7 hours early😩

See the end of the chapter for more notes

When Adora got home, she dug through her pockets and fished out her house keys before unlocking the house door and quickly ducking inside.

She wasted no time in running up to her room, the straps of her bag slipping down her shoulders. Once she got to her room, she tossed the white backpack onto the chair propped in front of her desk and fell down onto the mattress, allowing her body to be hugged by the soft foam underneath her. It would have been easy to fall asleep. Her days after school consisted of doing absolutely *nothing* . Her parents would both be at work and Adam usually stayed after school for guitar practice and she- well, she would have been in Soccer right now. At the thought of the sport, she felt her eyes drift toward the shelf with her trophies. A frown pulled onto her face.

She missed it. Suddenly, an idea came to mind. Just because she couldn't *compete* competitively didn't mean that she wasn't allowed to *play* at all. With a bounce, Adora stood up and walked over to her

dresser, pulling out a pair of gray joggers and a loose-fitting white top. She stripped out of the clothes that covered her body, and slipped on the soft fabric in replacement, tossing the clothes into the laundry bin that was beginning to spill with her shredded clothing.

She reminded herself to do laundry before she went to bed as she headed downstairs, her ponytail swaying side to side as she peered out the glass door into the backyard where the spotted Harlequin Dane lie across the grass, a red squeaky toy in his mouth as he chewed on the rubber. Her father must have let him out before he returned to work.

Adora smiled at the sight, before swinging the door open. "Swift Wind!" She called, earning the dog's attention from the toy in his mouth. Once his eyes landed on Adora, the dog jumped to his feet and ran towards her, the toy now long forgotten. The blonde let out a laugh as Swift Wind jumped up onto his hind legs and planted his paws on her forearms;his tongue hanging out and his tail whipping back and forth in excitement as he began kissing the girl. Adora petted the boy's head, her hands roughly rubbing against him as he jumped down. Adora bent down with him, the large dog falling to his side. Adora laughed at the pet's eagerness. "Hi, Swifty ."

After a well-deserved cuddle on the floor with Swift Wind's head lying across her lap, Adora stood up and dusted the fallen hairs off of her pants, and wiped away the slobber left behind from Swift Wind's kisses. Following his owner, Swift Wind's tail whipped back and forth in the air as he watched Adora walk towards the nook beside the front door. The girl grabbed the large cyan leash from off of a hook.

The thick material was needed to hold the rather strong dog back as he got overly excited over *anything* he sees when outside. Adora was able to decorate it when she first got him, and of course, she had decided to sew a white unicorn with rainbow wings.

As soon as the dog saw the collar, he jumped up on his back legs and spun in a circle, before jumping onto Adora, his paws landing on her thigh as her leg was propped up on top of the bench. "Okay calm down Swifty."Adora laughed as she flicked open the hook, and clipped it around the two rings attached to the black collar. She wrapped the leash around her wrist and pulled out her phone whilst slipping on a pair of running shoes. Before leaving, she sent her mother a text and connected her earbuds as she scrolled through Spotify to find the playlist titled Running!:)'. With everything set in place, Adora swung open the front door, and off she went with the overly excited Dane by her side.

The school was only a ten-minute walk, which meant it would take her about half of that time if she was jogging. She thought about how seeing her old teammates enjoying the sport she was desperately in love with absolutely crushed her soul, but the thought only came when she was nearing the school's Soccer field. Running across the grass with shouts of encouragement and whistles blowing left and right, she watched her team kick the ball directly into the net of the 'opposing' team. Which was really just half of them wearing red mesh jerseys as opposed to their regular light blue. " *Glimmer*! Watch your three o'clock, that's how they get past you!"Couch Huntara shouted, her pen clicking against the wooden chart as Adora watched Glimmer throw her head back and groan loudly.

"Perfuma, Bow , Frosta! You three watch your backs. If Mermista can see an opening in front and take it, so can the Horde! You guys got this!" Netossa shouted as the three of them gave her a thumbs-up and returned to their guarded positions. Adora slowed her jog to a walking pace, making her way around the court as the blow of the bell sounded, and the scattered team began their practice once again. This time, taking their coach's words of advice and managed to steal the ball from the red team and earn a point. Adora clapped loudly and let out a whoop of excitement, earning the eyes of the players. Almost instantly, their faces lifted.

"Adora!" Glimmer exclaimed as she and Bow came barreling towards her as if they hadn't seen her all day when really it had only been three hours. Adora began walking towards the field where everyone met up as the two cheerful friends wrapped their arms around the blonde. Adora laughed and hugged them back. "Gray!" Their hug was cut short as a much taller woman stepped into the field, her short platinum hair pulled into a bun as she held a clipboard to her side. Adora smiled at Coach Huntara as her teammates focused on the large dog who had stolen the attention from the game. "Hey , Coach."

Adora greeted as she was pulled into a rough side hug. "It' s good to see you, kid," Huntara admitted as they pulled away . "When do you get to come back out to the field?" She asked. Adora shrugged her shoulders and frowned at the question. She wasn't sure and to be fair, she was scared of the answer. "Uh- I'm not exactly sure. I have to go in for my check-up tomorrow so I'll make sure to ask him." The blonde informed, and Huntara gave her a curt nod and a wrinkle of her nose. "Hopefully it' s soon. The team isn't the same without our She-ra." Netossa jokes, earning a round of laughter from the

surrounding players who all agreed. Adora rolled her eyes and laughed at the nickname.

"Do you want to just kick the ball around?" Perfume asks, looking up from her spot on the ground where she was kneeling down beside Swift Wind who was absolutely adoring the attention he was getting. "You can take my place. I'll watch Swift Wind." The flower-haired girl offered, and Adora couldn't help but beam with excitement as she eagerly nodded her head. As long as she didn't hit her head, she would be fine. The blue-eyed girl flashed a smile and almost immediately handed the leash to Perfuma, who graciously took it. The team around her whooped in excitement, and Huntara placed a hand on Adora's shoulder, only giving her a nod. Netossa blew the whistle, and everyone took their usual positions.

"You sure you can play, Dor?" Bow asked as he and Glimmer took a stand beside her, their hands on her shoulders. Adora turned to look at Bow, and she couldn't hide the smile that formed on her face. "I haven't played in seven months and if I have a chance to just kick the ball around again, I'm not missing it." She quipped an eyebrow . Bow and Glimmer shared a look before smiles dawned across their faces. Bow gave her a pat on the back, her body jerking forwards as Glimmer clapped.

"She-Ra's back, baby!" She exclaimed as the three of them ran back towards the formed huddle. Adora couldn't help but smile. She felt like she could finally breathe. Like everything in her life was getting back to *normal*. Like the crash never happened. Like her life wasn't on pause anymore. She felt *alive*.

"She re-introduced herself to you?!" Scorpia exclaimed, nearly spitting out her milkshake as heads turned to look at the cause of the outburst. Catra quickly waved her hands and shushed her, shooting apologetic smiles at the peering eyes. "Gee, yell it a little louder , will you Scorps? I don't think the rest of the diner heard you yet." She uttered an annoyed look plastered on her face as Scorpia slinks back into her seat and gives Catra a small smile. "Sorry Wildcat."

Catra pursed her lips and tipped her head. "S okay . Im sorry for getting upset." The brunette apologized, but was waved of f with a '*no worries!* '. Scorpia huf fed and placed the straw in her mouth, sipping the remainder of her milkshake, which was clearly empty due to the sound of air pressing against the cup, creating a sucking noise. "I just, that' s so.I cant believe she did that! Y ou know?" She asked, and Catra let out an airy chuckle and nodded. "Y eah, I can't either. But I mean, it was destined to happen. Im just.." Catra didnt know what to say. Instead, she placed her head in her hands and rested her elbows against the counter and groaned.

Catra knew Scorpia would beg her to talk, or at least unknowingly push her to it so instead of allowing it to happen, she changed the subject by grabbing Scorpia' s cup and giving her a cheerful smile. "Refill?" She asked. Scorpia only nodded her head and thanked her . Catra didnt say anything. She just turned around and walked through the swinging double doors into the kitchen. "How hard is it to read a note? It said no onions and now, I have a screaming child who gets to have free ice cream!" Cyra exclaimed in frustration.

Catra stared at her mother, who was burning holes into the cooks with glares. It was a Monday, and it was a dinner rush.

Everyone wanted to eat diner food after coming home from their long and boring jobs and drink milkshakes to end the day. Cyra's hair was thrown into a messy ponytail, and her curls were frizzing. As she paced around the kitchen, she kept switching from English to Spanish, a common sign that she was *stressed*. "Este restaurante será la muerte para mí:: *this restaurant will be the death of me* ::"

Catra tried to hide her body behind the large stacked boxes to avoid her mother's gaze but utterly failed. "Catrina Lucía D'riluth, *what* are you doing back here? There are tables to be waited for deja de hacer el tonto! *:quit messing around!* " Cyra walked over to Catra, who stood by the milkshake stand, a finger pointed to it. "I'm making Scorpia a milkshake." She slowly said, careful with her word choice as her mother glared at her. Catra quickly pursed her lips. "But you can do it and I can wait tables." The brunette smiled at her mother and set the cup down. Cyra only gave her a nod, before pulling her into a side hug, her lips pressing against the crown of her head.

"Gracias mi Bebe. T e Amo. :: *thank you, my baby. I love you*::" Catra smiled. "yo T ambien Te Amo mama:: *I love you too mama* ::" And with that, Catra dipped out from under her mother's arms, and pulled out the notebook from her apron. The brunette puffed out her cheeks as Scorpia spotted her and opened her mouth to speak, but she was quickly stopped by Catra who shook her head and tilted her head towards her mother who had pushed through the doors with a milkshake in hand. Not wanting to get caught *not* doing her job

again, Catra quickly shot Scorpia a smile and went to the first table she spotted.

"Hi, welcome to '*Catrina's*! My name is Catra and Ill be taking your orders this evening." She smiled. "Now what can I get for you?"

"It was incredible!" Adora exclaimed, her hands pulling from her pockets and waving in the air.

"It was like I never quit. I scored so many shots before the hour was even up!" The four Grays walked along the sidewalk in downtown Bright Moon. The air was warm, like a summer evening which was an uncommon temperature nearing November in the usually chilled town. The street lights buzzed and lit up the town, and people strolled up and down the paved pathways, enjoying the evening.

"That's amazing, Dor!" Adam congratulated her with a high five, which she happily returned. Marlena and Randor shared a look, smiles on their faces as they listened to Adora ramble about her return to Soccer, even if it was just for a couple of hours. They were incredibly joyed to hear their daughter boast about the sport she was once in love with as if the accident never happened. As if they were all okay again. And a part of Marlena knew that they were. It was rough. So many people in their lives went through so much pain after

the accident. The most being Catra and Adora. Although it was their daughter in the coma, Catra never left her side

She would sneak in with them and stay for as long as she could. Marlena knew Catra blamed herself when the results came back. When they were told that if (when) Adora woke up, there was a chance she could lose her memories, and everyday functional abilities and have to relearn them. Although the news rocked the families and dug a hole into their hearts, they never blamed Catra. Not *once*. Not *ever*. Marlena never noticed the frown that was pulled onto her lips until Randor gave her a gentle bump with his elbow. He frowned. "What's wrong?"

He asked. Marlena just shook her head and linked their arms. Her eyes found their way to Adam and Adora, who were fighting with sticks as swords in the middle of the sidewalk. A smile formed on her face. A real one. "Nothing. Nothing at all." She answered, and Randor chuckled a bit, before pressing a kiss to the top of her head. "Hey , guys?" The man called, earning the attention of the two blonde teens. He nodded his head towards the restaurant they were standing in front of, the bright purple sign illuminating their faces in a soft hue. "We're here."

Adora looked up, she and Adam dropped their sticks to the ground behind a metallic bench as she read the light-up sign.

‘Catrina’s!

If I get called back to table seven one more time I'm va a arrancarle el pelo a alguien:: *going to rip someone's hair out!* ::”Catra’s eye twitched as she set down the tray of empty drinks with little force, causing the glasses to clink together. Cyra slowly turned to her, her lips pursed. Catra *hated* the dinner rush. She despised it. Lunch? She was fine with it. Lunch was calm. Nice old ladies who tipped her big money after learning she was named after the restaurant came in and called her eyes beautiful.

Little kids waiting for their french fries with *milkshakes* and teenagers who sat at the corner booths and ordered *milkshakes.* She liked making the milkshakes. She always got to make one of her own that she hid in the back of the fridge with her name on it. But dinner rush? Dinner was when families came in and they were hungry and angry after a long day at the boring office. They were cranky, and the children were *worse* if that were even *possible*.

Cyra chuckled at her daughter's exasperation as Catra rounded the counter, and placed the tray down beside the pop dispensary inside the kitchen. One by one, she began dropping pockets of ice into the cups and filling them back up with the desired soda. One good thing about working in a restaurant as a waitress (besides the tips) was the muscle you got and the ability to deal with annoying people on a day-to-day basis.

When she had first started, her arms nearly grew numb from the weight of the heavy drink trays and plates of food. Now? Now she was able to carry a drink platter and a food tray in both arms. With her newly gained muscle, it allowed her to carry out punches to the punching bag she had hidden away in the basement. A place Sharon rarely went.

Replacing the scowl on her face with a large smile, Catra left the kitchen and went over to table seven and passed out their drinks. The family was nice enough, but the number of times they had snapped their fingers at Catra and had walked over to her while she was bussing tables just to order something else. The absolute joys of being a waitress. "Catra!" Cyra's voice called to her from two booths over, gaining her attention. The brunette smiled at the family, before sliding the tray off of the table and holding it to her side as she walked over to her mother, who had her arm across the top of the booth with a wide smile on her face. Catra opened her mouth to speak before she saw the familiar blonde bump of hair. Before she could run away, Adora's eyes were already peeking at her over the booth, wide with surprise.

"Kill me now."

As Adora walked into the restaurant, she couldnt help but stare at it in awe. The walls were a dark purple, with wooden panels that climbed half of the wall and the floor was a rich oak. Long ceiling lights hung from the roof, bringing a soft dim to the restaurant. It was dim enough that it gave the restaurant a romantic vibe but light enough that you were still able to see across the building. By the entrance, there was a polaroid wall of the crew members, and returning customers. She and her family were in many of them, with two other women that she wasnt able to identify before being pulled to their booth.

The four of them settled into the snug, leather seats, Adora by the aisle and Adam beside the wall while their parents sat across from them. "What are you getting?" Marlena asked as their server came by their table, greeted them and then dropped off a pamphlet of drinks and their plastic-covered menus. Adora simply shrugged, her eyes skimming the options. "Probably just a burger and fries with a milkshake," Adam answered and set down his menu. Adora looked at him, then down at the burger he was referring to. Her stomach grumbled and she felt her mouth water. She set down her menu and nodded. "Me too."

Marlene nodded and turned to Randor as they had gotten into a new conversation. Adora didnt bother to join in and instead, pulled out her phone. Her first instinct was to go onto Instagram and search for Catra's username. Her friends had acted so suspiciously, and she hadnt had time to ask Adam about the accident. She would do it later tonight when she knew her parents wouldn't intervene... With a frown pulled onto her face when the bar loaded and a 'No accounts found' popped up, she tucked her phone away and propped her elbow onto the table, allowing her head to rest. She must have zoned out because moments later her brother was nudging her side,

and telling her to sit up. When she did, her eyes wandered to the aisle where a woman stood. Her dark brown hair was curled and pulled into a ponytail, and she wasn't wearing an apron like the other waitresses. When the woman noticed Adora's eyes, something in them flickered and her smile nearly fell, but she held it strong.

"Adora," Adora looked at Marlena. "This is a close friend of ours." She said, and Adora looked back at the woman, who held her hand out with a kind smile. Something about her was so familiar but she couldn't put a name to it. "I'm Cyra." The woman, Cyra, introduced herself. The blonde smiled at her and held out her hand, taking Cyra's in her own. "I'm Adora. It's nice to meet you." She said, "Again." It was a lame excuse of a joke, but she was sure since Cyra was a close family friend that they knew each other at some point. While her parents didn't laugh, Cyra did as she nodded. "It's nice to meet you again too, Adora." Adora smiled at her and felt a bit of relief. No one really bought into her jokes. Her parents always gave her sad looks when she did and she could tell Adam had tried to, but rarely did. It was nice for once to have someone *not* look at her with pity.

As Cyra engaged in a conversation with her parents, Adora took a sip of the ice water that she had ordered beforehand, before nearly choking on the small ice cubes as Cyra calls a familiar name. "Catra!" Adora brought a napkin to her mouth, coughing into it as her face burned a bright red in embarrassment. She ignored the looks she got from her family as she turned in her seat, her eyes wide as she stared over the top of the booth like a little kid watching the waitress bring the ice cream sundaes to the table. Except instead of an ice cream snack, it was Catra walking down the aisle toward *her* table.

Catra's hair rested over her shoulders, the ends curled and the wispy hairs that framed her face twisted and rested across her head. She had a slick cat-wing eyeliner across her eyelid, which only brought more attention to her Heterochromia. Catra looked beautiful, even if she was wearing a simple black shirt and leggings with the familiar ' *Catrina's!* 'apron handwritten in purple. Her name was the same, neatly curled at the crest of her shirt. As soon as Catra had taken notice of the blonde, something flickered in her blue and amber eyes and she paused.

"Catra come here, say hi to the Grays." Cyra gave her an encouraging nod and smile, and Adora could see the way Catra's eyes flickered to the ground almost nervously and the way her character had changed upon seeing her. The blonde couldn't help but frown and sit back in her seat as Catra made her way to stand beside who Adora assumed to be her mother. Cyra wrapped an arm around Catra and gave her a soft tap of the shoulder with her fingers. "Hey , Cat." Adam greeted, and Adora's head flipped towards her twin.

Catra smiled at him. "Hey , Grayskull." Adora's head whipped back to Catra, then at her twin. She knew that Adam and Catra were in the same classes, but she didn't know that they were so close that *nicknames* were in order. Adora couldn't help but clench her jaw and bit down on her tongue. She crossed her arms and leaned back into her seat. While her parents greeted Catra, the girl returning it, the three adults began to engage in a conversation, leaving Catra, Adora and Adam. Except Adam had gone on his phone and began texting someone so now it was just *Catra* and *Adora*. The blonde girl looked

up at Catra, who was already looking down at her. Her face heated up due to being caught staring. Adora did the same.

"Hey , Adora."Catra crossed her arms over her chest and stared down at the girl. It was most likely because she didn't know what to do with her hands, but Adora took it as an ' *I'm asserting dominance* 'stance. "Hey , Catra."Adora smiled up at her . Catra didn't return it. *Did she do something wrong?* Adora's smile dropped and she began fiddling with the bracelet on her wrist. "So, I didn't know you worked here."Catra shifted her weight on both of her feet and nodded. "Y up. Named after it and everything."

This caused Adora to light up. "Really?"She asked excitedly . "That' s like, so cool!"She laughed, and she was pleased to see Catra' s tense demeanour soften as she too let out a small laugh. "Y eah, I guess it is."The two stayed silent for a moment. Catra cleared her throat and pulled out her notepad and a pen that had an 'A€' written away in a sharpie, but slowly fading. Adora caught sight of it but didn't think anything of it. "So, can I get you anything to drink since you're the only one ready to order?"Catra nervously chuckles, gesturing to the others who were either on their phone or chatting away. Catra didn't bother to gain their attention. They would most likely be staying for hours anyways. It's usually how it goes. Or how it usually went.

Adora smiled and nodded her head. "Y eah, actually can I get a milkshake?"She asked, and Catra nodded before jotting it down. "And I'm guessing blueberry banana?"Catra asked with a light chuckle, before stopping dead. Her eyes were wide, and she looked

like she was going to pass out in the middle of the aisle. Adora tilted her head. "Y -yeah. How did you know that was my favorite?" She asks, and Catra scratches her wrist, a nervous smile planted across her lips. "Uhm. It was just a lucky guess." Catra lies and waves it off. "You look like you're a blueberry banana type of person."

Adora decided not to press any further as she smiled, and rested her cheek in her hand. "Is that a compliment or an insult?" She asked and this time, Catra *actually* laughed. "Definitely an insult." She jokes, and Adora can tell from the smile that beamed down at her . Adora really liked Catra's smile. She liked a lot of things about Catra like her hair, her eyes, her smile, her lisp, and her raspy voice. She had taken notice of a lot of things about the brunette in just a short while. Adora had always noticed Catra, she had always noticed these things and always found she liked them but she never dared to tell her friends or anyone but her diary. No one knew and she would like to keep it that way.

Before Adora could open her mouth to speak, Catra was off. Adora watched as the brunette hurried into the kitchen, her hand running through her hair. Cyra seemed to have noticed the girl rush of f and excused herself as she was only a minute behind her. Her family then turned to Adora, who was still staring at the doors Catra had passed through. Marlena, Randor, and Adam all shared a look. It was a teasing smile. They werent dumb, they knew what was happening. Were they going to stop it? *Absolutely* not.

"Catra!" Cyra called as she rushed into the kitchen, spotting Catra standing in front of the milkshake machine with her hands planted against the counter. She was breathing heavily, in and out and her small frame was trembling. Cyra frowned and walked over to her, her hand placed onto her back but Catra swatted it away. When she looked up, tears had clogged Catra's eyes and streamed down her face. "Mi bebé... *:my baby* ::"

"Dont touch me." Catra cried. Her hands trembled as she brought them up to her hair, gripping at the strands. Cyra didnt listen and instead wrapped her arms around Catra. She immediately fell limp in her arms and allowed her mother to cradle her shaking body. "I cant do this," Catra whispered, and Cyra nodded. "I shouldnt have called you over. Im so sorry Catra." Cyra apologized, and Catra shook her head and pulled away as she wiped her tears. "No, not that. It was nice to talk to Marlena and Randor and see Adam. It's just… *stupid* Adora." She explained, and Cyra stayed silent and listened.

"She stupidly reintroduced herself today and it sent me into a stupid spiral and I just- I just told her her *own* milkshake order and I had to make up some *bullshit* lie!" Catra gestured angrily to the notepad with Adora's milkshake order. Cyra only nodded her head and placed a hand on Catra's shoulder. "You should go home for tonight."

Catra furrowed her eyebrows. "No what? Im fine. I don't need to. It's a dinner rush. You need help." Cyra shook her head. "That's why we have waiters and waitresses that arent my daughter." She looked down at her watch. "Besides, your shift ended ten minutes ago."

Catra shook her head and turned to the milkshake machine and began making Adora's milkshake with shaky hands. "I'm fine."

"Catra." Her mother said sternly , and Catra shut her eyes. "Go home. I'm still your boss." The girl angrily passed her mother the pad of paper and ripped off her apron as she headed over to the lockers to change, the swinging door slamming shut behind her. Cyra sighed and looked down at the paper with a frown.

' *Blueberry banana milkshake for ~~my 'Dr 3~~ for Adora.'*

Chapter End Notes

'my 'dor' :((

This chapter is so much shorter than the other ones but if I kept writing it would be too packed and the book wouldn't flow nicely 😩

update: very important question, do you guys like weekly uploads (scheduled) or random?

Chapter 4

Chapter Summary

Adora learns some exciting news.

Chapter Notes

so this chapter is like four hours late I'm so sorry. I had absolutely no idea how I wanted to write this and I'm still a little unsure but in the end, I liked the idea enough to post it.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

The first thing that Catra noticed was that Adora was gone.

Not seeing the blonde in her regular seat in their shared English class stirred a mixture of worry and nervousness in her stomach. Every so often, she would find herself glancing at the blue door almost as if she was waiting for the head of blonde hair to walk in, stumbling over her words as she frantically apologized for being late and slipped into her desk. But it never happened. Adora never walked in through the door.

Second and third period rolled by within a flash and then finally, lunch came. Catra was growing tense now, almost fearful. Adora

wasnt one to skip school. Hell, she was the poster child for good grades. Catra was sure Adora hadnt skipped a *day* in her life. She guessed that she had probably just slept in, but even that felt wrong. Adora always woke up early. *She used to. You don't know if she does anymore*. Catra's thoughts fought her. But something in her body told her that wasnt the case. Her stomach felt like it was swishing around and she felt sick. For the first time in a while, she had peered into the cafeteria for her own frantic needs.

Her eyes gazed across the multiple heads scattered, before landing on a ball of pink she could easily identify as Glimmer, Adora's new and shiny friend. Catra contemplated going up to Sparkles and asking where Adora was, but she decided against it not wanting to be spat on for even speaking Adora's name. Out of the corner of her eye, she felt her heart race quicken as a head of blonde hair pulled into an idiotic ponytail and walked closer to the group with a tray in hand. Her smile faded when the girl turned her head and it was only Perfuma.

Out of everyone in Adora's new group, Perfuma (and sometimes Bow) was the only one who tried with Catra. She was nice and often talked to her when she hung out with her, Scorpia and Entrapta. Maybe it was because she and Scorpia were together and she felt like she *had* to, but also Catra figured Perfuma was a terrible liar.

Catra turned around and began walking down the hallway to the back stairwell, her phone in her hands as she opened up her iMessages. She scrolled through the various texts she had yet to open, before finding her acquired target.

(*cat*)

Is Adora okay?

Her finger hovered over the ṡend’button, her bottom lip pulled between her teeth before taking a deep breath and hitting send.

(*adam*)

Yeah? she’s fine

Adam’s text came almost immediately. Catra wondered if he was in school or if he was skipping as well. If Adora wasnt in class, then maybe it was for a reason. Maybe they had a family emergency. The thought only made Catra hold her breath as she leaned against the wall, and slid down till her knees were pressed against her chest.

(*adam*)

why

Catra responded even quicker. Maybe it was an act of desperation, maybe it was jւst because it was of f of Adora to skip. Either way, Catra didnt know why she was so worried about Adora. She figured

it was because Spinnerella was right. She hadnt healed yet. *Yeah. That was it.*

(*cat*)

why isnt she in school?

As Adam typed, Catra felt her heart jump into her throat as she stared at the grey bubbles. They stopped, then continued as if Adam was erasing his message again and again. It only made her more anxious as her finger came into her mouth, the nail finding its way between her teeth.

(*adam*)

Doctors appointment. She’s seeing if she’s

doing better in general ig

Catra pulled her finger out of her mouth to type a response. Her heart began to sink. What if Adora wasnt able to play again? Catra knew how much Adora loved Soccer and if she couldnt play again because of her.She wouldnt know if she would forgive herself. She had taken away more things than she had ever given Adora in their years of friendship, she couldnt take something else away . She knew that it wasnt her fault entirely , but the weight of it all came crashing down onto *her*.

(*adam*)

do you want me to keep you

updated?

Adam’s text came before Catra could reply. The brunette quickly deleted her draft and sat in the chat for a moment. Her head rested against the wall as she stared down at the message. Did she want Adam to keep her updated? She wasnt sure. A part of her wants to say yes, but the other half wants her to say no. She knew deep down in her heart and mind that she should. That this was a good thing like everyone had been telling her. But she was stubborn. She didnt believe them. She texted him back.

(*cat*)

No.

.Adora was scared.

She was sitting on a hard surface. The leather underneath her was tough and it pressed her ass into her bones. The paper underneath her was scratchy, it tore and crumpled with every action she made, no matter how subtle or small. The room was too bright and quiet. All she could hear was the air conditioning blowing, the beeping of machines in the next room and the sound of her mother playing Candy Crush on her phone behind her. Her nose wrinkled at the antiseptic smell. A little bitter, with undertones of the artificial fragrance that was contained in soaps and cleaners that wiped the floors and was soaked into the skin of every Doctor working.

None of it calmed her nerves. Her knee was bouncing. Up and down. Up and down repetitively on the little black stool and her fingers were twisted around each other. Adora puffed out her cheeks and let out a long exhale before finally, a woman with dark brown buzzed hair walks in with her phone in her hands and a smile pulled across her face. When she enters the room, her phone slips away and a smile grows across her face. Adora returns it. "Adora!"

The woman greets as she walks over to Adora. The blonde jumps up from her spot and wraps her arms around the woman who gracefully returns it. "Hi, Hope." The two pull away and Adora climbs back onto the seat, the paper crinkling underneath her weight. Hope and Marlena also share a hug. The family was fairly familiar with Hope Roberts. Not only was she Adora's doctor, but she was also the fiance of Adora's aunt, Mara. Since Hope and Mara were only dating when Hope was assigned to be Adora's doctor, there wasnt a conflict of interest. And it helped the family to hear the news as it came.

“How have you been feeling?”Hope asks as she stands in front of Adora, her fingers under her chin as she tilts Adora’s head upwards and shines a flashlight into them. The blonde tries not to flinch. “Follow the light for me.”Adora does as she’ s told, her eyes following the blinding flash. “I’m uh- Im doing good,”Adora answered as Hope removed the flashlight from her eyesight, nodding along. “Pupils are responsive and looking good,”Hope said, before smiling at Adora. “Y eah? That’s good. Mara will be happy to hear that.”

Adora frowns at this as she grabs Hope’s hands, the two interlocking fingers. Hope planted her feet onto the floor as Adora began pushing against the palms of her hands, testing her strength. “Why doesnt she just come over? See for herself.”Adora asks as Hope staggers a bit and they switch positions as Hope pushes against Adora’s hands. Her arms dont bend like Hope’ s. “W ell, with her residency she’s really swamped right now.”Hope explained as she nodded and checked three boxes. Adora tried to give her an understanding smile.

After Adora’s accident, Mara often snuck into Adora’s room to sleep by her side whenever she could. Whether she was on her shift, or even when her shift ended. When Adora got home, she was surprised to see so many people (including her doctor holding her supposed aunt in her arms). Mara was the first one to make Adora feel normal after everything. Maybe it was because she and her partner were doctors but maybe it was because Mara didn't coddle her. She treated her as if nothing happened. Adora was grateful for her.

The blonde was pulled from her thoughts by Hope snapping her fingers in front of her face. "Adora?" The woman asked, and Adora's head snapped up as she blinked. "You still with me?" She asked with a laugh, and Adora went red as she smiled. "Yeah- sorry." Adora cleared her throat as she quickly got off the table. She knew what was next. She had been doing the same things for the past year after she woke up. And plus, it was her favourite part. "Okay just walk across the room and back for me." Hope instructed and Adora shot her a smile.

"I know , I've done this a million times." The blonde teased and Hope rolled her eyes, and waved her hands, gesturing for Adora to get moving. She did as she walked across the room, even going further as she opened the door and began walking down the hall, giving Hope and her mother teasing smirks as if to say *'This test has nothing on me. I got this'.* Marlene and Hope followed her with smiles. "Okay show off." A voice said from behind Adora. The blonde whipped her head only to spot a tan woman with chestnut hair pulled into a thick side braid. Adora smiled and the woman returned it.

"Mara!" Adora exclaimed as the girl ran towards the woman who she almost towered over. Mara laughed and wrapped her arms around Adora, giving her a tight hug. The ID card attached to her chest uncomfortably poked Adora's skin, but she ignored it. The two pulled away and began walking back to Hope and Marlena. Marlena hugged her younger sister and Hope kissed her on the cheek. "Looks like someone might be ready to get back on the field." Mara threw an arm around Marlena, the older woman biting down on her lip as she sucked her teeth.

"That thought itself is absolutely nerve-wracking and exhilarating at the same time."The auburn-haired woman laughed and Adora just smiled, her eyes lighting up like saucers as she turned to Hope. She didn't have to say anything for Hope to give her a teasing shrug and smile. "I guess only one test really matters here."She said and Adora jumped up, clapping her hands as she smiled excitedly .

The three women laughed as they followed an excited Adora out through the emergency room doors. It was a slow day that day. No ambulances had come and the area resembled the size of a soccer field perfectly. It was a perfect size. Adora grabbed hold of her foot and began stretching her legs.

Hope disappeared around the corner before reappearing with a red foam soccer net with white strings and a familiar soccer ball. The edges were frayed and most of the blue had rubbed off. It was Adora's old soccer ball. It was the first one she had ever gotten at eight years old. Adora wondered if her mother had given it to Hope and Mara when they first started to test her motor skills. Hope tossed it to Adora who easily caught it.

Her hands glided across the ball, a reminiscing smile playing across her lips as she twisted the ball in her hands. The faded sharpie was easier to identify now that she was close and personal to the ball. It was signed by her family and friends and had stupid doodle faces that stained the rubber. Adora smiled down at it and looked up. Hope was standing in front of the net in a guarding stance. Adora wanted to comment on how her legs were too far apart and she would fall if she tried to defend herself like that, but she didn't.

‟f I get this in I get to play soccer again,”Adora called as she tossed the ball into the air and then caught it again. Hope smiled at her. ‟Let’ s see how well you can kick then we can discuss soccer, alright?”Adora gave her a nod. Suddenly , she felt her heart pick up. She knew that she was going to get it in. She knew she was going to be able to kick the ball. So why was she nervous? Adora closed her eyes and breathed in heavily.

When she opened them again, her mother and Mara were standing by the building, giving her encouraging smiles. She knew that her mother was praying this would be the final check-up. *Official* check-up anyways. She knew with two doctors as aunts she would never escape the checkups and exams.

Every box of hers was checked off except physical. This would be the last box. And Adora *prayed* she could check it. That her legs wouldn't give out again like last time. She was a bit sore from playing soccer yesterday, but she didn't dare tell anyone that. They would ȷst tell her that she couldnt play anymore. That she needed more time. Adora didnt need *time*. She needed to *play*. Get her body used to playing again. *That* was what she needed.

The blonde dropped the ball, her feet gently hopping against the cement to warm them up. Her neck craned as she shook her hands as if this would be the winning shot. And in a way, it was. Adora’s foot reeled back and before she knew it, the ball was flying through

the air at a whipping speed and smacking against the white string with so much force, that the net fell backwards with the ball bouncing in the fallen net. Although Adora only smiled (she knew she could do it), Mara, Hope and her mother all jumped and clapped their hands in excitement as the three of them ran towards her, engulfing her in a tight hug.

Adora could barely breathe and she let out a chopped laugh and hugged who she could back. Mara and Hope pulled away, but Marlena didnt. When Adora looked down, her shirt had a wet spot. Her mother had been crying. Adora frowned but covered it by hugging her mother back, the side of her face resting against her mother's hair. "Mom." Adora laughed as Marlena pulled back and quickly wiped her eyes and joined in with Adora. "I'm okay ." She said as she looked up to the sky and exhaled loudly

"Are you though?" Adora asked, amused. Marlena rolled her eyes and slugged Adora in the shoulder before wrapping an arm around her. "Keep it up and you're not getting ice cream."

"I'm getting ice cream?"

“Catra?”

The brunette’s knee was bouncing up and down, her fingernails in her mouth and between her teeth. She was sitting in a blue fabric chair with her knees pulled to her chest, staring down at her shoes and tracing the dirt that marked them. Her phone buzzed and she quickly pulled it out of her pocket to check the time. 12:23 PM. She still had around half an hour before class started, and that meant half an hour with her guidance counsellor, Spinnerella. After texting Adam, she decided she needed a place to hideout. If there was anything that Catra hated about Adam, it was how relentless he was. Puffing out her cheeks, Catra placed her phone on the seat and finally looked up at the woman in front of her.

“I ran into Adora and her family .”She explained. “Again.”Spinnerella nodded her head and continued to listen. Catra’s knee dropped to the ground. “And it was so stupid!I mean, I would have been *fine* if she wasn't there and she just-”Catra paused. “Ruins everything!” She exclaimed, and Spinnerella offered her a smile. “Does Adora ruin everything, or are you just too scared to talk to her?”The woman asked and Catra’s eyes flickered up to her. “What?”She asked. Spinnerella leaned back in her seat and twisted a pencil between her fingers.

“It’ s okay to be scared, Catra.”She went on. “But Adora doesn't ruin everything. She reminds you of a hard time in your life. One you haven't healed from.”Catra gritted her teeth. Sometimes, she *hated* how right Spinnerella was. But she would never admit it. “I have healed from it.”She mumbled and hugged her body . “Okay .”

The rolling chair turned and earned Catra's attention. "Then I want you to talk to Adora."Spinnerella rested her elbows on the desk and leaned forwards. Catra furrowed her eyebrows, and let out a nervous laugh. "What? No!Adora is better of f without me and I'm not- no!" The brunette protested, and Spinnerella shrugged. "Then I guess you arent as healed as you say."Catra was taken aback. Since when was Spinnerella one to challenge people? *Netossa* maybe, but Spinnerella? Catra scoffed and stood up, her bag flying across her shoulder. "W e're done here."

She said as she walked over to the door, her teeth gritted. She grabbed hold of the doorknob but was stopped by Spinnerella's voice. "T alk to Adora. That's your assignment."Catra didnt look back. She didnt speak, she just shot Spinnerella the middle finger and slammed the door on the way out, not caring if she got in trouble.

Stupid guidance counsellors.

"Adora!That' s amazing!"

Glimmer gushed as she pulled Adora into a bone-crushing hug. Bow copied and before she knew it, Adora was being pressed flat by two bodies. The blonde laughed and slid out of the hug, her hair frizzing up. She attempted to flatten it while behind pulled along with Glimmer and Bow. "Where are we going?" She asked, confused. Glimmer hugged her arm. "To go tell coach Huntara and Netossa, duh!" The short girl giggled.

"You got the go! That means you can start practicing with us again!" Bow exclaimed happily, his voice cracking. Glimmer groaned and tugged Adora's arm to the right, dragging her towards the gym. "Plus! We need you back. Mermista is too." Glimmer paused, picking at her words. "She's more competitive than you and not in the way you are. She gets mean." The girl explained and Adora pursed her lips and remained silent. She and Mermista often butt heads during practice and even games.

Mermista was more of an… *aggressive* type of supporter while Adora was more of an encouraging type. Both of them were aggressive and competitive players but had different styles of encouragement to give their teammates. Bow pushed open the doors and the three of them walked in. Or more so, Bow and Glimmer walked. Adora's feet dragged across the floor. "Coach!" Glimmer sang, her voice echoing across the gym as it bounced off of the walls in the large room.

Huntara and Netossa both looked up from where they stood in the middle of the gym. Adora's eyebrows furrowed as she took notice of all of the soccer balls lying across the floor with a black and red pump plugged into the wall with the straggly cord twisting around the floor like a snake. Adora's eyes adverted from the cord to the two women standing in front of her. "What can we do for you three?" Netossa asked as she placed the soccer ball that was coddled in her hands on the floor gently.

Bow nudged Adora's side and gave her an encouraging nod and smile. Glimmer did the same except she was being giddier. Adora turned towards Netossa and Huntara who were already staring at her. She suspected they already knew the reason for her being there from the hidden smiles behind their eyes. "Uh-" Adora started as she peeled herself away from Glimmer and shoved her hands into her pockets. "I'm all cleared. I can be out on the field in no time and resume my positions as soon as today." She said, and her coaches broke out into smiles.

"That' s great to hear, blondie." Huntara reached a hand out and ruffled Adora's hair (like she used to). Netossa picked up a soccer ball from the ground and gently tossed it at Adora who caught it. "That' s amazing. The team is out on the field running through a few drills. You already know them though." Netossa gave her a wink. Adora figured it was the same drills that had been done yesterday. It didn't take long for Adora to pick up on their moves and routines. She was a quick learner and as soon as she got the hang of how her team played again, it felt like she never stopped.

Adora smiled at her and looked down at the ball in her hands. "Go on, kid," Netossa said as she reached over and tapped her shoulder , gesturing to the open gymnasium doors, allowing the sunlight to flood the gym. Adora could hear the sound of a whistle blowing and her teammates shouting words of encouragement. The blonde turned to Glimmer and Bow before the three of them broke out into smiles and bolted into the changerooms to practice as much as they could before the bell rang.

"Who does she think she is?"

Catra asked as she continued to pace across the grass. "I mean, *tch* she doesn't *know* me! Why does she think she gets to tell me what to do? If I'm *'healed'* or not!" The brunette asked as she turned to look at Entrapta and Scorpia. Entrapta was sitting on the bench on her iPad, most likely calculating something and Scorpia was on the grass beside them doing lunges as a pre-warm-up for Soccer.

Catra's eyes followed the sound of a whistle blowing and scowling as she watched Bright Moon High's pretentious soccer players run across the field kicking their stupid ball. The muscular girl shrugged. "I mean, she *is* your guidance counsellor and has been since last year, wildcat," Scorpia said. Catra squinted at her .

“ *So* ?”

She groaned and threw her hands into the air, before slapping them against her thighs. “W ell, according to my calculations, you've spent a total of 343, 800 hours and 22,413 minutes with Mrs. R, so I'd say she does know you quite a lot.”Entrapta butt in. Catra puf fed out her cheeks and sat down on the bench beside her with her head in her hands. She let out a loud groan. Entrapta rested a hand on her hand and awkwardly patted her back. "There there.”

Catra looked back up, and Entrapta retracted her hand. “Should I do it?”She asked her two friends. They were her support. Catra loved to act like she was all high and mighty and like she didnt need them, but deep down, she did. She was thankful for them that they stayed by her side through everything. Even after the crash and with the mean words spoken to and about her, they stuck up for her and stayed by her side. She would be lost without them. And that was just the truth.

Scorpia stopped lunging and sat down beside Catra. The brunette looked at her. "If you think it’ s the right thing and if you're ready , you should.”She encouraged and Catra gave her a half-lipped smile. She then turned to Entrapa, who was tapping rapidly on her iPad. “Y ou were 93% happier when Adora knew who you were and now you're 87% moodier without her so I say yes.”

Catra rolled her eyes and laughed, before slugging Entrapta in the shoulder. Scorpia took this time to climb up behind them and wrap her arms around the two of them so tightly that Catra's cheek was squished up against Entrapta's. "Super pal trio hug!" And this time, Catra didnt fight it.

Their hug was cut short by the sound of someone running toward them. The three of them looked up and spotted Perfuma walking towards her. Her blonde hair was pulled into a high ponytail and she had a pink flower planted in it, Catra wondered how she managed to keep it in her hair even while playing such a sport like soccer.

Scorpia peeled herself off of Catra and Entrpata and giddily jumped off of the bench to wrap her arms around Perfuma. The girl immediately began peppering Perfuma's face with kisses and Catra couldnt fight the smile that was begging to break free. "Hi, love." Perfuma greeted as she wrapped an arm around Scorpia's waist.

"We're going to practice some more before lunch is over." She pointed a thumb back towards the team. "Do you want to join?" She asked and Scorpia turned to look at Entrapta and Catra, almost asking if it was okay. Entrapta didn't care, she was already back on her iPad and Catra smiled at her. "We'll be fine, Scorps. Go kick a ball around."

Scorpia smiled at her and gave her a nod. "Dont leave me!" The platinum blonde called as she and Perfuma began walking back to the team. Catra only saluted her and pulled out her phone as a distraction.

A few times the soccer players had begun cheering loudly, but Catra didnt bother to look up. Whenever Catra joined Scorpia for lunch (when practice was going on and she knew Adora wouldnt be there), every player was so loud and filled with excitement. Even when they missed a goal Catra swore they continued to cheer as if they had won the damn state championships. "Oh look Adora is playing again," Entrapta said casually , Catra almost missed it completely until she fully registered the purple-haired girl's words, her head snapping up.

And sure enough, Adora *was* playing again. It seemed like she had been for a while due to the sweat that glistened across her skin in the beaming sunlight. Underneath the blue jersey , her arms shone and even from across a field, Catra could tell how toned they had become just from doing simple arm workouts and she felt her mouth grow dry. Her hair, now nearly falling out of her ponytail and sticking to her forehead was curled and stuck up in the most random spots.

But one thing that stood out to her was how her bangs were no longer pinned back. They were free and granted, sticking to her skin, but they were free. Catra had always loved Adora's bangs. She

looked so.dif ferent with them. Like a brand new person. Catra loved Adora's hair down in general. The blonde raised her arms in the air and whooped loudly and Catra's eyes followed to the goalie net where a soccer ball was wrapped in nets.

It wasnt hard to tell that it was Adora who had taken the shot from the way her smile blossomed across her face and her friends tackled her with hugs. *That should be me.* Catra frowned at the thought, the smile that had snuck across her face fading. Almost as if Adora had felt Catra's eyes on her, the blonde looked away from her friends and over to the brunette who had turned her attention to the ground. With a rising chest, Adora peeled from her friends as she raised her hand in the air. "Hey , Catra!"

Catra hadnt expected Adora to call her name. And it seemed as though the shock wasnt just on Catra' s face but on everyone else's. The brunette looked up and to her dismay, Adora's eyes were locked on her. In fact, everyone's eyes were locked on her. Catra felt her stomach begin to twist and her face grows red as she gave Adora a painfully awkward smile and a small wave.

Catra quickly turned to Entrapta, who was smiling down at her as the brunette quickly picked up her bag without another word, strapping it across her shoulder as she kept her head down and began walking away. The doors were only twenty feet away from her. *If she walked fast enough, hopefully, she wouldn't be caught by Adora. Hopefully , she wouldn't stop her-*

Fifteen feet.

Ten feet. *Almost there*.

"Catra!" And there it was. Before Catra could even make it inside the school, Adora's hand was already on Catra's shoulder stopping her. *Shit*. *Stupid* soccer players. *Stupid* Adora. Why did she have to be *everywhere*? Catra was glad that Adora was able to play again, she was. But did she have to play *that* day? The *one* day Catra decided to sit outside? Of course, she did. Because this was *stupid*, *annoying* and idiotically fast *Adora*.

Catra stopped and swallowed the lump in her throat as she attempted to hide the blush that cascaded across her face. She failed almost immediately once her eyes caught sight of a panting and sweaty Adora. Her face was a soft pink like it was finally calming down from the rush of quick-paced activity and glistened with sweat. Up and close with Adora in all of her glory made Catra's tongue go dry and her face only burned more as her eyes flickered to the blonde's arms. "Hey ." Catra quickly looked up and away from Adora's arms and to her actual face. The blonde was smiling down at her all giddily.

"Hey , Adora."The cat greeted as she tried to play cool with a smirk. It seemed to work as Adora's face turned red and her hand slipped from Catra's shoulder and to the back of her neck. *Perfect*. If Adora was too busy being flustered she wouldn't notice that Catra was affected the same. "Hey . Hi."The blonde stuttered as she laughed nervously.

"So. I can play soccer again."She said, and Catra felt her heart pick up. "I know you probably don't care since you know , we've talked like twice but yeah I just- I just think that it' s cool and you're- you're cool so I wanted to sh-share"…

Catra couldn't help but smile as Adora rambled nervously. Catra fought the urge to place her hand across her mouth to shut her up, something she used to do when they were kids that Adora absolutely hated but she found to be quite hilarious. It was scary how easily she could slip right back into old habits. With Adora, it was like free-falling into a deep and dark abyss. A never-ending abyss. Catra wasn't sure if she liked it.

She ended up just giving the blonde a short nod. "That' s uh, that's great Adora. I'm glad you're able to play again."The brunette brought a closed fist up to Adora's shoulder and cuffed her. "Also that you think I'm cool."Is *this* what Spinnerella meant? She was talking to Adora. She was being friendly. She knew the purple-haired woman would somehow hear about this simple interaction, she heard everything around the school so Catra prayed that whenever the news touched her ear she would be at least *proud* of her for

stepping *way* out of the comfortable little bubble she had wrapped around herself.

Adora blushed as she scratched the back of her neck, before dropping her arm and bouncing on her toes like a schoolgirl. Catra thought it was cute. She didn't let her face show it. As the blonde opened her mouth to speak, a whistle blew and when both heads turned, Catra was thankful that it was Huntara. "Alright guys hit the showers, class starts in less than ten," Huntara shouted as she jabbed a finger backwards. Catra took this as her chance to slip behind Adora as she scaled the side of the school to take the other doors. She didn't want to interact anymore. By the time Adora turned back to look at Catra, she was gone. The blonde frowned as she turned her head to the side, spotting a head of brown hair slipping around the corner.

Chapter End Notes

I apologize if this chapter is actual shit LMAO

Chapter 5

Chapter Notes

> This chapter is one of my favourites I think. You guys will see why

See the end of the chapter for more notes

It’s been three days since Adora had seen Catra. Today is the third.

Adora didnt know what she had done, or if she had even done anything at all. Catra didnt show up to English class. She didnt appear in the cafeteria or alongside Scorpia and Entrapta on the field. She was just gone. After Adora had talked to Catra Tuesday afternoon, she had disappeared and almost immediately in her place was Glimmer. Adora didnt want to say that she was upset that Catra had been replaced by her best friend but she was. Glimmer was furious.

After she had told Adora about what Catra had done, you'd think she would understand why Glimmer was so angry. But she didnt. She didnt understand anything Glimmer or Bow told her . She didnt understand why she wasnt allowed to talk to Catra. She didnt understand why Glimmer hated her so much. If she hated her for the crash then Adora didnt want to know what she thought of her mother. She suspected it was something fairly cruel. Who gives their own kid Amnesia, right?

“Adora!” Glimmer chased after Adora who was hurriedly walking down the halls at a fast pace. “Stop running away from me!” Adora shot a glance over her shoulder. “I’m not. I am simply walking.” She answered, not slowing down. She lied. She was running away. It was break and Adora was on a mission. She wanted to talk to Catra. Over the last few days, Adora had two thoughts on her mind. Catra, and why Catra hated her. And Adora was ruthless when she wanted something. When she wanted to know something. She didn’t stop until she got it. And right now? She wanted to know why Catra hated her.

“Well then slow down.” Glimmer huffed, and hearing the short girl begin breathing heavily, Adora couldn’t help but feel bad. So she stopped. Waited until Glimmer was by her side, then continued. Glimmer seemed to hate the idea but now at least Adora was walking slower and they were side by side. “Look, Adora, I know you want to talk to Catra but-” That was where Adora grew angry. The blonde stopped dead in her tracks and whipped around to face Glimmer. Her face was pulled into a scowl. “What’s your problem with Catra?” She asked. Glimmer seemed taken back before she exhaled. “I already told you.” Adora rolled her eyes.

“Yeah. You hate her because of an accident.” Adora scoffed and licked her teeth. “So what, do you hate my mom too?” She asked. Glimmer’s eyes widened. The girl opened her mouth to speak but Adora didn’t let her. “I mean, really Glimm. Do tell me. Do you hate my mom?” Adora asked again. “Because she got into a car crash with me. I was in a coma for maybe two and a half months. I had to relearn how to properly walk because my brain was asleep for so long that it forgot how to walk. Or use my hands. I forgot who I was. Forgot who everyone was.” Adora crossed her arms. “So do you blame my mom too? Or do you just blame Catra because she stole

the lead role in fifth grade and you needed *anything* else to justify that reason?"

Glimmer's eyes fluttered. Adora gritted her teeth and shook her head as the girl remained silent. "You know what, you can keep your damn grudge but dont let it affect my life too." She said as she began walking away, before getting pulled back by a rough arm. "What did you just say?" Glimmer asked. Adora rolled her eyes. "I said, keep your damn grudges but dont let it affect my life too." She repeated. Glimmer shook her head.

"No. The other thing. About Catra stealing the lead from me in fifth grade." Adora raised her eyebrows. "Are you serious? That's the only thing you got from that? God Glimmer you are so-"

Glimmer interrupted her with a smile that caused Adora to pause. "Adora...repeat what you just said." The pink-haired girl whispered. Adora stood confused. "Catra stole the lead from you in fifth grade." She repeated. Glimmer nodded her head as if to tell her to repeat it again. And she did. "Catra stole the lead from you in." Adora's words came to a slow stop and suddenly, she began smiling incredibly wide. "fifth grade! Oh my god, I remember that!" The blonde exclaimed as her hands clamped down on her mouth. Tears began to well up in her eyes and the same happened to Glimmer.

"Oh my god, I remembered something." Adora whispered as tears began to slip down her face. Glimmer nodded her head as a silent tear slipped down her cheek and a wide smile played on her lips. "I remember something." Adora whispered again to herself almost as if she didnt believe in her own words. Something in her flipped and the silent cries she once let slip turned into sobs that rocked her body and made her knees go weak as she placed a hand on the wall beside her to keep her trembling body stable.

Glimmer quickly caught her and pulled Adora into a hug where the tall blonde fell into her arms. Her body rocked with sobs and the sound of her cries was muffled by her own arm that she had pressed in front of her mouth to keep quiet. Glimmer just rubbed her back and allowed Adora to sob into her.

After a few moments, Adora's breathing began to regulate and the tears began to slow down. But the weak feeling in her knees and the fluttering in her stomach did not. She remembered something. Even if it was a small detail from some fifth-grade play, it was something. Adora rubbed her nose on the sleeve of her jacket as she shakingly pulled out her phone. The break had ended three minutes ago but neither girl cared. And they were sure that if any teacher caught them in the hall, they would understand.

"Oh shit. Break is over ," Adora swore as she quickly wiped away her tears and exhaled loudly, shaking her head as if to stop herself from crying. Glimmer frowned. "Dont you want to call your parents?" She asked and Adora shook her head. "No. I want to tell them in person. And besides, I have to get Catra her homework." Adora' s face began

to turn red while Glimmers went pale. It didn't take anyone with half a brain to realize the infatuation that Adora held in a chokehold. All of their friends could see it just from the past week and a half that Catra had wormed her way back into her life.

"Adora, is that really a good idea?" Adora just stared at her and shook her head. "I'm not doing this again, Glimm. I like Catra. She's nice and- and cool. She made a mistake but that doesn't mean she should be avoided." Glimmer opened her mouth to speak, but Adora had already turned away from her. "See you later!" She called, her voice echoing down the hall as she disappeared around a corner.

Glimmer felt a lump in her throat begin to grow and suddenly, a terrible feeling boiled in her stomach. She felt like she was going to throw up and like her hands weren't going to stop shaking. She couldn't identify the feeling. But she didn't want to.

Something in her body screamed at her that this, this wasn't a good thing. But how selfish would that be? Was Glimmer actually… *upset* that Adora had remembered something? No. That couldn't be it. Glimmer refused to believe that was it. It had to of been something else. Glimmer wasn't upset that Adora was remembering. She was upset that Adora would remember Catra. That she would remember what she did to her. What everyone did. Glimmer knew Adora. She would *never* forgive them.

Catra sat on the beanbag, her legs spread and her body limp and slumped back into the soft cushion.

She stared down at the joint between her fingers, her eyes following the line of smoke that trailed upwards and disappeared into the sun that shone through her open window. Soft music played in the background as well as giggles. Catra looked to her right where Scorpia and Perfuma sat, Perfuma had her arms wrapped around Scorpia and Scorpia had hers around Perfuma. Their noses were touching and their smiles were wide as their bodies swayed. Catra scowled and turned away, bringing the joint up to her lips as she inhaled. The weed stuffed in between the paper crackled and burned the more smoke she inhaled. She hated when Scorpia and Perfuma acted in love.

She got it, they were in love. Scorpia was happy with her girlfriend. Scorpia was in a happy one-year relationship. She was happy for her best friend. Catra was just bitter when she thinks back on how that could have been her and Adora. That could have been them. It should have been them. But then again, Catra wasn't even sure if Adora had felt the same way about her.

There were times when it seemed as though she did. Like when she used all of her money to buy that stupid bracelet for her (Catra was

fiddling with the braided band). Or when they would have sleepovers, Adora would wrap her arms around Catra's waist and pull her closer until their skin was flushed against one another.

The brunette knew how she felt. She was *hopelessly* in love with Adora. Had been since the tenth grade. Yeah, she was fifteen and people would have told her that she was 'too young' (bullshit, love has no limit on how old you can be to fall in love) and that Adora was just her first serious girl crush. Catra would have believed them. Shit, maybe she *did* believe them. Sharon sure as hell made it clear that she believed that Catra was just confused. Catra knew she was certain about her sexuality.

She knew that when playing Spin the Bottle in eighth grade and she had to kiss Sea Hawk. His kiss was sloppy and it made her feel icky. But when the bottle landed on Glimmer? Sure the kiss was still sloppy for an eighth-grader and it was Sparkles;annoying, short and over-kill so the kiss wasnt any better but it sure as hell was a lot better than Sea Hawks and even though it lasted about three seconds, Catra knew that she liked girls 100% more than boys.

But her so-called love for Adora? Maybe that was the part she was confused about. After all, she was fifteen. And Catra wasnt even sure if she loved Adora anymore. It had been almost a year and there was no way in hell Adora reciprocated those feelings. You cant love someone you dont even know . And Adora didnt know her .

“...tra?”

“Catra!” Catra’s head shot up from her spot, her eyes going to Scorpia and Perfuma who were now kneeling in front of her with concerned looks on their faces. Catra’s eyes flickered to the burnt-out joint in her limp fingers, then back to Scorpia and Perfuma. “Oh jeez, Wildcat. Are you okay? Please say something.” Scorpia plead as she placed both hands on the sides of Catra’s face, her cheeks squishing between her friend's giant palms. Catra dropped the joint into the ashtray on the ground beside her, grabbed hold of Scorpia’s wrists and pushed her away.

“I’m fine, Scorps.” Catra’s tongue lapped around her own mouth, getting it stuck to the top of her mouth as she winced and sat up, reaching over to grab the purple water bottle on the desk. She flicked open the cap and drank nearly all of its contents to wet her cotton-dry mouth. “Why are you both staring at me like that?” She asked once she placed the empty bottle down.

“We were trying to talk to you for five minutes,” Perfuma explained and Catra's lips pursed. “This stuff is really strong, I shouldn’t have let you smoke so much,” Perfuma said and Catra burst out laughing. Her hand clamped onto her mouth as she snorted. Perfuma and Scorpia only stared at her with more concern. “Oh jeez, did you green out? Are you okay?” Scorpia asked and the question only made Catra laugh more. Tears began to sprout and she laughed until her stomach began to hurt. Either this weed was too strong, or Perfuma and Scorpia were just asking the dumbest questions known to man.

"Oh my god-" Catra inhaled loudly as she tried to calm her laughter . It worked for a moment. "No, this stuf f isnt too strong for me. No, I didnt green out and yes I am okay ." She answered between fits of giggles. So maybe she was higher than a fucking kite but who cared? She was having the time of her life. "Speaking of weed, can I buy some of this off of you?" Catra asked, turning to Perfuma as she straightened her slumped position. "It' s good as fuck."

Perfuma turned to Scorpia, then back to Catra. "I dont usually sell." She said and Catra frowned. She knew Perfuma sold because she had watched Scorpia buy from her before they began to date. Maybe she didnt consider them to be friends. Maybe she didnt actually like her at all. Maybe- "My friends get it for free." She finally said and Catra felt her heart jump to her throat as her eyes flickered to Perfuma's.

She must have tilted her head and stared at Perfuma with a confused look because the next thing she knew, Perfuma was placing a hand on her knee and smiling. "Y es, Catra. Youre my friend." The blonde giggled. Catra couldnt fight the smile that grew on her face as she nodded her head, colourful eyes flickering to the two blondes who sat in front of her. "Y eah..." She started.

"Y oure my friend too." She whispered. It felt weird to say . Almost like she was lying to herself. She felt vulnerable. But maybe that was

because she had just gotten used to only having two friends after losing so many. And now, she had three.

After watching another movie and binging out on junk food (Perfuma instead chose to eat a fruit platter to 'satisfy her needs for sweets'), Perfuma and Scorpia decided that it was best to head home as it was nearing six o'clock.

Catra agreed because her social battery had run out halfway through their second movie and so did her high. Plus, her mother and Sharon would be home soon. Catra still had to let her room air out and spray air freshener throughout the house to make it smell like she had cleaned it like she was supposed to.

As soon as her friends had left (yes, *friends*. Not *friend and friend's girlfriend*. Catra was relatively proud of that), she had begun doing a small amount of work to at least show that she didn't *completely* lie. She began to unload and load the dishwasher, wipe down the counters with Lysol wipes and take out the trash. The bag itself almost weighed as much as Catra did as the brunette huffed as she pulled it from the ground with both arms and waddled over to the back door. She threw the door open and walked out with the garbage bag in both hands.

The air was warm, almost a humid temperature filled the air and it made Catra's nose twitch and her lungs begin to feel heavy from the

thick air. As quick as she could, she flipped the top of the lid open and used her body strength to push and shove the garbage bag above her waist and into the filling bin. It dropped with a loud bang as she turned back to the door, her feet tapping against the cement path and she could feel small twigs and leaves that had dried out attach themselves to the striped socks on her feet.

As she grabbed hold of the door, a weak and piteous cry wept out from beside the recycling bin. Curious, Catra's ears perched up at the sound. With slow steps, careful to be light on her feet, scared to frighten the animal as she crept towards the blue recycling bin. Stuffed with the cardboard boxes crushed and squished down was a small, black fur ball shaking in its spot. Catra's mouth fell agape as she bent down and stared down at the kitten in the box.

A thousand thoughts ran through her head, and she didnt know what to do. She wasnt sure if the cat was hurt or not or if it was ridden with rabies as it was hiding in a crumbled box of Mott's Applesauce beside the recycling bin. Catra bit down on her bottom lip as she reached up to her hair and tied it back into a low and loose ponytail before resting on her bare knees.

Small pebbles pressed into her skin, but she paid no attention as she slowly reached a hand outwards, careful not to get attached and gently pulled the box away from the corner it was stuffed in. The kitten lifted its head, its ice-blue eyes staring at Catra as it hissed and swatted a paw at Catra. The girl reeled her hand back in time before its claws caught her skin.

“Hey!” The girl scowled. “I’m trying to help you.” She murmured almost annoyingly as if the cat was able to understand her. She poked her tongue out between her lips, allowing her tongue to coat the chapped skin as she stood up and darted inside, quick to make sure that by the time she came back outside the kitten wouldn't have run away.

She opened the hallway closet and grabbed a white fluffy towel from the top rack before running back outside. “Don’t scratch me I’m trying to help you. Okay?” She said as she unfolded the towel and lay it flat in her left hand, using her right hand to slowly reach into the box. The kitten hissed once again, and Catra’s hand twitched back but she bit down on her lip and allowed the kitten to reach its nose up and sniff her hand.

Its nose twitched and they hissed again, but ultimately allowed Catra to gently scoop their body in her hand, and lie it on her left as she quickly wrapped the kitten with the towel and held them close to her chest. She grabbed the box and checked inside of it to make sure that there weren't any more, and she let a sigh of relief out when she saw that there was only one. Although the thought hurt that this one had been separated from its family who was probably on the street as well. She frowned as she looked down at the kitten who was in a ball, almost like it was shielding itself from the world around it. Catra stood up and took the kitten inside.

She knew that if Sharon arrived home and saw the ball of fur in her house she would throw a fit and toss the kitten outside with no remorse. She hated cats. With her entire being. In fact, she hated almost every animal except the fish that she had in her office. Catra figured the only reason why she liked them was that they were silent and barely needed any care. Plus she made Catra clean the tank. She didnt do anything but feed them and stare. Her mother? Cỳra didnt like cats either . But she wasnt as cruel as Sharon was.

But this wasnt her home. Even if Cỳra came around to the idea (Catra knew that she would), her say wouldn't matter. For some reason, Catra didnt care about what Sharon had to say . Something inside of her had warmed up as she felt the kitten fall into her chest. Sure, it was probably jµst warm and tired from being outside for who knows how long but she didnt care. She accepted it even if it was for a short while.

Catra went into the living room and grabbed one of the decorative pillows so that she could place the kitten down without hurting them on the rough surface of the table she placed the dipped pillow down, followed by the cat. When Catra stood back up, her fingers poked at the small animal as she ran her hand gently down the kitten's matted fur.

She plucked small twigs and leaves from its fur, getting what she could as she checked for any cuts. Thankfully, there seemed to be none. That was until she noticed the jagged ear . One of the cat's ears had been cut off, leaving its left ear to be jagged and shorter than the other. Catra frowned as she leaned closer, her fingers

gently caressing the thin flap. It seemed to have healed but she couldn't help but feel her stomach turn at the thought.

Now that the cat was lying down in the light, there were a lot of things Catra didnt notice before. Like that this kitten wasnt at all a kitten, but an adult. The cat was scrawny and light, almost like a kitten and that was why she had mistaken it for one. The second thing was that *it* was actually a *he*. Catra had no idea how to care for a cat, much less a boy. All she knew was that they sprayed and all she knew was that she could *not* have this cat spray if she kept him. And that was a big if.

Catra pursed her lips as she began rummaging through her cupboards searching for any type of food. She had read a while ago that there were quite a few things that cats could eat. Tuna is the obvious one and surprisingly- bananas. It wasnt a pretty combination, but she figured Tuna would fill him up and a bit of banana would at least start him on the few nutrients and vitamins that he needed. The brunette stood back up, two cans of tuna in her hands as she grabbed two small bowls from the cupboard. One for water and one for food.

As soon as the cans had popped open, the cat's head perched up and his nose began to twitch as he smelled the air as the fish wafted through the kitchen. Catra looked back at him as he began meowing. "Calm down Im getting it."She laughed as she drained the water from the tuna cans and scraped it into the bowl. She wiped her hands on a washcloth before placing the bowl on the table in front of the cat.

He rolled onto his stomach from his previous spot on his back and arched his back, his claws digging into the pillow underneath him and Catra winced at the thought of Sharon noticing the scratch marks. His frail body shook and he wobbled as he took a step towards the bowl, dipping his head. He immediately began to eat the Tuna, a small ‘hom-nom’ sound with every bite.

Catra laughed at the sound, falling more in love with him. She filled the water bowl up and placed it beside his food which was almost gone. She reached a hand out and gently pet his back, feeling his spine. She frowned. “I’m sorry you were living in a box.”

She said as she turned back around and ripped a banana off of the cluster she peeled it back, used her fingers to gently pinch off a small portion and held it out for the cat to lick off of her finger which he did, before returning back to his tuna. Catra washed her finger before leaning against the counter, arms crossed as she took a bite out of the fruit and watched the cat drink.

“What the hell am I going to do with you?” She asked. The cat looked up at her, ice-blue eyes staring back into blue and amber. “I mean, if I could keep you then I would.” She trailed of f. “I mean, maybe I could.” The cat licked its paw , before meowing loudly. Catra opened her mouth to speak but was cut off by the doorbell ringing. “Y ou see that,” She pointed at the cat. “Y ou’re going to not be so loud if you wanna stay."

The doorbell rang again and Catra rolled her eyes, wondering who the hell was at her door. She quickly paused and looked at herself in the mirror. She was wearing an oversized black shirt, white fluffy shorts and black and purple striped socks as well as her glasses propped on the bridge of her nose. She contemplated ignoring whoever the hell was at her house but when the doorbell rang again followed by a knock, she knew she couldn't ignore it. Whoever it was knew that she was home *anyways*. The lights were on.

"Calm down I'm coming." She growled as she grabbed hold of the doorknob, twisting and pulling it open. Catra's eyes followed from the ground up to the person standing in front of her. Her eyes widened at the sight as grey-blue stared back into blue and amber. Adora stood with a blue binder in hand as well as a math textbook and some loose papers that curled in the wind.

"Hey , Catra!" The blonde gleamed and Catra blinked again just to make sure that she was seeing this correctly. "Adora?" She asked almost as if she didn't believe it. "Why are you at my house at"… Catra leaned back and looked at the clock on the wall. "...Nearly eight o'clock? And how did you even know where I lived?" She quickly added.

Adora's face turned red as she shut her eyes and smiled, laughing nervously. "Oh my god- I'm so sorry this looks super stalkerish." The blonde laughed and Catra gave her an awkward smile. Adora

opened her eyes and pointed a thumb behind her. "Adam drove me, trust me I didnt like- drive around to find you myself." She said.

Catra jumped to her tiptoes and peered over the shoulder of the tall blonde and sure enough, there was a red car parked in front of her house with the interior lights on. Adam gave her a small wave. Catra returned it before looking back at Adora.

"Oh!" She exclaimed as she held the books out to her. "I brought you your homework." She gleamed. Catra raised an eyebrow. This was 100% Adam's idea and she *knew* it. "That's not my binder." That was what she said, a finger poking at the blue binder in Adora's arms.

The blonde looked down at it for a second, before scratching the back of her neck. "I- I know. I just- I don't know your code and I didn't want to be like Hey Scorpia what's Catra's locker combo? 'yknow? So I just- it's my binder. I have all of the notes and I figured you'd want to take a..a picture of them or..or something." The blonde rambled as her face grew redder with each word. Catra couldn't help but smile and feel her own face grow hot.

Instead, she laughed. "Adora it's okay. I get it." She smiled and Adora copied. "Thank you." Adora smiled back at her. The two stood still for a moment, taking in each other's presence. Adora couldn't help but stare at the shorter girl. Catra's hair was pulled into a low

and loose ponytail, but most of the strands had pulled and fallen to frame her face. And she was wearing glasses.

Adora had never seen Catra wear glasses before and somehow she couldn't help but find her more beautiful with the frames that lie across the bridge of her nose. She wore a long shirt that nearly covered the shorts that she wore and Adora felt her face grow hot and her fingers fumble with one another nervously. Catra looked *beautiful*.

"S-so I wouldn't want to keep you waiting."Catra was the first one to break the silence. It took a moment for Adora to register that she had begun talking, but when she did she quickly nodded. "I mean- Adam can suck it up. Hell be fine and he cant leave anyways."Adora said and Catra laughed. "Eh, he deserves it."She joked and Adora laughed along with her. The blonde shot a look behind at Adam who was currently on his phone.

"He wont even notice."She said as she turned back to Catra, whose tongue poked between her lips. "Do you-"Catra started, but was cut off by a small thump in the background as a small, black cat came up behind her and began rubbing against Catra's leg. Both girls looked down and Adora's eyes almost sparkled.

"Oh my god- your cat is adorable!"She whispered as she bent down. "He isnt my cat."Catra bent down along with her , her hand gently

petting him. Adora held a hand out in front of him and without hesitation, he sniffed her and then pressed his face against her hand. "Whose cat is he?"Adora whispered as she pets him, a frown pulled across her lips as she felt his bones, her fingers finding his ear.

Catra shrugged. "I just found him today in an Applesauce box."The brunette explained as Adora looks up at her with a grin. "An applesauce box?"She repeats and Catra looks at her and nods. "Variety pack and all."They both laugh as Catra scoops the cat up in her arms and they stand up.

"Do you have a name for him?"Adora asks as she readjusts the books in her arm. Catra bit down on her lip. "Here, come inside. I cant take them right now but..." Catra paused, not knowing what she was going to say. Instead, she stepped out of the way for Adora. She could have sworn she saw Adora's face light up at the suggestion as she quickly looks back at Adam's car, now seeing that he was on the phone.

The blonde shrugged and smiled at Catra. "Okay ."

And with that, the two turned around. Catra felt her face grow warm as Adora shut the door behind her. Catra turned to look at her, watching as Adora eyed the house. It was nothing special. The floors were white tile and the walls were white too. The kitchen and front

porch were beside each other so the floors shared the same look. It looked like any ordinary rich person's house. Catra hated it. Her mother loved it. Sharon had no care as long as it was clean and looked like it cost money. "Your house is really pretty."

Adora said as she looked at Catra. The brunette gave her a tight-lipped smile. "Thanks. It's my aunts." She said and Adora tilted her head and gave her a cheeky grin. "Do you own *anything*?" She asked. Catra rolled her eyes. "Well, I have a bedroom and-" She held up the cat. "A cat now so." The two of them laughed as Adora kicked off her shoes and followed Catra into the kitchen. The blonde had to snap her mouth shut as she looked around in awe. Catra's house was *huge*. Maybe even bigger than her own.

The brunette placed the cat on the table (she would make sure to sanitize it after Adora left) and sat down. Adora followed, the chair scraping against the tile. Adora murmured a sorry for the noise which Catra ignored.

The two sat in silence, both petting the cat who seemed to love the attention he was getting. Their fingertips brushed against one another, and Catra felt her heart rate pick up. Her eyes flickered to Adora, who was already staring at her. Catra swallowed the lump in her throat and pulled her hand away and slipped it under the table. "So." She started. Adora followed her body language. "So"…

"We should name him," Adora said and Catra looked back at her. "We?" She whispered. Adora's face grew red and she quickly shook her head. "Well no- not- not we. I mean you. You should since he's your cat." Adora looked down and pushed a strand of fallen hair behind her ear. "So what were you thinking?" She whispered.

Catra ignored the fuzzy feeling in her stomach as Adora suggested that they name the cat. As if it was *theirs*. Something *they* owned. Together. She liked the idea of it and didn't bother to deny Adora's request. It almost felt like they were best friends again. The feeling scared her. She shrugged. "Maybe." She thought about it for a moment

"Melog." Adora's head shot up and a confused look was pulled across her face.

"Melog?" She repeated. Catra nodded. "Melog."

"Why?"

Catra shrugged. "I found him behind a recycling bin. Melog means mud I think. It fits." Adora burst out into a fit of laughter, her hand across her mouth as she giggled into it. "Oh my god, you are cruel!"

She ɒked and Catra laughed. "W ell, what? Do you have any better ideas?"

She asked and Adora nodded. "Y uh-huh."Catra crossed her arms and squinted her eyes. "Like what?"She asked. Adora mirrored her as she stayed silent, her lips pursed and the small crease between her eyebrows forming before she finally lit up.

"Applesauce."She said. Catra tilted her head and smiled. "Applesauce?"Adora nodded proudly . "Applesauce."

They repeated the previous conversation. "Y ou think Melog is a terrible name but you think Applesauce is better?"She asks, amused. Adora nods. "W ell, you found him in an applesauce box!" She defended. Catra laughed. "Y eah *and* in the mud!"

Adora scoffed. "Okay okay ."She pursed her lips as she stared down at the sleeping cat on the table. "How about.Melog Applesauce Meow-meow?"Adora suggested and Catra burst out into a fit of laughter and immediately the brunette shook her head. "Absolutely not."Adora pretended to act hurt with a hand on her heart.

"Why not?"She asked and Catra giggled.

"Because Melog Applesauce Meow-meow is a terrible name!" Catra exclaimed and Adora began laughing as she held her hands out, gesturing to her. "But you could be Catra Applesauce Meow-meow!" She whispered as if she had made the greatest discovery and Catra buried her head into her hands and shook her head. "I mean I like it. It has a nice ring to it." Adora joked as Catra peeked at her through slotted fingers. "I hate you." She teased and Adora grinned.

Their laughter continued to carry on as they watched a peaceful Melog sleeping. Catra's eyes flickered up to Adora as she watched her. Adora's bangs fell in front of her eyes and framed her face. Catra remembered when they first cut her hair. They both decided to give each other bangs (Or more so gave themselves bangs).

Catra liked hers, and Adora hated hers. And thus, the bump was formed. After that day, Adora wore her bangs pinned up instead of lying flat across her face. Although now, it looked like she had trained her bangs to be in the middle part instead of completely across her forehead like before. Catra liked it. It was new and it suit her. Catra always loved Adora's hair down. Catra loved anything Adora did with her hair. But she especially loved it down and when it fell across her shoulders.

"Melog is a good name," Adora whispered as she looked up. Catra smiled at her and looked back down at Melog to avoid eye contact. "Yeah?" She asked.

Adora nodded her head and swallowed the lump in her throat. "Y eah."

Catra looked back up at Adora. The two continued to stare at one another, Grey-blue against blue and amber. The perfect combination of colours, the perfect palette. One with the colour of the sky, and one with the colours of the ocean and rich honey. Suddenly, the honking of a car caught their gaze as their heads snapped upwards. Their faces flushed red as they both stood up. "Uh- thanks again, Adora," Catra said as she brought a hand up to her head and scratched at her scalp. Adora shook her head and smiled. "No worries. I wanted to." She whispered and Catra nodded slowly .

Adora bent down to slip on her shoes as Catra looked back at the kitchen table, spotting Adora's binder. "Oh, shit-" Catra cursed, quickly swiping the binder off of the table and grabbing it, before holding it out to Adora. The girl gave her a confused look as she eyed the binder, then Catra. "Y ou need the notes." She said and Catra shook her head. "Adora Im not taking your binder . It's Friday." Catra said and Adora shrugged, pushing her hands into her pockets. "So? Y ou need the notes."

Catra rolled her eyes as she pushed the binder into Adora's chest. "Just." She bit her lip and shut her eyes. W as she taking a risk? Yes. Would it be worth it? She had no fucking clue. "Add me on

Snapchat and send me it there.”She whispered as she pulled out her own phone, handing it to Adora.

The blonde's face lit up almost like a kid in the candy store and Catra secretly prayed that she would hurry up before she changed her mind. Maybe Spinnerella was right. Maybe her mom was right. Maybe Adam was right. But what if they were all wrong? What if instead of this being the best decision, it turned out to be the worst? Catra’s nerves ran through her body and she felt her hands grow clammy. Was it hot in there? Or was she just freaking out over something as small as Snapchat?

“Here, I added myself.”Adora handed her phone back to Catra as the brunette stared at the annoying blonde emoj that was smiling back at her. She quickly shoved her phone into her pocket and gave Adora a quick smile, before bidding her goodbyes to the blonde.

Catra shut the door behind Adora and closed her eyes, exhaling through her nose as she placed a hand on her forehead before walking back over to Melog. She sat down and rested her chin on her crossed arms on the table.

“Did I make the right choice?”She asked him. Melog didnt answer . All he did was place his nose against Catra’s and a purr rumbled his body. Catra smiled and shut her eyes.

Her phone buzzed in her pocket and she slid it out, looking at the new notification on her screen.

(*adora.gray added you back. Say hi !*)

Chapter End Notes

Melog and Catra Applesauce Meow-meow supremacy

Chapter 6

Chapter Notes

> so let me start off with an I'm sorry. During Easter break, I spent it with my partner so i wasn't able to update or even continue writing. And then I got into a major writers block that I am still trying to get out of which is why this chapter isn't the normal length. It's still pretty long, but it's not almost twenty pages like usual. I've had the first half of this chapter in my google docs since April 7th and I just finished and it's May 13th (happy Friday the 13th guys) and I'm not sure if chapter 7 will be out on Wednesday because of this huge shift that happened but hopefully I get back into writing this book again and get back to uploading weekly. Once again I'm sorry for the month and a half hiatus.

(*c.driluth added you by username*)

Adora smiled down at her screen, her binder tucked under her arm and her phone in both hands. The blue light that emitted from her screen illuminated her face and outlined the blood that had rushed up to her cheeks. She quickly added her back and hid her phone in her hands as she opened the car door with a swing and grin. Adam raised an eyebrow at her as she crawled into the red Coupe.

"You were in there for a while." He started with a wiggle of his eyebrows. Adora scoffed, rolled her eyes and clicked her seatbelt into place. "For your information, she found a cat and we named it."

She informed with a smile and a shake of her shoulders. Adam tipped his head to the side. "So you're telling me," He paused and smiled. "Cat got a cat?" Adora turned to him, an unamused smile on her face as she exhaled through her nose loudly. It slowly turned into chopped and breathless laughter, despite fighting it.

"Dont *ever* let Catra hear you say that please."

"No, I am 100% going to bug her about this." Adam laughed and Adora did too as the boy put the car in drive and sped off. The two sat in the car almost in silence excluding the faint hum of 'The Beatles' playing from Adam's aux. Adora bit down on her bottom lip. She was bubbling with excitement and it felt like she was being pulled down with quicksand the longer she stayed silent. Adam seemed to notice her leg bouncing up and down because when they pulled into the driveway, he locked the doors and gave her an inquiry look.

"What happened?" He asked. Adora seemed caught of f guard by the locked doors as her seatbelt slowly slid off. She turned to him.

"What do you mean?" She bit down on her lip. It hurt, but it calmed her. Adam's head fell to its side and he stared at her with a vexed

look. Adora felt herself begin to sink into her seat. There was no point in lying to Adam. He could read her like he could read a picture book played out in front of him. She was as clear as glass to him, as he was to her.

"Well, you're fidgeting in your seat, you won't leave the insides of your cheeks alone and you look like you saw a ghost."He pointed at her face and it was only then that Adora noticed she was in fact, gnawing at the inside of her cheek.

She stopped and glared at Adam. "If you unlock this door Ill tell you." She smiled sweetly but Adam didn't buy it. She scrunched her nose and her hands slipped from the door handle and her body fell against the leather seats.

"Fine."She huf fed. Adam smiled satisfactorily and leaned back in his seat, mirroring Adora. Nerves began bursting across Adora's body like little pockets of air. Her heart felt heavy, fat even and stuck in her throat. Her hands and stomach were sweating and sticking to her clothing.

Adam seemed to notice Adora's rising and falling chest as her eyes became glossed over. He slowly reached up and placed a hand on her shoulder. Adora turned to him and a silent tear slipped down her cheek.

"Hey , Dor it' s okay. You dont have to tell me."He whispered and Adora shook her head. "No. No, I have to tell you. Y ou're the most important person in my life."She croaked and Adam felt his own heart grow heavy with worry. Instead, he smiled. "Hey , youre the most important person in my life too."

Adora laughed and smiled. She wiped her tears and inhaled deeply, preparing herself to finally tell someone other than Bow and Glimmer. This was the real deal. This was her twin brother and next was her mom and dad. "Adora?"

Adora leaned forwards, Adam's hand slipping from her shoulder. "I'm going to tell you something and you cannot freak out because I am already doing that."She said. Adam grew intrigued as he nodded. "...Okay? Now Im scared."He joked, but Adora' s face remained muted.

"I won't freak out."

"Thank you."

Adora ran a hand through her ponytail. "I remembered something." She whispered, avoiding Adam's eyes as they dilated. "It was just a stupid detail of how Catra stole the lead from Glimmer in fifth-grade bu-"

She didn't get to finish. Adam had wrapped his arms around her and pulled her into him so tightly that her chest felt like it may have burst.

"You said you wouldn't freak out." She choked out. Adam sniffled from under her. "Shut up." He whispered as his face buried into her shoulder. She could feel a drop of something wet land on her shirt and within seconds the both of them were crying tears of joy.

It didn't last long, but it was a moment of vulnerability and pure love. It was something special.

Things immediately changed.

After Adora told her parents about the news, they immediately started to bawl and pull her into a rib-crushing hug. They didnt leave her side and she must have repeated the same sentence over and over again. *‘Catra stole the lead from Glimmer in the fifth grade*.’ She was starting to mumble it randomly to herself from the number of times the words fell off of her tongue.

It was Saturday morning and the faint smell of pancakes made Adora’s nose twitch, her stomach growl and her mouth begin to water as the thought of pancakes made its way into her dream. Her very *lovely* dream. With Catra. In her bedroom. On her bed.

Adora’s eyes snapped open and her body sprung up like someone had tied a rope to her chest and yanked. Her chest rose up and down quickly, and her skin was hot to the touch. Adora brought her folded hand up to her cheeks and as she suspected, they were warm.

The blonde pulled the fisted blankets into her chest and fell down with a bounce, her hair cascading everywhere. Her bottom lip was pulled between her teeth, her blue eyes following the patterns in her ceiling as she tried not to think of the dream she had woken from.

It didn't work. Adora frowned, groaned then pulled herself out of bed with a drag of her feet. The wood beneath her was cold and it travelled up to her barely covered legs and arms.

She shivered and grabbed a large, fuzzy blanket from the end of her bed and wrapped it around her shoulders as she hopped down the wooden stairs. '*Madonna* 'was playing from the Alexa' s speakers and she knew her mother was in a good mood.

Adora's lips pulled into a small smile as she watched her mother dance around the kitchen, her head and shoulders bopping as she stood over the stove.

Adora laughed and gained her attention. Marlena's smile only went wider as she entered her arms out and motioned for Adora to come over.

She obliged, grabbing her mother's hands and that was how she found herself dancing to Lucky Star 'in nothing but a pair of shorts, a tank top, and a fuzzy blanket thrown over her shoulders with her mother at ten in the morning on a Saturday.

Catra’s morning did not start with pancakes or dreams of Adora in her bed.

Catra’s morning started with her hand in her hair and her face pressed deeply into the pillow beneath her. Her curtains were pulled shut and she had a blanket folded over her head to keep the light from seeping in.

“Catrina Lucia D'riluth baja aquíahora mismo!”:: *Catrina Lucia D'riluth get down here right now!* : The brunette let out a groan followed by a long moan into her pillow as her eyes slowly peeled open. Her mouth was cotton dry and her body was still asleep due to the feeling of numbness that spread across her body.

She reached a hand out from under the blanket and felt for her phone, before grabbing it and pulling it under the covers with her. The brightness from the screen caused her to flinch and groan as her pupils adjusted to the blue light.

The first thing she checked was the time. It was one in the afternoon, frankly still too early for the brunette as she only fell asleep at around five in the morning.

The second thing she checked was the number of notifications she had gotten while in Do Not Disturb. She didn't bother to open any apps or turn it off.

Only when her name was called once again was when Catra fully heard. Her body shot up and her hand reached outwards to the end of her bed, her heart was pounding in her chest and it only settled when she felt the matted fur of the cat still peacefully sleeping.

She let out a breath she wasn't aware was being held and slid her legs out of the blankets earning a mew from the cat for disturbing his sleep. Catra glared at him. "Hate.":: *hush*:: She whispered at the scrawny animal who almost immediately rested his head back in his paws and fell asleep.

Catra's eyes turned to her bedroom door and it was days like these when she was thankful that she had a lock. You know because everyone takes stray cats into their cat-hating aunts' homes and hides them in their room.

Catra reached down to the floor and grabbed the black hoodie from the ground as well as an elastic ponytail which she put her matted hair into a low ponytail. Her phone slid into her pocket and her glasses slid on top of her nose as she stood up and unlocked her bedroom door.

The wooden tiles are cold under her feet, even with the socks that covered them and the brunette shivered. “Catra!” Cyra shouted again, this time her voice was more stern. Catra hurried her pace and bounced down the stairs.

“What?” She asks as she rounds the corner into the kitchen. Cyra was leaning against the counter with two cans of empty tuna and an unimpressed look on her face. Catra’s hair stood on the end of her skin. “W ould you please tell me why there are two cans of tuna empty?” She asks and Catra goes frozen.

“I made a sandwich.” The brunette lies as she slides into the kitchen and into the dining chair, staring up at her mother.

“T wo cans?”

“I was hungry .” Catra shrugged. Cyra eased up as she playfully scoffed and rolled her eyes. With a clink, the cans fell into the recycling bin. “I was going to make tuna casserole with those.”

She says and Catra perks a brow. "Doesnt Sharon hate tuna?" She asks and Catra scrunches her nose. "It isnt for her." Cyra spins around and suddenly Catra understands why her mother's face had begun to grow brighter and why she had turned away.

"Oh my god- is someone coming over?" Catra asks with a wide smile. Cyra brings a hand to her hair and scratches it before spinning around with a shit-eating grin as she nods her head like a child. "Y es."

Catra brings a foot up and kicks the chair in front of her, the wood sliding against the tile and gestures to Cyra to sit. She does. "What' s his name?"

The teen asks, crossing her arms. Cyra mirrors her except with more of a giddy bounce. "His name is Thomas." She answers and Catra's nose crinkles. Cyra notices this and immediately goes to defend the man but it's already too late.

"Thomas?" She asks. "What kind of generic white man name is that?" The teen asks with a rasp. Cyra rolls her eyes. "Did you meet him on a dating site?" Catra raises her brows.

"No." Cyra deadpans, her face flat before it rises again. "We ran into each other at the coffee shop and he paid for mine." She answers, slow with her words as Catra listens. Something inside of her rippled and she didn't know what it was.

She was happy for her mother, truly. She had been alone since Catra's father had left them when she was just a kid. Cyra was always too busy raising her and trying to make ends meet while running a restaurant. She never had time to go out for new love.

New love. Maybe that was what caused the ripple. It had always just been the two of them. Cyra and Catra. Catra and Cyra. Sharon barely even counted, she was just a housemate. But this 'Thomas' guy? A duo would turn into a trio.

Their little family would be adding one more and probably three more after that. Catra knew how this went. Mom meets step-dad, step-dad and mom have kids, the oldest kid of mom gets forgotten because there's not enough love to go around and make it to her.

Catra swallows the lump in her throat and stands up from her chair, cutting Cyra off from her rambling. "Catra? Are you okay?" She asks. Catra avoids her eyes as she glared down at the ground. "I'm fine. I'm going to my room." Without another word from Cyra besides the shout of her name, Catra runs up to her room and locks the door.

She’s greeted by a low purr and a furry head swiping across her leg. The brunette gives the cat a small smile as she slides down to the floor and picks the cat up onto her lap. She reminisces the night she found him and the smiles she and Adora shared too. Catra pets the purring cat and rests her head against the door.

"Y ou won't forget about me too, right Melog?”She whispers. And as if Melog answers, he meows and piles onto the girl's thighs.

“*Please*?”

Adora cried, following her mother around the house with her hands pressed tightly together and a pouty lip. Marlene shot a look at her. "Everyone is going and Im finally getting my life back!"

The blonde exclaimed, her hands falling to her sides as Marlena shook her head. "The answer is no, Adora.”The woman said sternly

as she fluffed the decorative pillow. Adora's face fell.

"Why not?"

"Because I said no." Marlena dropped the pillow down with a sigh. She was growing annoyed with the girl following her around like a lost puppy begging for something she had already said no to. Clearly, Adora was growing annoyed too by her mother's answer.

"But Adam will be there! I won't even drink, not a drop I *promise*." Adora begged as she threw her twin under the bus. Adam must have heard his sister's desperate cries of approval as he strolls into the living room, arms crossed and leaning against the doorway. "What's going on?"

He asked. Adora spun to look at him and Marlena tipped her head. Before she could say a single word, Adora had cut her off.

"Adam, please tell Mom that you won't be drinking so I can go to the Sea Hawks party." The blonde begged a gentle bounce of her shoulders and a whine in her tone. Adam's eyes flickered to his mother, who was crossing her arms and staring at Adora with a disapproving stare.

"Adora the last time you went to a party you ended up in the hospital," Marlena said and she pointed a finger at Adam. "And who said you could go?"

"Dad." The boy answered and Marlena pursed her lips and squinted her eyes at him. "Of course he did." She muttered before turning to Adora.

"You arent going."

"You wanted me to try to live my life and be a happy teenager and you're not even letting me do that!" Adora shouted.

"Adora *enough*."

"Adam, please tell her that you will be driving, that we wont be drinking and that we will be home by eleven pm sharp." Adam pursed his lips, being caught in a difficult situation. One, side with his mother and be ignored by his twin for the next week or two, side with his twin and get disapproving stares from his mother for a week.

“Adora’ s right, Mom.” He said and Adora’ s face lit up. “Y ou told her to try to get back to normal and no offence, Dor , but being known as the ‘girl who lost her memories’ isn’t exactly a title you want to carry out till college.” Adora rolled her eyes. “I won’t be drinking, I’ll be coming back before midnight and I’ll keep Adora by my side until then. But she should at least attend a normal party since her last one didn’t exactly end well.”

Marlena opened her mouth, then shut it again. She did this for the next few minutes, growing fearfull for the twins before she sighed and looked at Adora. “No drinking, stay with your brother and for the love of god please don’t get into anyone else’ s car.”

Adora began smiling as she engulfed her mother in a hug and thanked her excitedly. She only rolled her eyes and hugged Adora back before the blonde pulled away and turned to her twin. Once her mother was out of sight, he winked at her and the two threw on their shoes and headed for Adam’s car.

“I can actually leave your side tonight, right?” Adora asked as she clicked her seatbelt. Adam looked at her and started the car.

"Please do."He smiled and Adora copied. The radio began blasting, and they began driving to Sea Hawks farm.

Chapter 7

Chapter Notes

 That's all i have to say for this chapter

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Music could be heard from a mile down the road.

Adora hadnt been to a party in so long. The last time she had been to one was the night of the crash. Her mother had come to pick her up and she wound up in the hospital. Adora's throat began to tighten and her heart began to pound louder and louder as they drove up to an empty spot in the field, the car running along with the bumps of grass.

Adam put the car in park and turned it off, now leaving them in the silence of their voices and the muffled music. Adam turned to his sister, who was staring straight ahead. His face fell.

"What' s wrong?"He asks. Adora turned to look at him and realized that she had been frowning. She replaced it with a smile. "Nothing." She said as she bent down to unbuckle her seatbelt. Adam followed cautiously.

"Look, Dor we can go home. W e dont have to go in."He said. Adora ignored him as she climbed out of the car. Adam quickly followed her. "Adora-"

"I'm fine, Adam."She snapped. "Leave it alone."Adora turned, her ponytail swishing as she dug her hands into her pockets and stalked off. Adam watched her with a disappointed frown, before quickly following her.

The liquor burned as it crawled down her throat and dropped into her empty stomach.

Maybe drinking on an empty stomach wasnt the best idea but who was going to know that? Exactly. She needed to get shit-faced. And drinking on an empty stomach? That was the way to go.

Catra held the remaining liquor in her mouth as she stood next to the drink table, a litre of Pepsi in one hand and a bottle of Vodka in the other. She poured, mixed, swallowed her remaining drink and then took one from her freshly made one.

She didnt know where Scorpia or Perfuma was. Hell, she didnt even know where Entrapta was. She had lost them almost the second they had gotten there which was over an hour ago. Entrapta went one way, tablet in her hands and Scorpia and Perfuma ran the other and into the dance floor.

So naturally, Catra had floated to the drinks and snacks. She sat there, leaning against the wall beside the table, her right hand holding the blue solo cup and her left dipped in the Sour cream and Onion chips.

Day n Nite' by Kid Cudi was currently blasting through the speakers and Catra couldnt help but watch, amused at all of the bodies on the floor, absolutely drunk and jumping while shouting the lyrics. She would give it to Sea Hawk. His parties went hard.

"Catra?" A voice asked. Mismatched eyes looked away from the dance floor, lingering, before falling on a much taller blonde. She felt her heart drop and suddenly, she wasnt as drunk anymore.

"Adora?" She asked, her words coming of f a bit slurred as she pushed off the wall. Suddenly, instead of being drunk or sober, she felt *sick*. Like her head was spinning and she was going to upchuck the chips she had eaten as well as the large quantities of alcohol she had confused in the hours of being here.

Everything was coming back to her, no everything was *crashing* into her. The party. The drinking. Adora. Except for this time, it was *Catra* who was shit-faced and it was *Adora* helping her stand up. Catra hadn't even noticed that Adora had caught her stumble before she could fall into the drink table.

The brunette looked up, faces inches apart. Catra could smell the mint toothpaste that lingered on Adora's breath (and something else sharp) and she could see the gloss that perfectly defined her full lips. She felt her heart leap and she stood up straighter. Adora let go of her but didn't tear her eyes away. Stormy Blue stared down at her with concern.

"Are you okay?" Adora asked. Catra ignored her.

"What are you doing here?" She asked as she leaned against the wall to stabilize herself, allowing her body to slip from Adora's grasp. The blonde stayed in her spot, before finally taking a step closer and leaning against the wall beside her.

"You answer mine and I'll answer ours." Adora retaliated. Catra rolled her eyes but smiled. "I'm fine. I just had too much to drink." It wasn't technically a lie. She would be able to pull it off as she *was*

drunk. But what was she supposed to tell her? ‘ *Oh yeah, just remembered the last party where we got into a car crash. No biggie* .’

Catra could feel the heat emitting off of Adora and onto her and she could feel the friction between their arms which were just inches apart. Catra turned to look at her and Adora’s eyes followed. "Your turn."She whispered, almost like her voice was caught in her throat. The blonde’s head rested against the wall as she stared down at the brunette.

"Well, it’s the weekend. Glimmer and Bow would be here and I didnt want to be alone in the house with my mom."Adora explained. Catra hummed in response and brought the cup to her lips. "And where's Sparkles and arrow boy now?"

She muttered her words echoing in the plastic. Adora shrugged beside her. "No clue."She frowned. Catra looked back at her and her face too fell as she watched the smile slip from the blonde's full lips. "Hey."She nudged her shoulder into Adora’ s. "My friends ditched me too."

The smile that was once played on Adora’s face came back and with it, and so did Catra’s. She loved Adora’s smile. She always had. There was something about Adora in general that brought a sense of warmth and security into any room that she walked into. Hell, they

weren't even friends and yet Adora still gave Catra that feeling. And when she smiled? Or even laughed? God the world zoned out and nothing else mattered but Adora.

Suddenly, Catra got an idea. She put her drink down on the table and grabbed Adora's hand, linking their fingers. "Follow me." She smiled.

When Adora walked into the house, she was expecting a group of sweaty teenagers grinding up against each other to loud music. She was correct.

There was barely enough room for the blonde to twist and turn her body to slip through the crowds that formed. It was nearly impossible when everyone started to jump up and down to the music that raged.

She had left Adam back in the yard, she was sure he would be fine. Thankfully for Adora, she was able to straighten her pack, crane her neck and peer over most of the bodies. In the sea of people, she was easily able to spot the vibrant pink and blue hair standing next to each other.

She muttered out a few apologies as she slipped through the crowd and made her way over to her friends. “Adora! Oh my god, you came!”

Glimmer slurred as she wrapped her arms around Adora, bringing her head down and placing a sloppy kiss on her cheek. Adora placed a hand on the top of Glimmer’s back and helped her stand up straight with a chuckle and smile.

“How much has she had to drink?” Adora asked, having to be louder than the music surrounding them. Mermista shrugged and drank from her solo cup. “Glim, here.” Adora looked to her left and saw Bow with a bottle of water and a handful of chips.

“Oh hey , Adora!” He gleamed cheerfully once he spotted the blonde. Adora helped Glimmer sit down on the window seat with Bow helping her. He then sat down beside the pink-haired girl and handed her the unscrewed bottle of water.

“Drink this.” He said. Glimmer brought it up to her nose and smelled it. “What is it?” She asked and then suddenly took it away from her face and stared at Bow with a perplexed look. “I’m not drinking water , I'm not thirsty.”

Adora rolled her eyes and laughed at her drunk friend. Bow pursed his lips. "W ell, good thing it's not water."He said, growing quiet as he thought of what to say. "It' s Vodka."Adora raised an eyebrow at him and the boy shrugged his shoulders and tipped his head to Glimmer who also shrugged and began drinking it.

Bow looked at Glimmer, a certain glint in his eyes as he rubbed her back and fed her chips to help sober her up. He then looked up at Adora who was standing with her hands in her pockets and looking around.

"She' s over by the drinks."Bow states and Adora turns to look at him. "What do you mean?"She asks, confused. Bow gives her a dud look. "Y oure constantly looking around and going red at the first sight of any 53 brunette. Go before Glimmer sobers up and kills me."

Adora goes red at the fact that Bow had caught on to her movements. She stands still for a moment before her lips twitch into a smile. Bow gives her another nod, and Adora glances back at Glimmer and suddenly feels guilty for even thinking of leaving her friend in this vulnerable state.

"You know what, it's fine. Ill see her at school." Adora says as she goes to sit beside Glimmer but Bow blocks her with his leg. Adora frowns. "I've got Glimmer . Plus, Catra doesnt look too good." He gestures to Glimmer, explaining that Catra was in the same boat as their friend. Adora takes a deep breath in, then exhales.

"Glimmer won't know?" She asks. Bow shakes his head.

"Know what?" He fires back with a smirk. Adora goes to open her mouth to speak but snaps it shut at the realization. She smiles.

"You dont know how much I love you right now ." She exasperates as she turns around and picks up her pace, sliding through the bodies, craning her head up to search for the kitchen and then apologizing for bumping into people. It's a loop until she finally gets out of the crowd.

Near the kitchen was less crowded, yet more filled with smoke. Adora winced, hoping that it was just various students vaping rather than Sea Hawk setting his tablecloth on fire. Again. The music was also softer, not so loud and vibrating as it was on the dance floor. She kind of liked it better than where her friends had chosen.

Adora walked to the edge of the table, her eyes grazing across all of the bottles of alcohol and bowls of chips. There were crumbs everywhere and spilled liquor and Adora was just thankful it wasnt her party. The blonde reached out, grabbed a mini solo cup and poured Vodka into it. She was never a drinker. But she thought about the last time she had drank and decided that she deserved to have fun.

Adam was right. She didnt want to be known as the girl who had Amnesia. So, she downed the shot and then took another before she could change her mind. The clear liquid burned down her throat and sent a blaze into her stomach. Her face twisted in disgust and she did a small shutter. Her body felt warm and maybe she shouldnt have taken two shots.

With a twist of her head, she scooped the area before landing on a short brunette leaning against the wall with her hand limp in the chip bowl. Adora couldnt help but smile as she watched Catra bring a chip up to her face, examine it and then place it on the tip of her tongue.

Adora had never seen Catra so vulnerable before, it was kind of cute watching her play around with her chips before actually eating them. But as cute as it was, She knew she couldnt leave her like this.

Adora walked closer to her and shoved her hands in her pockets. Her heart began beating faster. "Catra?" She asked. The brunette's eyes snapped up, then finally found her own eyes. Storm Blue stares into a pair of honey amber and ocean blue. Adora was still mesmerized by Catra's eyes no matter how many times she saw them. She often found herself getting mesmerized by them.

"Adora?" Catra stood up straighter, her eyebrows furrowed as if she didn't believe what she was seeing. Suddenly, Catra lost her balance, one hand smacking into the table and her body nearly following. Adora rushed over to her and wrapped her arms around the fragile girl's waist, holding her up with her hands.

Catra seemed shocked, stunned even by the course of action. Her breathing got heavier and Adora grew more concerned. She had never seen Catra drunk before, what did she do if she just- passed out in her arms?

The brunette looked up, faces inches apart. Adora's eyes bore into Catra's, although Catra's eyes were not on hers. They were on her lips. Adora felt her heart sputter, maybe even stop and her stomach took a flip. Her face exploded in a bright blush and she prayed Catra was too drunk to notice it. Suddenly, Catra pulled herself from Adora and straightened her body, her eyes now on Adora's.

“Are you okay?” She asked, concerned. Catra only ignored her , causing Adora to frown.

“What are you doing here?” She had asked instead, almost impulsively, before stepping back and leaning against the wall with her back pressed. Adora contemplated moving or staying but ended up taking a step and standing beside her. She hadn't even noticed how close she was to Catra until the brunette moved and she felt their arms brush. Her heart fluttered once again.

“You answer mine and I'll answer yours,” Adora smirked, her eyes scanning Catra’s face. The brunette rolled her eyes and Adora even heard a scoff. She bit down on the inside of her cheek then opened her mouth to speak, but snapped it shut when Catra smiled.

“I'm fine. I just...had too much to drink.” Adora nodded her head and pursed her lips. Catra continued to eat chips and Adora hoped that the carbs were helping her sober up just a bit more. Catra turned to look at Adora and the blonde allowed her eyes to follow. Now, the two were staring at one another. Catra pulled her bottom lip between her teeth and let out a whisper.

“Your turn.” Adora pulled her eyes away and rested her head against the wall as she stared down at the brunette. “Well, it’s the weekend. Glimmer and Bow would be here and I didn't want to be alone in the

house with my mom."Adora explained with a shrug. Catra let out a small snort and Adora smiled just a bit.

Catra hummed and brought the cup to her lips. "And where' s Sparkles and Arrow boy now?"

She had asked. Adora could have told her the truth, tell her that they were just across the room but she had a suspicion that Catra would just send her away . And Adora wanted to talk to her. Catra had *finally* begun warming up to her and she wasnt going to fuck it all up now.

So instead, she shrugged. "No clue."Catra looked back at her and frowned, before giving her the best welcoming smile she could muster. "Hey."Catra' s shoulder moved up into Adora's. "My friends ditched me too."

Adora felt bad for lying. She didnt know that Catra had been the one to be ditched whereas she was the one to do the ditching. The blonde suddenly began to feel guilty as she opened her mouth to speak, but was cut off by Catra grabbing Adora's hand.

Their fingers linked and something familiar sparked up her fingertips to the top of her head as she looked down at their hands. Her cheeks went bright red and her mouth was stuck gaping like a fish but fell into a smile as Catra pulled her into the dance floor, giggling. "Follow me!"

"What are you doing?"Adora asked with a laugh as the two came to an abrupt spot in the middle of the dance floor. Catra let go of Adora's hand and the blonde immediately missed the warmth that came with it. Catra began to move her body, her hips swaying and her feet following in the same direction. Her head was bobbing up and down going along with the music.

Adora smiled as she watched her, standing completely still. She stuck out like a sore thumb by being 5"1 1 and standing like a complete idiot. Catra seemed to pick up on that.

"Dancing dummy . What does it look like?"The brunette shouted over the music. Her words were less slurred now but they still werent clear as they would be if she were sober. Catra suddenly stopped and tilted her head to look up at Adora.

"Y ou look stupid."She deadpanned. Adora' s mouth opened and she wondered if she should have felt hurt by it. Instead, she laughed, her tongue running over her top teeth. "Oh okay is that how it' s going to be?"She asked while slowly moving her body to get into the rhythm.

She had never been a good dancer. Her body was stiff and it didn't move the way Catra's did. So when she did what she called "dancing", Catra raised her eyebrow at her and began to laugh.

"You are *terrible*!" Her voice was raspy and she kept laughing before even finishing her thought. Adora faked a gasp and pretended to act hurt, but the act fell when she saw Catra giggling to herself.

"You are so mean to me!" Adora laughed. Catra dropped her hand and poked her tongue out between her lips. Adora watched as Catra's tongue grazed across her filled lips with a quick swipe and she felt herself frow red. The blonde quickly turned her head away from Catra but was brought right back when she felt a pair of hands on her waist.

Adora's eyes shot down to Catra's hands which were lightly touching her hips as if she was afraid Adora was like. Like she would break. "Here." Catra whispered but it was loud enough for Adora to hear. *Only* Adora. It was like they were in their own little bubble as soon as Catra pulled Adora closer to her.

Adora didn't know what she was doing. She blamed the two shots she took. The blonde took a step closer to Catra, allowing their hips

to nearly touch. Adora's nose was centimetres from Catra's forehead. If Catra decided to look up, their lips would be brushed away. Adora kind of wanted it to happen. No, she *begged* for it to happen. Her chest was thumping heavily, her hands felt a bit sweaty and her stomach was fluttering at the way Catra's hips moved along Adora's.

"Like this." Catra's voice cracked. Her words cut off into a whisper and she took a deep, shaky breath. Her fingers trembled above Adora's hips and they were still hovering over her as if she were glass. Catra began moving and with her body and hips went her hands and Adora's hips. Adora allowed her body to relax under Catra's touch and feel vulnerable in the middle of the dance floor. She began to grow hot. She would blame it on the fact that they were dancing so closely in the middle of every other sweaty body, but she would be lying.

Adora lifted her hands and placed them on Catra's hips. Her fingers trembled as they lay across Catra's lean body. She could feel every curve, every muscle and every movement that she made that vibrated up her legs. It was in this moment, chest to chest, hips to hips that Adora was truly able to look at Catra. The girl in her arms was truly beautiful. Freckles exploded across her face, most prominent on the bridge of her nose and even a few specks by her temples.

Catra has a dimple. A dimple on the left side of her smile that Adora had only just noticed and her tan skin glowed under the colourful lights that bounced off of the walls. Pinks and purples roamed across

her face and when they did her eyes sparkled. One a vibrant blue and the other a honey amber. Adora had never met anyone with heterochromia. She was happy Catra had been the first. Specks of green flickered in the amber, almost like it was waiting for the right time to come out and shine. Adora hoped she would be there when it did. Catra was undeniably-

"Beautiful."Adora' s voice broke out. It was a whisper and she wasnt sure if Catra had heard her. The brunette's body stopped and she let out a shaky breath. Adora swallowed. Hard. The brunette tipped her head up, her nose brushing against Adora's and she felt her heart stop.

"Adora,"Catra whispered. Her name barely reached Adora' s ears but as her eyes were trained on Catra's lips, it wasnt hard to read. Her name slipped off of Catra's tongue with an exhale, almost as if Catra had been waiting for that moment. The world around them seemed to stop. Nothing in the world mattered but the two of them. And Adora was okay with that.

"Y eah?"She whispered back. In a room full of people drowning in loud music, it was almost silent. And they were alone. It was them against the world at that moment. Or maybe the shots she had taken were finally catching up with her.

Catra’s eyes were on Adora’s lips. She hadnt even registered the fact that Adora had answered her. All she could think about was how Adora’s lips were slightly parted, she was releasing shaky breaths the more they closed the space between them and how their bodies were pressed against one another. Oh, and Adora’s hands were on her *waist*. Catra didnt know what she was doing.

What was she *doing*? Why was she dancing with Adora, their chests pressed against each other and their lips only inches apart? Everything felt good. It felt *right*. God she had wanted this for so long and now she was here. All she had to do was lean up and close the space. If she did, everything would change. Everything was already changing the month she and Adora had reconnected. She loved it and she never wanted it to go away. She wanted to stay there forever. Or for as long as she could. Maybe it was her own selfish needs fueling this desperation inside of her.

Catra’s eyes flickered into Adora’s eyes, but they never met. Adora’s eyes were on Catra’s lips. She pretended not to notice the fluttering in her stomach. “I…

Adora’s eyes finally lifted to meet hers. Just lean up. It was all she had to do. It was all she had to do to close the space between them. And as much as the thought scared her, it seemed like Adora wanted it to. Maybe *just* as much.

"Catra," Adora's voice was barely a whisper. It barely left her lips. Catra barely heard it. The blonde lifted a hand up and away from Catra's hips and brought it to the side of her face. Her thumb stroked Catra's cheek, tracing her freckles and the brunette felt her heart explode in her chest. Her knees felt weak. Her heart was pounding.

She wanted to kiss her. Adora's thumb found its way underneath Catra's chin as she manually tipped Catra's head upwards even more so. The brunette's stomach tightened at the contact. She was hot. Her clothes were sticking to her body and her hair was plastered to her skin. She swallowed the lump in her throat. Adora's lips parted.

"Catra I-" She was cut off by a male voice calling her name. But like Catra's name was cut off, so was Adora's. Catra felt stiff in her place as the two girls pulled away from one another and turned to look at Adam who was staring at them with widened eyes. A girl, just a few inches taller than Adam was also staring at them. She had dark brown hair that reflected auburn in the light and tanned skin. Catra had to guess that the girl holding Adam's hand was the girl he had been obsessing over.

"Hope we didnt uh- interrupt anything." Adam started, his eyes switching from Adora to Catra. The brunette avoided looking at him as she knew what he was thinking. Instead, she shook her head

before finally bringing her gaze back up. "No. No, you didn't." She wrapped her arms around her body.

Adora stared down at the brunette and felt her heart sink just a little. The interaction between the two of them meant something to her but apparently, it didn't mean anything to Catra. The blonde shoved her hands in her pockets and tried not to let her nails dig into her skin.

"Yeah. You didn't interrupt anything." She added. Catra turned to look at Adora, but stopped and turned back to Adam as she pressed a tight-lipped smile on her face. Adam turned to look at the girl, giving her a raise of his eyebrows before bringing her in closer to the two girls.

"Okay well, since you're both here" He started. "Adora, Catra meet Teela." Adam introduces. Teela gave them a small wave and the girls reciprocated. "Teela, this is my twin sister Adora and this is my best friend Catra." Catra gave Teela a small smile before it turned into a smirk.

"Ah, so you're the one who he's been obsessing over." The brunette teased as Teela looked over to Adam, watching as his face burst into a bright red. The blonde shot a glare at Catra but she only continued to smirk. Teela smiled and snaked an arm around him.

“A we you talk about me?”She asked. Adam turned to look at her as he began stumbling over his words. Catra and Teela made eye contact and immediately started to laugh. Adora watched the two interact and although she didnt fit in, she let out a small laugh too.

“Dont listen to her . She’s been drinking.”Adam said. He brought a finger up to Catra’s forehead and pushed it away. She swatted at him and stuck a tongue out. “Speaking of, do you have a ride?”

Catra looked around the party with pursed lips as she slid her hands into her back pockets. “I havent been able to find any of my friends so I am not sure.”She informs.

“Okay , then you can just come back with us.”Adam shrugs and turns to look at Teela as if she was okay with it. Catra assumed she would be spending the night at their house as she nodded her head.

“Y eah of course. It’s your car.”Adam smiled and quickly kissed her cheek. Catra watched out of the corner of her eye as Adora recoiled and faked a gag. Adam only shot her the middle finger as Catra and Teela laughed. “Okay well, well be in the car”.Adam started as he began turning his body. Before he was able to be completely hidden,

he shot Catra a wink which she returned with a glare. The two disappeared while giggling and whispering.

"So."Adora started. Catra turned to her . Now everything was awkward. Catra had sobered up and a part of her instantly regretted how she had acted. But if anyone asked, it didnt happen. "I dont have to go if you dont want me to."

The brunette said and it caught Adora off guard as the blonde head pulled back and her eyebrows furrowed. "What? Why wouldnt I want you to come?"she asked. Catra frowned.

"Because of what happened..?"

Adora looked to the ground and opened her mouth to speak but shut it again. Catra was starting to grow nervous with the girl's silence. But finally, she spoke. Catra wished she hadnt.

"It was nothing. Dont worry ."

Chapter End Notes

You thought they were gonna kiss huh😔
this entire chapter came out from this other book I'm writing where Adora is a fuckboy and there's like- sexual tension and shit so that's where that inspiration came from suddenly LMAO

Chapter 8

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

“It was nothing. Don’t worry.”

It was nothing so why was Catra still hanging on to those five words? Those seven syllables? Catra should have known. But *Adora* was the one leaning in. *Adora* was the one who moved closer to her. *Adora* was the one who was staring at her with that look first.

She did all of those things *first*. So how come it was nothing to her? Maybe it was all in her head. It was ridiculous to think that even for a second that Adora had liked her. Catra was drunk. Maybe Adora was too.

No Catra wasnt drunk. She had begun sobering up the second she saw Adora. And Adora? That sharp hint of something lingering on her breath turned out to be Vodka. Adam was the one to identify it and everything made just a bit more sense.

She wasnt in her right state of mind. It was a heat of the moment thing. Adora didnt like her. Adora was caught up with everything. And so was Catra.

She was sitting at the dining table, her finger tracing the marks on the wood. She hadnt been to Adora’ s house in so long. She hadnt sat in this chair in so long. It felt like it had been years and in reality, it had only been one. 342 days since she last stepped foot in the residence.

The last time she came here was the night of the accident. It was the grade eleven kick-of f’party . Adora was wearing a red dress that gave her a high neckline. Her hair was in a ponytail, her bangs were pinned back and she had a gold star clip to secure her ponytail. She looked absolutely beautiful that night.

And it was Catra’s favourite night. They danced the night away, they snuck drinks in like all the other teenagers and they ate chips and candy until their stomachs hurt. Catra had gotten her license a month before.

It wasnt her first time driving back home from a party , but it was the first time she had been caught in a storm while behind the wheel. What went from being her favourite time went from being the most unforgivable thing in her life.

"Catra?" The brunette tipped her head up to look at the blonde, pulling herself out of her thoughts. Adora was staring down at her, a small smile on her face. She had changed out of her clothes and put on a white T-shirt with a unicorn on it and a pair of matching shorts. Her hair was in a low and loose ponytail and her bangs were shielding the sides of her face. In her hands was some clothing.

Catra smiled at her and stood up. Adora held her hands out, allowing Catra to take the soft fabrics. "Thanks." She whispered. Adora just gave her a small smile and bounced her shoulders. "No problem, really." She reassured. "The bathroom is just down the hall and the guest bedroom is beside it."

She explained. Catra felt her heart pang. *I know*. She wanted to say. "I can show you if you want." The blonde gleamed and Catra just gave her a small nod, afraid if she spoke she would start to cry.

The two girls had left the dining room, Adora switching the light off behind them as the two ascended the stairs. "My parents are at their friend's house for the night. Something about board games and wine."

Adora laughed and Catra tilted her head in realization. "Yeah, I'm like 99% sure my mom is hosting it." She laughed. Adora's head whipped back to look at her.

"I cant believe our parents are friends and we've never met."She said with a sigh. Catra's stomach tightened and she stopped in her place.

She felt the bile begin to rise in her throat and she must have looked like a deer in headlights. Adora seemed to notice the body that had stopped as she turned to look at her, confused.

"Catra? Y ou okay?"She asked. Catra swallowed the rising bile and ignored the stinging in her heart. She quickly nodded.

"Y eah, Im okay . I was".She paused. "Adora there' s something you need to know."Adora tilted her head to the side and stared at her .

"Okay?"She shrugged a shoulder and gave Catra a smile. "What is it?"Catra opened her mouth to speak but quickly snapped it again.

She shook her head. "I just wanted to thank you for letting me spend the night here. Scorpia and Perfuma werent answering their phones and Entrapta didnt take hers.. so thank you."She lied. It technically

wasn't a lie though. Everything she told Adora was the truth. But it wasnt what she wanted to tell her .

Adora smiled and bobbed her ponytail. "Y ou dont have to thank me, Catra."She said. Catra opened her mouth to speak, but Adora cut her off before she even could. "Y oure my friend now ."

The blonde gleamed and suddenly started to laugh. Catra was confused. Was there something on her face? Oh *god*, Adora was lying. *Of course, she was*. Catra doubted that they were friends. The brunette frowned.

"Cat you should have seen your face you all like-"Adora tried to imitate what seemed to be Catra's scared expression but had failed miserably. But Catra wasnt focused on that. She was focused on the fact that Adora had called her *'Cat'* .

The nickname she had given her at the prime age of seven. Catra almost thought she had remembered it but then realized Adam still called her that. The realization made her frown a bit but she stopped when she noticed they were in front of the bathroom. For how long? She couldnt tell you.

"Oh right! This is the bathroom!" Adora held her arms out to showcase the room. Catra grinned as she opened the door with a push, flicked on the light and set her- Adora's clothes down. "And just right there is the guest room." Catra poked her head out and looked to where Adora was pointing.

She knew where every room in this house was. She knew where Adam's room was, where their parent's room was, hell she even knew where they kept their survival gear that was tucked away in the damn seller. She could name every room and get them all right. She had grown up here.

She and Adora had grown up here. The guest bedroom was where they would make a giant fort because it had a TV in it and a king-sized bed. It was where they would have sleepovers since Adora's bed was never big enough.

It was where they hung out in their little blanket fort until they turned thirteen and Adora got a bigger bed, and a TV and they started to slip out of her bedroom window and sit on the roof. They did that until they were sixteen and seventeen.

"And right there is my room." Catra snapped out of her thoughts, her eyes turning to Adora. "What?" She asked. Adora was balancing on her feet, switching her weight as she tucked her hands behind her back. It wasn't very hard to miss Adora's room.

There was a giant ‘A’ on it with kids' handprints. Three pairs. Two blondes and a brunette. Three peas in a pod. Three best friends. It was Catra, Adam and Adora’s hands. Catra’s eyes felt like they were about to tear up so she looked down to the ground and at the fuzzy socks that covered her feet.

"The guest room can get kind of cold sometimes. Especially since it’s October so if you ever need another blanket or...somewhere else to sleep...my room is open.”Adora whispered. Her face had blown out to be a blushing red and it spread to Catra’s face as the brunette looked up at her and smiled. Adora didn't turn away from the floor.

"Thanks, Adora.”The brunette said. This time, Adora looked up. She smiled, gave her a small nod and then with a quick goodbye she was gone into her bedroom. Catra watched the bottom of the door for a moment, watching Adora’s shadow pace in front of it before it stopped and the light switched off. Catra swallowed the lump in her throat as she took a step back into the bathroom and locked the door behind her.

As soon as she was shut inside the small room, she allowed herself to break. Tears began streaming down her face and her sobs were caught in her throat. It hurt. Her throat felt like there was a rock stuck inside of it and her eyes felt like there were chemicals infused into her tears.

She had cried so much that it began to hurt. She had small rashes from the salted tears at the corners of her eyes and her cheeks always felt itchy. And now? It physically *hurt* her to let it out.

The brunette sat on the floor, her back against the small edge of the wall as she brought her knees to her chest and rested her head. She tried to blink away the tears, no longer wanting to cry but it was nearly impossible.

She brought her hand up and wiped them away and with them went her makeup. When she stood up, her mascara had been smudged and of course, the corners of her eyes were red. Catra opened the second drawer and peered into it.

Inside were all of the guest items including a spare toothbrush and a packet of makeup wipes. She grabbed both things as well as a tube of toothpaste and set them on the island. She shakes out one last shiver before bringing her hands to the hem of her shirt, about to take it off before a soft knock on the door startles her. She jumps a bit and stares at the wood with widened eyes.

"Catra?" Adora's voice muffles through the door and the brunette lets out a sigh of relief.

"Jesus *Christ* you scared me, idiot." Catra hissed, not meaning to sound as pissed off as she did. Thankfully, Adora didnt take any offence to it.

"Sorry . But I forgot to tell you that there's a new packet of toothbrushes and toothpaste in the second drawer." Catra looks down at the already secured items but still, she opens the drawer.

"Oh. Thanks." She calls, sliding it closed. It seemed pointless on her end but Adora seemed to believe it. Catra could practically see her gushing face from the other side of the damn door.

"You're welcome!" The blonde exclaims. Catra smiles and looks down. "Goodnight, Cat."

Catra stays silent for a moment, before finally whispering,

"Goodnight, Adora."

Adora’s clothes were baggy on her.

The pants that she had given Catra hung off of her hips and reached past her ankles, nearly dripping on the floor. She had fixed it by bunching the waistband up but even then they still hung off of her small frame.

It was odd how just a few years ago they were the same size. Well, Adora had always been at least a size bigger but that never stopped Catra from wearing her clothes. In fact, she was wearing the same shirt she had worn at their last sleepover. It used to fit her a lot better but after the accident, it seemed like all of her clothes were a bit too big for her.

Catra spits the toothpaste out into the sink, rinsed her brush and then put it along with her other clothe before flicking off the light and leaving the bathroom.

The wood was cold under her feet and sent a shiver down her spine as she tiptoed down the hall and into the guest room. She was met

with carpeted floors as soon as she entered the guest room as well as a cold atmosphere.

Catra let out a yawn and a shiver as she tensed her body and waddled over to the dresser where she placed her day clothes and the toothbrush. Despite the cold, Catra didnt crawl into the warmth right away. Instead, she stared at the room. Her eyes slowly lingered across every aspect, every piece of furniture.

The chair in the corner where Catra would always put her schoolbag. The bedframe where she hung fairy lights and pictures of her and Adora. They had kept the fairy lights but like every memory of her, the pictures were taken away. Torn down. Tossed.

Catra bit down on her bottom lip, her eyes glossed over as her fingers slid off of the oak dresser which once held her clothes. She walked over to the closet and pulled it open. Her eyes had adjusted to the moonlight fairly quickly, making it a bit easier to see in the darkroom as she stood on her tiptoes, reached her arms out and grabbed a small box that was tucked underneath a thick winter jacket and hidden behind a toolbox that she assumed to be Randor's. It was difficult to lift the heavy objects, but she managed to push them aside as the much lighter box fell into her grasp.

The terribly painted box was light compared to the one she had at home. When she and Adora were fourteen, they made each other

boxes to put all of their favourite keepsakes in. This was the one that Catra had made Adora. The front had a light purple and blue background and in thin black paint had been a drawing of them. Even then Adora had the stupid hair poof and Catra's hair was just as wild and thick as it was now.

Some things never change. But at the same time, didnt everything change?

Catra sat down on the edge of the bed and peeled open the lid. She set it aside as she began looking through the contents of the box. She was met with letters from Catra to Adora and even small doodles they had done in class. Catra smiled as she peered into the memories that were contained. There were pictures of them from all the years they had been friends and even pictures of Catra and her mother with them at Disneyland so many years ago.

As her hand swept across the sheets of paper and printed out photos, something hard smacked her knuckle. The brunette winced at the quick pang as she grabbed hold of whatever she had hit. When she pulled it out, she instantly began to smile. Maybe even tear up a little. The rock that Catra had thrown at a group of girls who were bullying Adora for being picked for the boy's team. It was a bundle of misogyny in a group of five eighth graders who were laughing because she had a more masculine build than them.

Catra had picked up the thickest rock she could find and tossed it at the girl who was pointing a finger and laughing. It had hit her right in the forehead and Catra was sure that to this day Octavia had a scar across her skin. She swiped a finger across her eye and caught the tear. She let out a small laugh, before placing the rock back into the box and covering it with the lid once again. Catra put it back into the closet, covered it back up with everything and shut the door quietly to keep from waking anyone in the house up before crawling into the bed and sliding underneath the covers.

Adora hadnt been lying when she told her that the room would be cold. The covers were cool and made her body shiver underneath them as she pulled them up to her chin and wrapped them around herself rather tightly. Her nose pressed into the shirt she wore and the smell of Adora filled her nose.

Adora's clothing smelled of laundry detergent- lavender and a hint of her perfume. Catra wondered if she had sprayed some of it on the articles of clothing before giving them to her. Catra missed wearing Adora's clothes. It was always her favourite because they were always soft and they hung off of her just the right amount.

And they always smelt like her. Everyone had a certain scent. Adora smelt of a sweet flower field mixed with a rich forest. She was both. Both feminine and masculine. Catra loved it. She always had and whenever she had smelt the familiar scent of Adora, she knew she was safe.

It must have been why the second her eyes closed and her head hit the pillow, she fell asleep.

Chapter End Notes

> This chapter definitely isn't very... action-packed but it's one of my favourites despite it being a bit shorter than the others. I'm so excited for them to become closer and I just love how although Adora doesn't even know it, she's slipping back into her old ways subconsciously

chapter 9

Chapter Notes

ITS BEEN ALMOST A WHOLE YEAR HI
I took a hiatus bc i got majorly heartbroken (LMAO) and then I got played like two months ago so here is a.. quite fun chapter :)

"You do realize that you almost *kissed*, right?"

Adam harshly whispered as he leaned closer to Catra, despite already being nose to nose in the stuffed kitchen pantry. Catra whacked his arm and glared up at the boy. "*Yes!*" She hissed and crossed her arms over her chest in frustration and embarrassment. Her mind had been racking over the moment ever since it happened and it even crept into her dreams that night. When she awoke, her body was covered in a slick sweat as if it was a nightmare and in every sense, it was.

"I don't want to talk about this, Adam." Catra croaked, arms crossed and fingernails running across her elbows. Adam leaned back into the shelves and let out a saddened sigh. The brunette felt guilty as if she had taken advantage of Adora at that moment. The way she knew almost nothing while Catra knew almost everything. Every detail while Adora was picking up the pieces day and night, trying to pick her brain for any inch of her memory.

"Cat," Adam said, "What's on your mind?" Catra looked up at the blonde as she leaned back against the shelves, boxes of cereal and pasta pressing into her spine. She shrugged. "I'm not sure." She answers honestly. By the tilt of his head, Catra knew he wasn't going to take her answer.

"I feel wrong for what happened between Adora and me." She confesses, speaking her thoughts. She knew no matter what she had confessed to Adam, he would never judge her for them. He simply nodded as she continued, allowing her words to roll out of her mouth freely. By the time she had finished explaining everything about last night's events, Adam was no longer paying attention. Yet another common factor among the twins; they could never stay focused.

Catra frowned but knew she could not stay mad for too long. Instead, she sighed, knowing she was able to get what was on her mind off of her chest whether it was heard by the ears of others or not. The brunette reached out to grab the handle of the pantry and as she turned and pushed, a force from the other side of the door pulled at the same time, causing her to gingerly smack her head against the oak wood with an *oof!*

Catra brought her hand up to her forehead and rubbed the already forming bump as Adora began profusely apologizing and asking Catra if she was okay (*she wasn't.*)

"Oh shit, I am so.. so sorry , Catra."Adora' s eyes were wide and full of sincerity but Catra couldnt help but return with a glare and a snarl. "Whatever . Now Im going to have a stupid bump to pair with my outfit."Catra pushed passed Adora, who tried to talk to her but Catra simply ignored what she had to say. Yeah, it was unfair of Catra to be this way towards Adora as Adora had no idea why she was being this way. But again, Catra didnt do feelings.

She stared into the mirror hanging in the hallway and sighed as she gently grazed her fingers over the bump practically jumping of f of her forehead along with the bright red ring around it. From behind her, Adora came into view with dipped eyebrows and eyes filled with concern. Catra almost felt bad. She looked up, smiled at Adora through the mirrored glass and said;

"The bruise is gonna look fucking sick."She could see from the corner of her eye that Adora had stepped forwards, coming closer to her. "Looks like you got your ass kicked."

Adora teased, a mischievous smirk painting across her blemished lips. Catra turned to look at her, her neck craning. Adora's lips stay in their position, but her eyes drooped down. That was her cocky face. Catra had seen it more and more as they got older. When Adora was feeling smug, her face showed it all.

"I beat your ass once I can do it again, Ador-" Catra's mouth snapped shut. Her eyes widened, pupils dilated and her heart began battering against the cage it was concealed in. Adora's face twisted from smugness to flat-out confusion. Catra could see the wheels turning in her brain. Adora may be dumb but she wasn't a flat-out idiot.

"Wait," She paused, her eyebrows thrown together and her head tilted. "What do you mean?"

Catra opened her mouth to speak, but the words didn't come out. The cat had her tongue.

"Nothing, forget I said anything." Catra quickly shifted behind Adora, making her way to the black bag that sat on the floor. She picked it up and swung the front door open so fast her arm nearly pulled a muscle. "Catra wait- what the *fuck!*"

Adora ran after her. Catra was almost halfway down the street when a gruff hand grabbed hold of her bicep. Spinning her around, Catra stared up at Adora with shock and fear displayed in her eyes. Adora's eyes went from their usual, cerulean blue to a dark shade of grey as they stared down at her. "Tell me."

Catra’s eyes fluttered. “I do not know what you mean, Adora.” She said, voice growing stern as she clenched her jaw . Anger rising. She could tell that Adora was becoming the same way by the way she let go of Catra’s arm and placed her head in her hands, fingers running through her hair.

“If you know something, tell me.” She demanded. Catra remained cold. “I don’t, Adora. It was a joke. Fucking relax.” Adora’ s jaw clenched as she was now glaring. The brunette felt fear and guilt crawl up her throat. She had to get out of there. She turned on her heel and picked up a fast pace. It only made Adora follow.

“No. No, you don’t get to make a joke like that and not fucking explain it.” The blonde cursed, growing more agitated the faster Catra walked and the longer she pretended to play dumb. Adora knew that Catra had meant something, but the girl wasn’t budging. If she did, she was damn good at avoiding speaking about it.

“Can you, I don't know , leave me alone?” Catra shot back, head twisting to look at the blonde. Adora groaned angrily and reached out, grabbing Catra’s arm once again and spinning her around to be face to face. They glared at one another, the tension between them filled with anger, regret and frustration. “Let go of me, Adora.”

Catra seethed, her eyes moving from the hand around her arm to the face it belonged to. Adora didn’t move, nor did she lesson her grip.

She was staring straight down at Catra, and the brunette knew at that moment, Adora could see right through her. She already knew Catra was lying about something. It was only a matter of time before Adora figured it out due to her careless amount of mistakes.

"Not until you tell me what the hell you meant Catra," Adora demanded once again. The brunette rolled her eyes and scoffed. "Are you dumb?"

She asked. "I said it was some stupid joke. Adam told me you got picked on as a dumb kid and I wouldn't be fucking surprised if I was one of them." Catra ripped her arm out of Adora's grasp as the blonde stared down at her with disappointment.

"You don't say that shit or make those jokes around someone who you know doesn't remember a single fucking thing about their life." Adora snapped. "That's not what friends fucking do."

Catra shook her head and laughed a bit, an amusing smile across her lips. Adora was confused. But it was all made clear when Catra opened her mouth.

"You think that we're friends?" She asked, half amusingly. Adora didn't know what to say. Weren't they?

"Please, Adora. *We* are not friends. Adam and I are friends." Catra stated with a certain venom laced within her words. Adora felt a premature pain in her chest. "You're just his twin sister who has to follow behind because you have *nothing*."

As soon as the words left Catra's mouth, she instantly regretted them. Nothing she said had been true, not in the slightest. The look on Adora's face had told Catra all of it. Tears formed in her eyes and her bottom lip quivered as she tried so desperately to fight the breaking feeling inside of her. It was the lowest blow that Catra could have shot at her. For someone who was trying to fix things, she seemed to be only making them worse.

"Thanks, Catra." That was all Adora responded with. The blonde shoved her hands in her pockets and turned. Catra could hear the sniffles and the choked-back sobs as Adora walked away from her.

Catra couldn't help the tears from falling down her face. She had fucked up.

chapter 10

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

The next week and a half at school had been hell. Not just for Catra, but for Adora as well. The blonde had gotten home and was immediately bombarded with questions from Adam and comfort from Teela. She had wanted none of it. She never told Adam what Catra had said, but he knew she had done something. Adora didn't want to tell Adam because he knew they were friends and she never wanted to come between that.

So, she stayed silent. And so did Catra.

The entire week, Adam had been on her ass trying to figure out what happened between the two of them, how he was confused because they were finally starting to become friends again and suddenly they hadn't looked at each other or even spoken one syllable. "Catra, come on. Adora wont tell me what happened and-"

"If Adora of all people wont shut up about it what makes you think I will?"She snarled as she got to her locker . She twisted in the code, unlocking the box just as a hand slammed it shut. Adam was leaning against the locker, a desperate look on his face. "C'mon Cat. Please I just.."

He paused for a second. “Adora won't talk to me, you won't talk to me, and all I know is that my sister is sitting up in her room, barely eating, barely coming out. And from the looks of it, so is my best friend.” With that remark, Catra looked down at her clothes. They were the same ones she had worn all week, and her hair had been tied in a bun that hadn't been brushed through since last Monday. It was Wednesday.

Her clothes had undeniably gotten bigger on her frame and the bags under her eyes signified her lack of sleep. Catra licked her lips, dry and cracked as she opened her locker once again as Adam removed himself. “So just tell me. I'm losing my mind here.”

Catra grabbed her books and shook her head. It was too early to be caught up in an emotional battle between the Grayskull twins. She slammed the locker shut and glared up at him. “This is between me and your sister. Stop shoving your nose into everyone's business just because yours is so fucking boring. Kay?”

The brunette turned away from him and angrily hurried her pace, trying to run from the situation at hand. But that was easy for her. Running away. From down the hall, Catra heard Adam scoff.

"Oh, that makes sense."Catra stopped and looked back at him. "What?"She had asked. Adam walked closer to her , making sure no one but the two of them could hear.

"You were a complete jackass to her because you'd rather run from your feelings and run from your guilt."Catra swallowed the lump in her throat and felt her eyes begin to gloss over. Adam was completely right. She was running away. She realized that whatever feelings she had for her were still there, deeply buried and the longer she spent with Adora, the faster those would come into the light. And Catra dreaded for that to happen. It was the same with her guilt. Adora's own mother took the fall for her, saying she was the one who crashed. She had never owned up to it to Adora, she still didn't know the truth.

"You don't know anything about me."She said, trying to grasp onto whatever sense of ground she had. "Don't act like you still know me after all of this time."She glared at him, standing in her spot. Adam licked his teeth and hugged his backpack closer to him, walking over to her.

"Know you or not, you need to make this right. Because I know damn well this version of you isn't who I want to be friends with."Catra avoided Adam's eyes but she knew that he was staring down at her. "You can't run forever."A hand was placed on her shoulder and Adam gave it a tender squeeze before walking off to his first period. The bell had rung, yet even the loud shrill was not enough to get Catra to move her feet in the direction she needed to go. She felt

humiliated. The consequences of her actions were catching up to her in the form of a boy who hated conflict, but yet stood in front of her and told her what everyone already knew. She angrily wiped her eyes and headed for the girls' bathroom.

Inside the washroom stall, Glimmer Moon had been perched up on the toilet seat, her face in her knees and her hands shielding her eyes as free-flowing tears dripped down her blush-catered cheeks.

She had failed her Calculous quizThe one thing threatening to kick her off of the Soccer team and now, it just might. She was failing the glass miserably and refused a tutor. She understood what to do, but she couldnt compute the larger numbers without a calculator ready to use when the numbers began getting bigger with more decimal points than she could understand.

Unknowingst of the two girls’situation, Catra had come rushing in, chest heaving up and down, watered eyes and her fingernails digging into the strand of her bag. Her fingernails scratched at the empty spot on her arm, scraping until her skin turned raw. She refused to cry anymore, only allowing a sniffle to escape. This caught Glimmer's attention as she looked up and wept. "Occupied! Whoever just walked in please leave!"

Catra tore her eyes from the tiled floors and looked at the closed stall in confusion. It had been a voice she recognized, but a voice she did not want to hear. "Pretty sure the school bathrooms are a public space, Sparkles." Catra's voice broke without her knowledge.

Glimmer's head snapped down to look under the stalls, seeing a pair of dirty black sneakers and a mismatched pair of socks. "*Catra*?!" Glimmer nearly shouted, her voice filled with arrogance and disappointment. Catra sighed and slid down the bathroom wall, sitting down. She didn't care if Glimmer didn't want her in here. She just needed a concealed space. A way from Adam and away from the world. And the chances of Glimmer staying knowing Catra Driluth was the one in the shared bathroom were slim to none.

"Don't sound too excited." Catra teased, in a low monotone voice with no hint of amusement. It confused Glimmer. " *Oh, ho ho* absolutely not. You are the *last person* I want to see right now!" Glimmer barked, her angry tone bouncing against the bathroom walls. Catra scoffed and got up.

"You know what, Glimmer?" Voice raised, "I am sick of your dopey fucking hatred towards me. I did absolutely nothing to you and you know it. *Get off my fucking dick*." Catra slammed the door open, the metal handle smacking against the tiles but before she could even take a step, Glimmer had emerged from the stall. Her face beat red, presumably from the rising anger seething from her body. Her hair

was tugged on and Mascara smudged under her eyes. She looked *worse* than Catra if that was possible.

"You ruined my best friend's life!" She burst, rage consuming her every word. Catra turned back to her, letting the door close by itself, a shocked expression plated across her face. "You were drinking. You were driving. You had barely driven on your own and you still drove that night in the storm."

Catra felt a pang in her heart. "Adora wouldn't have been in a coma for months, she wouldn't have had to do physical therapy and try to remember her childhood because of *you*!"

The girl knew Glimmer blamed her for the accident. She knew everyone did. So what she was saying wasn't wrong. Catra knew all of this, she knew she had ruined her life but hearing it after their most recent fight made her nearly crumble to the ground. But she held strong.

"No. I'm not doing this shit with you." She laughs, "You were not her childhood best friend. You did not grow up together, you were not in love with her, and you were not by her side all of these years!" Catra laughed, tears clouding her eyes. She hastily wiped them before Glimmer could see and give her another thing to judge. "And most importantly, you do not have to live with the guilt that you almost

killed your best friend. You didnt have a lifetime of memories with her so please, do not act like you fucking know what loss is.”

Catra turned away and opened the bathroom door, leaving a stunned Glimmer. Of course, Catra had lashed out on her before, many times actually. The two had never been the best of friends, only associating with each other through Adora. And now, their mutual connection had been severed. There was never any reason to reach out or even be friends. What shocked Glimmer was not the tone Catra held in her words, but it was *what* she had yelled, disguised under all the guilt and pain. And for some reason, it had never even crossed her mind that there was so much more to Catra and Adora's relationship than they had all assumed.

Glimmer practically had to wait all day to meet up with Bow alone. The entire day, Adora had clung to their side. Something had happened, but she refused to say. It had gotten to the point where Adam had asked them, and they had no idea what to say. The blonde had yet another doctor's appointment that day and so finally, Glimmer could share the new information she had been overflowing with the entire school day.

"I dont understand, Glim," Bow whispered as he put his books in his locker. Glimmer rolled her eyes, "What is there not to understand? Catra *admitted* that she was in love with Adora!" Bow sighed and shut his locker as the two of them began walking out the back doors. "I know that."

"But what are we supposed to do with that?" He asked. Glimmer pursed her lips. "I mean, Adora wouldnt remember that. She's just now getting sporadic flashbacks. And besides, if Catra doesnt even want Adora to remember their *friendship* why would she want her to remember their *relationship*?"

Glimmer quickly got in front of him, walking backwards now. "That's the thing! I don't think they were ever *in* a relationship. Think about it, why wouldn't we know? Why wouldn't her family?" Bow raised his eyebrow at her. "Because not everyone's families or friends support their involvement with the same gender...?"

"Bow," Glimmer held her hands together. "We are bi, Perfuma is a lesbian, Mermista and Sea Hawk are also bi and Adam is pan. Why the hell *wouldn't* we support when our entire friend group is every letter in freaking LGBTQ?!" Glimmer heavily exclaimed and Bow cocked his head to the side to subtly agree. But still, he shrugged.

"Or maybe, they just wanted it to be hidden."

Glimmer scoffed. "It' s *Adora* and *Catra* . If they were dating we would see the proof on every corner."She said as they made it to Bow' s car. They got in.

"Then I don't know , Glimmer."He sighed. "What's your point even?" Glimmer finished buckling her seat belt and turned to him with a '*duh* !expression. "Catra had some kind of feelings for her before and even now probably, so."She dragged on. Bow could tell he did not like where this was going. "If we convince Catra that Adora likes her too, *maybe* that will make Adora's brain wake up and ta-da!She gets all her memories back and *the end*!The three of us go back to how everything was, no more hiding. This *nightmare* can finally be over!"

Bow shook his head. "No. Glimmer , you cant just *use* Catra's feelings for some dumb experiment that most likely would never work."He explained and Glimmer frowned. "And why should we care about Catra? She's the one who *did* all of this. Adora would have been completely fine if she didnt get into that car with a drunk driver."

The boy rolled his eyes and scoffed. A hand went to his forehead. "What?"Glimmer angrily asked. Bow looked at her and shook his head. "Glimmer , Catra and Adora were best friends even *before* we came into the picture. There are so many things wrong with this plan, for starters, using Catra's feelings when we don't even know if Adora felt the same. And what happens if it did work? Do you really think

Adora would ever let Catra go? If she remembered, there would be no trio.”

"Oh please, ever since Catra spoke up for her in class Adora has been pining over her."Glimmer rolled her eyes and shrunk back into her seat. She knew Bow was right, but she chose not to believe him. She knew her plan would work. And if Bow wasn't going to help out, then she would do it herself. "If I was the one in the crash, I would never forgive the person who knowingly drunk and decided to drive in a storm. *Even* if it was my best friend.”She said, crossing her arms. She looked out the window and stared off into the soccer field. A shadow emerged, followed by a brunette girl wearing a baggy sweater and pyjama sweats. Glimmer ’s eyes brightened as she unbuckled her seat belt. Bow had been talking, but she hadn't listened to a word he said.

"I'll be back.”Glimmer opened the car door and eagerly got out. Bow stared at her, confused until he saw the head of pink hair jogging over to a familiar face.

Catra had skipped the rest of her classes. The music room had opened up after lunch, so she had stayed there with a reserved spot for the rest of the day. It was nearly four when she had decided to leave, using the back exit as a way to avoid anyone she knew. Including Scorpia and Entrapta. Although she was sure that Scorpia

was with Perfuma and Entrapta had stayed in the lab like usual. That’s how it was most days. They rarely hung out, but they were still strong.

She had hoped that she wouldnt bump into someone she knew while taking the long way, but of course, not even God had been on her side the past few months. "Catra!"

The brunette stopped in her tracts and pulled a face as Glimmer was quickly approaching her. She saw Bow quickly following behind her, trying to catch her attention. "Come to yell at me some more for ruining an innocent human's life?"She deadpanned. Glimmer was now standing in front of her. The pink-haired girl shook her head and innocently smiled. "No. Actually-"

"Glimmer!"Bow had finally caught up and he was panting from the short run from his car t the field. Catra began to wonder how he had made it on the soccer team with such short stamina. Glimmer turned to look at him, but Bow kept his eyes on Catra. "Oh, hey Catra. Didnt ah- didnt see you there."It was clear that Bow was a terrible liar.

"Arrow boy ."She greeted, one eye closed due to the sun shining into it. "Always a pleasure when Shimmer and Friends are around." Glimmer rolled her eyes at Catra and opened her mouth to speak, but was gently elbowed in the side by Bow. Catra raised an eyebrow

and knew that they had something planned. She knew whatever it was, it wasnt going to be good. Either they were going to lure her into an abandoned alleyway or they were planning something worse.

"What the hell do you guys want?" Catra asked, growing impatient and just wanting to get the *hell* out of the conversation. Glimmer spoke up and it was the thing Catra dreaded most. "We were wondering if you wanted to come out and grab a coffee sometime."

Catra raised an eyebrow, a smile playing on her lips as she let out an airy chuckle. "What?"

"Well, were all friends with Adora and-" Bow started, but Catra didnt let him finish "Adora and I are not friends. We havent been since the two of you came along." The girl snarled angrily , taking Bow and Glimmer back. Confused and dreadful expressions painted their face like sad Russian dolls. Catra rolled her eyes. "Dont act so shocked. You have hated me ever since the fifth grade and pretty boy over here just followed whatever you said. Hell, this entire conversation probably was your entire plan and let me guess," She turned to Bow . "You followed it because she's your girlfriend."

Bow and Glimmer both look flustered, trying to deny the accusations made against them, Catra couldnt care for it. She began walking away but was immediately followed. "Look, Catra. I had no right to

say those things to you and I have no right to hate you. You're completely right."

Glimmer's apology was over in a few seconds as if she had to make sure she got it all out in the open before Catra could jump in. "Y ou were right. An-and we want to try to be friends." Glimmer sputtered, looking to Bow for reassurance, He gave it to her with a nod. "Exactly . And we know you miss Adora. Maybe we could al-"

Catra stopped in her tracks and turned to look at them. "Adora is not my friend. I do not miss her. Losing her was probably the best thing for both of us. She has her team, she has her family and she has you guys. Why the hell would I once again come in and fuck everything up for her?" Catra asked. "She' s happy."

"No, she' s not!" Glimmer cried. "Her life is absolutely miserable without you! W e all thought her life would be better but even when she can't remember you, she never shuts up about you. Nothing has changed except the fact that she doesn't know you're the one she's talking about." Catra stayed silent. It was the same thing she had been hearing about over and over again. She didnt know why everyone was pushing her to reach out. Had they not gotten that she *couldn't*? As much as Catra desperately wanted to, her guilt was eating her away every time she saw the blonde girl knowing what she had done. Adora was still needing monthly brain scans and tests and she still couldn't play soccer competitively.

"That sucks for her then."That was all that was said before Catra began to walk off. This time, Bow and Glimmer watched her, determined faces. They were going to do this one way or the other. It had been a whole month and a half process, but now that they knew how both of them felt, it was only a matter of time that would help them fall back into place.

Chapter End Notes

IM SORRY FOR THE SHOR T CHAPTERS BUT I WANT TO MAKE THIS BOOK LONGER WITH THE CHAPTERS ALL TOGETHER IF THAT MAKES SENSE

but things are finally set in motion. Be warned, I wholeheartedly love cliche books and this is one of them so if you like realistic shit you probably shouldn't read further. because its about to be like a disney movie with a hint of angst and depression

Act one begins

Chapter Summary

well... the moment everyone has waited for. the ball is now rolling

Chapter Notes

As act one (finally) starts, the first few chapters are going to be a bit shorter than my usual thirty pages. This is just so I can get as many chapters out there without it looking like a super fast burn because it is in fact not. just lust, no love

(yet)

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Adora stared down at the blank bitmoj. Her thumb hovered over the chat, bottom lip pulled between her teeth as she figured out what she wanted to type. She wanted to call Catra out for what she said, but she also just wanted to talk to her . It had been almost two weeks and Catra's birthday was coming up. How did she know that? Her lovely friend Snapchat had given her a notification. Maybe Adora was just clueless. Catra obviously did not want to be her friend, why else would she be pushing her away and trying to hurt her?

One thing she had picked up from talking about her with Adam, was that she used anger as a coping mechanism. If she wanted to run from something or deny it, she would often come off as harsh and rude. Adora wasnt even sure why she wanted to connect with Catra. Maybe it was something to do with her feelings. It was obvious that Adora had grown fond of Catra these past few months. Whenever she smiled, Adora swore she saw sparks fly. Her presence was

warming and whenever they were together, Adora never wanted it to end.

Catra was a bad idea. She knew that and her friends had warned her countless times. But she couldn't help but feel electrified when she was around. She wanted to hold her close and be near her. It felt right in Adora’s brain, and that's where the delusion set in. She knew that Catra didnt feel the same. That didnt matter , but Adora was set on making Catra become her friend.

The blonde shut off her phone and rested her arm across her eyes. As she closed her eyes, all she could picture was Catra. Her eyes, were both two different colours yet they held so much more than their unique appearance. Adora was determined to figure it out. She opened her phone once again and opened Instagram. On a burner account she had created a few days ago, she finally got the courage to type in Catra’s username. But with her luck, the account was private. It was definitely Catra’s account, the username being a pun; *@atscorner_.* Adora knew that Adam must have had some influence on it because of his love of puns and their unspoken friendship.

Figuring the account wouldnt work seeing as the username *screamed* Adora (soccerplayer09) and the profile picture being a cartooned unicorn. She was less creative when it came to creating fake accounts. But then again, she had never been this desperate before. So, she logged into her brother's account.

The password was easy, it was his date of birth. It was a wonder how no one had hacked him yet. But when she got in, she immediately went into his following. Finding Catra's account was easy. I was near the top. Adora hesitantly clicked on the profile and found herself in awe at the number of pictures Catra had posted. Behind the private account and in-life persona, she never would have guessed that Catra's account would have so many pictures spread across her theme. The latest one was just a few minutes ago and Adora had felt her heart sputter.

Catra was beautiful. But Adora had already known that. The brunette was lying on her bed, a hand beneath her cheek as she stared into the camera. The sunset lamp displayed in front of her illuminated the room in a soft, heavenly glow and only made the colours in her eyes stand out far more prominent than usual. The freckles on her cheeks were dark, scattered across her face in random and unusual spots. The caption was a lyric from one of Adora's favourite songs, August. It read,

' *But I can see us lost in the memory , August slipped away into a moment in time* .'

Adora felt a ping in her chest. The song had always resonated with her. About losing something or someone that was never hers. It's pretty obvious, stated right there in the lyrics. But she wondered why Catra had used that specific lyric. Of course, Adora continued to

scroll to come out of the smoke of delusion she wished to stay in. As she continued to scroll, she noticed most of the captions had contained lyrics, short and simple. Adora could identify which songs they had come from, as most if not all, had been on her very own playlist. She never would have guessed their music taste had been so similar.

With each picture Catra posted, the longer the time frames became. Some went from being posted just a few months ago to a few years ago. Almost all of them were pictures of random things including trees or painted rocks with what Adora had assumed, drawn on by her and her friends. Some even included pictures of her old artwork which Adora immediately recognized from the school's Art hallway. Adora was about to continue scrolling when Adam called her name. She quickly logged out of the account and went on Twitter. Within a few seconds, Adam comes bursting into her room, cell phone in hand.

"Did you log into my Instagram account?" He asks. Adora shakes her head and purses her lips. "Nope. Uh, just on T witter." She gave him a small smile and a flash of her screen. He didnt believe her for a second. "How did you even crack my password?" Adora sits up, her hair falling across her shoulders as she throws the phone onto the bed.

"Your password is your birthday, A!" She exclaimed. "Literally anyone could hack into your account!" Adam rolled his eyes and hopped onto the bed. Adora pulled her legs in closer towards herself,

allowing her brother to lie comfortably on his side. “Are you going to tell me why you decided to hack into my account?”

Adora could lie, say she wanted to snoop through his messages, But he would immediately know that wasnt it. Adora was never one for snooping, even in the most dire situations. So, she caved. He would find out anyways just by opening his phone and seeing that the last viewed profile had belonged to a certain brunette-haired girl. “I just wanted to see what Catra’s been up to,”Adam smirked up at his sister, who was doing anything possible to not catch his eyes, knowing exactly what he was thinking.

“And did you find anything new?”Adora fought the smile that tugged on her lips. Her hands shielded her blushed face as she fell down on her side, facing her brother. She poked an eye between her fingers. “She posted a new photo.”Adam raised his eyebrows, telling her to continue. “And the caption was a T aylor Swift lyric.”It was the smallest thing, But Adam couldnt help but be proud of his twin sister . Before the accident, Adora had never been this open with her crushes. When they were on guys, she couldn't shut u about them. But from what he had come to the realization, she would be quiet on her girl crushes, almost never flat out admitting that it was a crush. Some part of him was thankful that the accident had somehow opened her up to the thought of her own sexuality.

The twins continued to talk about Adora’s blooming crush for the next few hours. Adora learned not to trust Adam’s relationship advice.

Later that evening, Catra was eating a bag of Cool Ranch Doritos with a can of Pepsi and high out of her mind as she aimlessly scrolled on Instagram, getting distracted by multiple funny animal compilations. She had come to the realization that getting high, was far better than being sober. Especially with everything going on in her life. As she was scrolling, a notification had popped up. It was a snap from Adam. The brunette licked her fingers from the chip dust and opened the new video. When it loaded, Catra nearly choked on her spit. The video was of Adora, lying on her bed. Her hair was sprawled across her body in small and messy tangles as she stared at her phone. In the bright lighting, it wasnt hard to tell that Adora was blushing.

"What are you looking at all happily?" Adam asked in the video. Catra sat up straighter, now intrigued. Adora's face burned a sharp red colour as she hid her face in her hand, before dragging it down her face. Her blue eyes flickered up to Adam, round and wide. She looked like a puppy dog with eyes filled with love and curiosity. Catra's heart swelled in her chest. "She' s so pretty."

That was all Adora said, and the brunette frowned as the video ended with Adam giggling. Catra felt her stomach twist. Why would Adam send her a video of Adora fawning over some girl? Perhaps it

could have been him trying to show her that Adora was more comfortable with her sexuality now. As Catra was about to close the app and continue her binge of animal compilations, a Facetime notification popped up. It was from Adam.

Catra wanted to ignore it, but the screen displayed that Adam had his phone facing down. She was intrigued and decided to answer. She was immediately met with Adora's rambling.

"And she' s just, so pretty ."The blonde exasperated. "God I hate her ."

"Y ou hate her?"Adam asked and Catra could tell that he was being smug. Adora groaned loudly and the mic ruffled a bit from the blankets shifting. "No!Of course, I don't hate her!"

"She' s so incredible to be around. And it's so dumb because we're never actually alone for a long enough time. The longest had been when we were at her house but that was once and it probably won't ever happen again."She sighed. Catra' s head turned in confusion. Now, she was fully inclined to stay. Was this an invasion of privacy? *Yes*. Nonetheless, it was *Adora's*. But Catra figured that this was the best way to at least be updated in her life without actually having to indulge herself. Plus, the twang of jealousy swirling around her made her eager to stay to find out who Adora seemed to have a crush on.

"God, I think I actually like her ."Adora' s voice was muffled and Catra could barely hear a word. She put the phone closer to her ear. "Why dont you talk to her?"

"Because she had made it insanely clear that she does not like me in the slightest. I am ninety-nine percent sure that she hates me even for being on the same freaking rock as her!"

"Y ou never know, Dor ."

"Oh no. I know . Catra hates my guts while I am the loser who actually-"That was all Cara needed to hear before she hung up the phone and tossed it to the side. Her hands were placed in her face as she stared into the distance, trying to convince herself that what she had just heard was real. By now , she had completely sobered up and she was instead left in a dreading shock.

Adora liked her. Not just as a friend, but something more. It sounded crazy to even repeat back. On one hand, it made her heart flutter with excitement knowing this new information. On the second hand, she was terrified. All it meant was that she was going to find out that Catra ruined her life and chances of playing competitive soccer. She also felt responsible for Adora's crisis. She was fully at fault for

making the blonde believe that she didn't like her, hell Adora tight she despised her when it was the furthest from the truth. She had fucked up and didnt know what to do. So, she called Scorpia and Entrapta.

After a long discussion, most of the advice coming from Scorpia (Catra was pretty sure Perfuma was there telling her what to say) and statistics from Entrapta, Catra had decided on her course of action.

She was going to tell Adora.

Chapter End Notes

THOUGHTS?

chapter twelve

Chapter Notes

a very sweet chapter containing a sick adora

See the end of the chapter for more notes

As the weeks turned over, Fall had officially begun to set. The leaves started to brown and pumpkins had started to load patios outside of the many homes down the street. With Halloween just around the corner, that only meant that her eighteenth birthday was flying at her faster than she had wanted it to. Catra was sitting at the kitchen table, Halloween music playing on the Alexa as she, her mother and Thomas were carving out their pumpkins. Surprisingly, Catra and Thomas' relationship had grown. At first, Catra didnt trust him. But now? After seeing how much he loved her mother and even her, her mind had been changed. She finally had someone who she could one day call dad. And for the first time in a long time, she was excited to spend her birthday with more than two people.

"What the hell is that?" Thomas asked, leaning over to stare at the pumpkin Catra was working hard on. She turned to look at him, then back at her pumpkin. "It' s a cat." She said, a playful frown on her face as Thomas raised an eyebrow.

"That is one deformed cat." He said and Catra gasped while her mother burst out into a fit of laughter, her forehead nearly lying across the table as her body shook in amusement. Catra stared at her mother and scoffed. "Okay let's see your pumpkin then!" Cyra pursed her lips as she placed her knife on the table.

"Prepared to see the best pumpkin carving of your life." She said smugly as she twisted the fruit around, allowing the others to look. Catra tipped her head as she tried to figure out what it was exactly. It looked like a mix of a clown and a rabbit. The brunette opened her mouth to speak, but was silenced by Thomas who leaned in closer to her to whisper; "Say it looks absolutely beautiful."

Cyra had heard this as she scoffed and grabbed a chunk of pumpkin guts and tossed it at the two of them. Catra gasped as the coldness had shocked her as well as the guts that had been splattered across her face and clung to her hair. Thomas let out an uproar in laughter and challenged her mother to a pumpkin fight. Thankfully, they had covered every surface imaginable with garbage bags. If Sharon had come home early for her meeting and seen the mess created on her marble counters, they would all have been kicked to the streets.

"Oh, it is so on!" Catra shouted as she stood up, digging both hands into her pumpkin and scraping whatever fell loose in her hands. She grabbed the clot nearly as big as her head and she split it between her two hands, chucking the goo at her parents. They both wheezed out a burst of laughter, gasping in shock at the sudden coldness. Catra doubled over as she watched their faces and the orange cores dripping down their bodies and in their hair. Pumpkin seeds sticking to their faces and arms and quite frankly- *everywhere*.

"You are so dead, kit-kat." Thomas exhaled as he reached into his pumpkin and grabbed the most guts out of everyone and chucked it at the unexpecting girl. Catra shrieked as she attempted to shield herself, but was unsuccessful. Her mother laughed loudly, practically cackling as she grabbed her phone and set it up, pressing record before joining Thomas in completely bombarding Catra. The girl wheezed and shrieked loudly, begging for them to stop as she doubled over, her stomach hurting from laughing so hard.

Only one thing ran through her mind at that moment. She had a real family.

And of course, at that same time, Adora had caught the flu. Although her immune system was perfectly fine, Marlena had practically quarantined the entire house. Lying in her bed sick with a runny nose and aching joints was not something that Adora had planned. Over the course of the weekend, she and Adam had planned nearly fifty different ways to win Catra over and over fifty ways on how to ask her to the winter formal after winning her trust. They had absolutely no idea if Catra would even overlook everything (Adam seemed certain about it, but Adora didnt think it would work.)

So now, unable to go through with her plans, she sat at home with snotty tissues surrounding her and Modern Family' playing on her TV. Her friends had bombarded her with texts and even calls asking if she was okay and if they could come over. Adora had reassured them that she was fine, just down with the flu and to not worry . She told them they could try coming over, but was certain her mother would say no (she did).

Other than that, she was completely and utterly bored. The blonde decided to do some more snooping, now having Adam's permission to use his account. But when she went to go switch accounts, she noticed a notification.

@catscorner_has followed you !

Shooting up in shock, Adora's eyes widened as she immediately clicked on the notification just to make sure that she had seen what she thought she saw. And yet, staring at her was the ' *Request to follow* ' button. Almost eagerly , Adora clicked on it. And now, she waited until the certain mismatch-eyed girl accepted.

As the day went on, Adora did two things. Slept and checked if Catra had followed her back. Thankfully, her parents had left for work and she had the house to herself. The blonde sat up and wrapped her blanket around her shoulders. Loose hair from her bun had fallen out, creating a crown of standing hairs to add to her pale complexion and Rudolph-coloured nose. She slowly made her way downstairs with her empty water bottle, groaning loudly at the inconvenience of her situation Swift Wind ran up to her and began rubbing against her. Adora smiled at the pup and gave him a rough scratch. "Hey buddy ," She greeted.

The animal ran to the backyard and scratched at the door combined with a whine. Adora sniffled and set her glass down, going to open the back door for him before returning to filling up her cup of water. As she stood there, leaning against the counter with messy hair and wrapped in a large blanket, the doorbell rang. The blonde's head snapped towards the entryway and wondered who was at the door. Shuffling with her vicks-covered feet, she moved towards the door and rested her head against it, suddenly feeling fatigued.

"Who is it?"She asked, her voice coming out more nasally than she had expected. There was no response for a moment until there was. "Adora? It' s Catra."

Adora nearly fell to the ground, her eyes wide and her nose runnier than before. It was at that moment, Adora could not have looked

worse. As Adora stared at herself in the mirror, she had wished she just ignored the door .

"Are you okay?" Catra asked concerned. "Do I need to call an ambulance-" Adora quickly snapped her head to the door and shook her head as if Catra could see. "No!"

Catra stared at the door in confusion. Adora sounded muffled as if her lips were pressed flat against the wooden door. She also sounded incredibly ill which only made Catra grow more nervous as the time passed. "I'm fine, no need to waste an ambulance." The blonde implored, almost sounding desperate. Catra's eyebrows furrowed.

"Then open the door dumbass." Adora stared through the eye and down at Catra, who was holding a container of something. The brunette looks nervous as she bit down on her lip and anxiously shifted her feet. Adora had to think of something. "Uh. Well you see, I'm incredibly sick and my mom would actually murder me if I let someone in and plus I don't want to get you si-"

Catra shut down her rambling. "I have my flu shot and your mother was the one who told me to come in so let me in or I'm breaking down your door." Adora knew she was serious. Through the peephole, Catra was already staring at her with a heavy countenance. Adora was confused as to why her mom had asked

Catra to come over and not Glimmer or even Bow. Any of them could have made soup and checked up on her.

The blonde was hesitant as she covered the bottom half of her face with the blanket, before unlocking and opening the door. She was met with Catra's concerned face being the first thing t be seen. Then the soup. Catra stared at Adora as if she was a kicked puppy as the girl let her in. Catra took her shoes off as they stayed in silence. "What's up with the blanket mask?"

She asked as the two of them made it to the kitchen. Catra set the container of soup down as Adora shrugged. "I don't want you to get sick!" She cried and Catra raised an eyebrow , opening her mouth to speak but was cut off by the loud barking and whine of Swift Wind. Adora moved to go get it, but Catra had ordered her to stay back and sit down. The blonde listened as Catra opened the back door to let the giant dog inside. She wouldn't admit it, but sitting down made her feel ten times better.

Swift Wind jumped up on Catra, nearly towering her weight as the brunette attempted to hold the dog up, surprisingly keeping her own weight on her feet as she laughed happily. The sweet sound made Adora smile and her face swell. She was thankful for the blanket mask at that moment. "Swifty , get down!" Adora coughed from the other side of the room as Catra had been knocked on her ass, Swift Wind practically putting his entire body weight on the girl's lap.

Catra looked up and shook her head, smiling. "No, he' s okay."She looked down at the dog and began aggressively petting behind his ears. "Isn't that right, Swifty?"Adora watched in amazement as the girl who had shared multiple times on her stories how she was terrified of large dogs was now completely wrapped up by one.

"I thought you didnt like big dogs?"Adora asked, barely getting Catra's attention from Swift Wind. "W ell yeah, but Swifty is the only exception."She exclaimed with a giggle as Swift Wind climbed of f of her and came over to Adora, sitting by her feet. Adora instinctively began petting him.

Catra's mind couldn't stop reeling about what she heard Adora confess. She knew that she could never bring it up around her, but it gave Catra a sense of comfort that she and Adora were going to begin being okay again. Plus, she now had an excuse to shamelessly tease Adora just to see the glint in her eyes.

The brunette began making the soup, finding everything she needed easily. Of course she had, she had it memorized the day Marlena and her first cooked together. Adora watched Catra's movements, opening her mouth to help her find things but watched in wonder as Catra had known where everything was without ever having to think about it. "How do you do that?"

She asked. Catra looked at her, confused as she began scooping the soup into a pot. "Do what?"

"Know where everything is. I don't even have to tell you." Catra just raised an eyebrow and laughed amusingly. "Adora, Adam and I have had many sleepovers. You learn where everything is in your best friend's kitchen when they can't cook for shit." That had been a lie. Adam was an incredible cook, he never needed Catra's help and was often encouraged to just sit down and watch. It was Adora who she had to cook for because the second the girl turned on the oven, everything burned. But Adora wouldn't be able to tell if that was a lie or not.

"Wait," Adora raised her hands. "You and Adam had sleepovers?" Catra could see the jealousy practically infusing her pretty little head. The brunette rolled her eyes as she stirred the warming food. "Relax princess." The nickname made Adora's knees weak. "Just as friends. I don't go that way."

Adora's eyes widened at the remark as if she were surprised. She wasn't. Catra was out and proud all over her socials. The longer the blonde stayed silent, the louder Catra laughed. She turned the stove off and transferred everything into a bowl, putting the rest of it in the fridge as she grabbed a spoon and Adora's glass of water. "C'mon, you need to lie down. You look like a sick Victorian child."

Adora watched as Catra kicked her head towards the stairs, and rolled her eyes. "Hah hah. V ery funny."Adora snif fed as she began ascending the stairs, trying to hold her blanket up as much as she could. "I know , I'm hilarious."The two ended up in Adora' s bedroom and the blonde almost immediately curled onto her mattress and shut her eyes. Catra gave her a small smile, before setting the bowl and glass on her end table. Her eyes then wandered around Adora's room. Almost nothing had changed except for their years of memories. The thought made her sad but she knew it would all work out. Catra sat down at the end of Adora's bed, by her feet. The blonde tucked them in closer to her body, giving Catra more space.

"Thank you."Adora snif fled as she poked her head up. Catra looked at her and smiled. "Dont mention it."She hesitated and looked away , down at her hands as she fidgeted with them. "It' s what friends do."

Adora sat up, the blanket falling away from her face and finally allowed Catra to grasp how ill the blonde was. She stared at her in curiosity. "I thought we weren't friends."Catra closed her eyes, exhaled and looked at Adora.

"I shouldn't have said any of that. It was uncalled for and fucking shitty of me."

Adora scoffed and Catra looked away. "Y eah, you basically threw my accident in my face."Catra swallowed the lump in her throat and

blinked back the forming tears. "I know . I know and I'm so fucing sorry Adora. It was such a messed up thing to say and I hope you can forgive me."

Adora stayed silent, just staring at the blanket covering her . Catra was waiting for it. For Adora to yell at her and kick her out. And rightfully so. Catra didn't deserve her *forgiveness*, hell she didn't deserve her *friendship* nonetheless. She knew after that fight she had to make it up to her. No matter what, no matter how long it takes. Catra had messed up and desperately wanted to fix things between them. Between everyone's advice, all saying the same thing with different words, maybe it was time for Catra to own up to everything. No matter the consequence. As hard as it seemed to be, the blonde-haired girl with a heart of pure gold deserved all of it and more.

"It wasn't cool of you to say that, but Adam kind of helped me out a bit so ill give it a chance."Catra smiled and quietly laughed. "Adam seems to always fix things, doesn't he?"Adora nodded her head and laughed. Catra hadn't heard that in so long that she wanted to engulf herself in tears and run away. In the back of her mind, she prayed that Adora forgives her for everything. But she knew that a part of *Adora* would never forgive her.

The two ended up talking for hours, just like they used to. It was almost *enchanting* how easily they fell back into their old lives. Almost as if nothing had happened. They ended up lying beside each other, on their sides as they talked about anything and everything. Adora went down a rabbit hole of knowledge about

random things that interested her and Catra listened to every single word that she spoke. It was refreshing as it had been new things that Catra had not even known interested Adora.

Eventually, the two drifted off into a soft slumber beside each other almost as if they were fifteen again.

Chapter End Notes

do not worry, what catra said will be dealt with but shhh enjoy the fluff I'm serving before we get really depressing

(adora did not eat the soup)

new challenge;how many taylor swift references can ki make in a single chapter comment because I'm currently listening to her and she sometimes sneaks her way into my books

chapter 13

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

The sun was beaming down on her, tanning her already-bronzed skin as she lie on the beach chair. The salted winds blew in her hair and sent a cool breeze down her body . Kids' laughter could be heard, perfectly blending in with the sounds of the ocean smacking against the shore. Suddenly, her tanning session had been cut short by a large shadow blocking her way. Catra peeked an eye open and lifted her sunglasses as she stared up at the soaking blonde in front of her. Cold water dripped from her lean body and down onto Catra.

"What?"She asked, knowing Adora was only bothering her for a reason. The blonde was panting, her chest rising up and down in exhaustion, and Catra nearly winced at the patches of red that burnt her skin. Catra had told Adora to wear sunscreen, but the girl was certain that if she was in the water the entire time, she would be safe. She was so very wrong.

"Come play ."Adora giddily voiced, her arms swaying back and forth like a child, more water only dripping onto Catra's body. The brunette tilted her head and gestured to her feeble position on the chair. "I'm tanning, Dor ."Adora frowned as she rolled her eyes.

"You have been tanning this entire time, come actually enjoy the beach with us!" The blonde exclaimed as she sat down, covering her mouth with a cough as she slouched down by Catra, lifting her feet up to place them across her lap. Catra crossed her arms and shook her head.

"I am enjoying the beach!" Catra clamoured, laughing. Adora shook her head. "No, enjoying the beach would be coming into the water with your friends and not sitting all alone increasing your chances of skin cancer."

"What can I say , I live for the thrill of it." The brunette sarcastically spoke as she reached down and grabbed the book she had previously been reading. Adora pursed her lips, her fingers drumming against Catra's legs as she looked towards the water where Bow, Glimmer and Adam were splashing each other. Suddenly, Adora got an idea. The blonde grinned mischievously as she turned to look at Catra who was intensely reading.

"Yeah no this isnt working." Catra looked up just as Adora had reached over and yanked the book from her hand, tossing it onto the ground (*but making sure she didn't lose Catra's page. She wasn't a monster*). "What are you doin- *ADORA*!" Catra shrieked as Adora had thrown Catra her shoulder and immediately booked it towards the water. Catra let out cries of protest as she slapped Adora's back, the wet skin snapping loudly as Adora cackled, finally reaching the water. Catra gasped.

"Adora no, please." The brunette begged. "Do not throw me in I swear to god- *I will murder you* !"

Adora laughed as she turned her head to look at Catra behind her shoulder. "Are you planning on swimming?" Catra instantly nodded her head, begging Adora not to throw her into the cold waters. Adora knew it was a lie. Catra would walk in, get her toes wet and then run back to the warmth. It took a *lot* to get Catra to go into the water, but when she did, you couldn't get her out.

"Great!" And with that, Adora had run in deeper , Catra's body going stiff as she squealed and tried to keep the rising water from touching her. It was no use though, as Adora had gotten deep enough. She chucked the brunette into the water with a deep splash and an uproar of laughter from her friends. Catra's head popped out of the water.

"Oh, you are so dead"…

Adora sprung up in her bed, the room was now dark as the sun had gone down and instead was replaced with the warm glow of the fairy lights encircling her room. A soft moan brought the blonde's attention down beside her, seeing Catra sleeping. She was curled up in a ball,

covered underneath the blankets. Her hair cascaded down her shoulders and around her neck, falling out of its ponytail. She had looked so peaceful Adora banished the idea of even waking her.

That was when it had fully hit her. Catra was sleeping in Adora’s bed. The entire day had been a fog, she couldnt remember when she had woken up that day or when she fell asleep. The blonde brought a hand up to her eye and rubbed the sleep out of it, stretching out a near-silent yawn, making sure not to wake the girl beside her. She slid off the bed, making sure to leave the blanket behind as Catra’s hand reached out and gripped it, holding it closer to her. A smile sputtered across Adora’s face as she watched, before gently shaking her head, trying to push away the thoughts that roamed around her head. It didnt work.

Something in Adora was clicking. The way Catra was sleeping so peacefully, almost as if it was the first night she had been able to drift off without worry corrupting her mind. The smell of Catra’s laundry detergent lingered on her bedding, her clothes and even Adora herself. It manifested in the girl's mind, watching the brunette frown in her sleep and pull her eyebrows together. Adora wondered what she was dreaming of.

Not wanting to risk waking Catra up, Adora grabbed her phone as well as the bowl of soup that was left untouched on her endstand. She would reheat it, obeying the low growl of her stomach. She slowly started to feel better the more she woke up and used her body. The blonde creaked towards the door, slowly twisting the handle and sneaking out without a peep. Before she shut it behind

her, Adora peeked back into the room to make sure Catra had not woken up. She didnt but now had her back facing towards the door .

Adora walked downstairs, seeing her family in the living room, talking with Teela. She placed the bowl of soup on the kitchen table, their attention turned to the girl at the sound of the soft thud. Her mother gave her a smile and readjusted her seating position, allowing Adora to sit beside her. She did so, having an arm wrapped around her shoulders. "How are you feeling?"

Marlena asked, and Adora shrugged. "Better I guess."Her eyes flashed to Teela as she gave the tanned girl a smile. "Hey , Tee."

Teela copied, giving Adora a smile and a small wave. Although they had only hung out a few times within them meeting, the two had grown close. Adam had complained about it countless times to Adora, saying that she was stealing his girlfriend and all that she did was laugh. Of course, Teela was gorgeous. She had dark, auburn hair and forest-green eyes. But she wasnt Adora' s type. Thinking of her type, Catra blurred into her thoughts, clashing against the image of Teela. She quickly looked down, hiding the blush that cascaded across her face, her hair thankfully covering most of the flush of colour.

Then, she remembered that Catra had been up in her bedroom and she wasnt sure if her parents thought she had left or not. "Oh, Catra

is still here." She trailed of f, staring at her fingers as she twisted and overlapped them, something she did when she was nervous or thinking too much about something. Randor cocked his head to the side and looked at Marlena, then at Adora. She thought he was going to get upset for allowing her to stay over knowing that Adora had been sick, but instead, he smiled and slapped his hands onto his jean-clad thighs.

"W ell, tell her to come down!" Randor roared with laughter as her family agreed rather loudly, voices clamouring together loudly. Adora shook her head, bringing a finger up to her lips as she shushed them. " *Shh*. She's sleeping." Randor raised an eyebrow , looking straight at Adora. She knew what he was about to ask, what he would assume. She only hoped he held back and didn't.

"W ait." He paused. "In your bed?" Adora slowly nodded her head. She knew her father was supportive but she wasnt sure how he would take another girl sleeping in her bed, especially with closed doors.

"Bringing up memories, huh?" Randor laughed as he threw a soft hand slap to Marlena's arm, but immediately stopped when he found out no one was laughing, but instead, staring with horrified eyes. Adora tilted her head, her mouth hanging open as she stared at her father, confused. "What." Adora let out a confused chuckle, standing up.

"What do you mean?" She asked, her voice cracking. Randor looked to his wife for help but didn't find any. Instead, she was staring at the ground with her fingers to her mouth. Adam and Teela too, avoided any eyes that could be found.

"Nothing. Just that... Uh." The older man struggled to find his words. Adora continued to stare and his eyes told her that he had made a giant mistake with his words. Problem was? Adora was trying to figure out what it was. The blonde turned to her mother and twin, seeing their expressions. Even Teela was taken aback and avoided her gaze. Adora rolled her eyes and scoffed, crossing her arms aggressively.

"We aren't fucking doing this again, Dad." She argued and Randor looked almost taken aback by her language. He stood up. A hardened stare on his face, filled with disappointment and disagreement. Adora stood up straight and almost regretted opening her mouth. It wasn't as if she was scared of her father, she knew he would never do anything to hurt her or their family. In fact, he hurt himself keeping them all safe and well off. Growing up, she was taught not to disrespect her elders. It was impolite. Of course, she was allowed to discuss what she found to be disrespectful and they all worked on it. But now was not the time or place.

"No, Adora." He said sternly. "*We* aren't doing this. Not right now." Adora bit her tongue, wanting to push further. Her eyes caught Adam looking away, almost guiltily. She knew he would crack. He swore he wouldn't tell her who the girl Catra supposedly killed was, and then he did. She asked him what her 12th birthday present was from their

parents, he swore not to say, then later that night he told her. (It turned out to be Swift Wind while Adam got Cringer- hence the names).

Yes, another memory. She had been getting flashes of them randomly throughout the day and even throughout the night. It was mostly of her family, and she felt terrible when Bow and Glimmer had gotten excited over this information, only to find out that she still never remembered any of their core memories shared together. Marlena stood up and placed a hand on Adora's arm, bringing her gaze to the much shorter woman.

"When the time is right, youll figure it out." W as all she whispered, as if prying ears were near. Adora turned, and sure enough, like a kid hiding behind the corner of a wall- stood Catra. Her Amber eye peeked behind the wall, watching the family almost worriedly. Marlena gave her a smile, before making her way towards the girl. Catra gave the woman a comforting smile, her bottom lip nearly quivering as Marlena grabbed the girl in a tight hug.

Adora could see the way Catra's body tensed up, before ultimately giving into the hug, her nose digging into the crack of her mom's neck. It almost looked like the two were near tears when they pulled away. Marlena cupped Catra's cheeks, her thumbs tapping the girl's cheek. The brunette laughed a bit as Marlena let her go and guided her away from the step. Adam stood up and walked to her, giving her a handshake that seemed far more complicated than Adora would like to admit. They spun, did a high and low five and something with

their feet and a low jump. The teen's laughter rang through the house as her father had taken it upon himself to hug Catra as well.

Adora wasn't sure why her parents were so loving, but she assumed it was because Catra hadn't been over in a while to visit Adam. Adora couldn't blame her , if she was in an accident that involved the loss of her best friend, she wouldn't spend much time being outgoing either.

Eventually, night fell and they sat around the kitchen table eating a stir fry that Catra and Marlena had made. Adora tried to help but was pushed out into the living room with Adam, her father and Teela. The blonde shovelled another bite into her mouth, moaning in pure delight as the flavours burst across her tongue. Catra turned to look at her and laughed at the sight. Adora was acting as if she hadn't eaten in weeks by the way she was scooping the food into her mouth and swallowing almost without chewing.

Adora turned to look at her and swallowed. "Mm-what?"She asked, fork already supporting more food. Catra gave her a risen eyebrow, her eyes glancing at her fork. "You're going to choke on your food if you keep shovelling it in there like you have a time limit."The brunette laughed. Adora rolled her eyes and filled her mouth again.

"Mm I'm a pro."She said with a mouth full of food and a teasing smile on her face as she watched Catra's fill with disgust. "Agh, you're so

dumb.”She tried to stay stern, but couldnt help but quietly laugh. Adora watched with a small smile tugging at the corners of her lips. She opened her mouth to speak, *after swallowing of course,* but was interrupted by her mother.

“Adora, sweetie, eat slower , please. We dont want a repeat of last weekend.”Adora’ s head whipped towards her mother, eyes widened and face blooming in a deep shade of red out of embarrassment. Her father cackled, fork in hand as he covered his mouth and looked down at the table. Marlena smiled almost teasingly as she winked at Catra. Adora turned to look at the brunette who was already staring at her.

“Oh, a pro eater , huh?”She mocked and Adora rolled her eyes and dipped her head down to avoid eye contact. “Shut up.”She mumbled and hesitantly took another bite, making sure to eat much slower than before. The table burst out into a flurry of contagious laughter as suddenly stories of Adora’s embarrassing moments became the conversation topic. Most from her childhood, some from just a few days ago, like when she tripped going up the stairs and spilled iced tea on herself.

The blonde turned to subtly look at Catra, the brunette’s eyes wide and shining. The smile on her face permanently stretched across her face as she *cackled* and even let out small, almost unnoticeable snorts of laughter. Adora noticed. The blonde's face was a shade of pink, cheeks prominent as she subtly smiled at the girl who sat beside her. As she continued to stare, the clicking began once again. She recalled the memory she had almost a month earlier and tried to

connect it to the moment she was experiencing. Of course, Adora had trouble recollecting every small detail, but she had done it. Her eyes glanced down to Catra's hands, blue eyes wandering to the rings scattered and clumped across her nimble fingers and the black, chipped nail paint.

As Catra laughed, it was almost *deja vu.* It reminded Adora of every small memory, dream and even hallucination she had. Had Catra been the girl she was seeing? It wouldnt be too far of f, Adam and Catra had been best friends for years as she was told, so it wouldnt have been such a stretch to think that some of those sleepovers Catra and Adora had slept in the same bed or sat so close together at dinner time. The one thing she couldnt figure out was, why hadnt Catra told her.

Eventually, dinner ended. Adora helped her mother with the dishes and cleaned the area while her father and Catra were talking about *something.* Adora had tried to eavesdrop, catching glances of them hugging or what looked like Randor comforting Catra and it only intrigued her more. But every time she tried to sneak off and listen, she would be pulled back by her mother for a new chore to do. Adam had even come in and started to talk loudly, assuring his mother that Adora could barely hear the conversation at hand. It frustrated the girl and made her jaw hurt from being clenched too tightly for the duration of time until they were finally finished cleaning and it was time for Catra to leave.

Adora walked the brunette to the door, grabbed her coat and helped Catra shrug into it. The blonde gave her a smile as Catra zipped it

up. Adam had grabbed his keys from the end table and was putting his shoes on, getting ready to take Catra home. Adora turned to him and whispered, "Let me take her ."

The request came as a shock to Adam as he furrowed his brows. "What?"

Adora placed a hand on the end table, leaning in closer to her brother. "I want to drive Catra home."Adam shook his head as he too, lowered his voice to a whisper. Adora looked back at the brunette, seeing her talking with Teela. She caught a brief mention of cats and knew Catra would be gushing about Melog, not paying any attention to the twins. Adora looked back at Adam.

"No. Absolutely no way are you driving."Adam whisper-yelled, shaking his head. Adora rolled her eyes and tried to snatch the keys from Adam's hands, but ultimately failed as he raised them above his head. "I've been driving with Bow and Glimmer for *weeks* now. I know how to fucking drive, Adam."Still, the boy persisted.

"You're not even supposed to be driving, Adora."He reminded her and Adora shook her head. "No, Aunt Mara said I was able to start driving again, alone after our last few sessions-"Adam had stopped her and Adora realized why . No one was supposed to know that Mara had been going behind her sister's back and allowing her niece

to be driving, especially when it was expressed by Marlena that she wasn't comfortable with the idea. "W ait."

He paused. "Aunt Mara has been taking you for secret driving lessons this entire time?" He asked and Adora nearly had to smack him to stop his slowly raising voice. If her mother found out she would be dead. And so would Mara.

" *SH*. "Adora hushed and guided Adam further away from Catra and Teela. The two still haven't noticed. "Y ou cannot tell anyone. Okay? Hope is going to clear me for driving next checkup. Even if I'm cleared, Mom would *never* let me go unless she could see that I'm not a danger to myself on the road. Hence the *secret* sessions with Mara." Adora explained and she prayed to god it would keep Adam quiet. But she knew even that wouldn't cut it. So, she pulled out the best card she could.

"After the accident, I've never felt normal. I ju-s-"

"T ake the damn keys." He said, cutting her of f as he placed them in her hand. Adora beamed and her back straightened as she smiled at her twin. "I love youuuu." She said, dragging out the words as she clutched the keys close to her chest. Adam rolled his eyes and pushed her closer to the door, looking back to make sure none of his parents were walking down the stairs to catch them in their scheme. "Y eah yeah. Just stop pulling the bullshit amnesia card on me, kay?"

Adora nodded her head and agreed (they both knew she wasnt going to stop) as she tugged on her shoes. Catra turned to look at the blonde, wondering why she was getting ready to leave. From what she knew, Adam was to drive her home. Something clicked on her brain and before she could even protest, she and Adora were being shoved out the front door by Adam. "No. Where the hell is Adam?"

Catra asked as Adora shoved her hands in her pockets and jogged happily over to the car. She grinned. "Change of plans, *kit-kat.* "

The use of Catra's childhood nickname flooded her with grief as she stared at Adora with wide eyes. Adam must have told her about it. The one thing she prayed Adora would never remember was the atrocious name Adam and her had come up with. There was absolutely no way that Marlena knew about this. There was absolutely *no way* Marlena would even *let* Adora be behind the wheel after the accident. Catra shook her head. "I'm going to walk."

"Across town? At night? In the middle of October?"Adora asked emphasis on every word with a shit-eating grin on her face, watching Catra shiver in the thin sweater that she wore. It had cooled down a lot more than it was earlier this morning, the brisk air turning Catra's nose and ears red as her fingers began to burn. She wondered how the hell Adora was only wearing a black short-sleeved shirt. If anything, Adora was just asking to stay sick by standing out in this

weather with nothing to cover her. But, Catra couldn't complain that much. She looked *good.* Her muscles popped out through her sleeves and hugged them tightly. It was clear that she had almost grown out of the shirt by the way it hugged her body but Catra *was not complaining.*

"Fine."The brunette grumbled as she ran swiftly to the car , jumping in almost immediately as soon as she heard the click of the doors unlocking. Adora climbed in and turned the vehicle on with a soft rumble and Catra reached for the heated seats, turning them on for the both of them. Adora thanked her as they strapped in.

She connected her phone to Bluetooth and clicked on a familiar playlist that made Catra's heart skip a beat. It was their playlist, the one they made when they were thirteen. Catra's eyes slowly wandered to Adora, trying to find any sign that she *knew*. If she did, she was extremely good at hiding it. The blonde put the car in reverse and backed out of the driveway before driving away from the residence. Catra could say that she wasn't absolutely terrified, but that would be a lie. Did Adora even know how to drive? She doubts Marlena would ever let her practice after everything that happened. She remembered Adam telling her about the fight the two had gotten into because Adora wanted to drive with her friends, but Marlena had insisted that she be the one to drive. It tore them apart for weeks and ultimately, Marlena ended up being the chauffeur.

The beat of a song filled the car and Catra couldn't help but let a small smile come across her lips as she looked at Adora. "Taylor Swift? Really?"It appeared to her that Adora had made a few

changes to the playlist they shared. Of course, Adora had always loved the artist and often forced the ones around her to listen to the blasting love songs (*Adora's absolute favourite genre of music*). The blonde turned to her and nodded with a grin.

"Absolutely T aylor Swift."And with that, she reached forwards and turned it up much louder than it already had been. Catra recognized the song as *Mine.* Memories began flooding her mind as her face turned red and her stomach flipped. She and Adora would always blast this specific song and sing it at the top of their lungs whenever or wherever it played. They could be in the grocery store and it would come on and almost immediately through the aisles, they would sing it, causing much disturbance. They didn't care, it was *their song.*

Catra caught Adora's eye as the blonde began singing. She laughed which only made Adora sing it louder as the chorus approached. Catra gave in and she joined in. T ogether, they loudly sang the lyrics as they continued to drive. Almost as if nothing had changed, almost as if they were the same as they always had been.

Chapter End Notes

And slowly they come together.

If you stopped reading to listen to 'Mine' by Taylor, you are DEDICATED.

This might be one of my favourite chapters simply because it isn't action-packed, but its pure fluff mixed with some angst. Don't worry, Adora won't let what her dad said be forgotten ;)

chapter fourteen

Chapter Summary

> This one is pretty short but i also have nothing more to add to it so this is what yall get. much love xx

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

By the time Wednesday rolled around, Adora was feeling much better and was rather eager to get back to school. Although her brother had brought home her schoolwork and helped her with what she missed, she couldn't help but feel like she had got it wrong. And plus, she missed Glimmer and Bow. And from the looks of it, they had missed her too.

"Adora!" Glimmer shrieked as she ran up to the blonde, down the hall and wrapped her arms around the blonde, jumping onto her as Adora stumbled back from the force. She wrapped her arms around Glimmer and smiled. "It was only four days, Glim." The short-haired girl pulled away and shrugged. Bow came into view, holding one strap of his backpack as it hung off of his shoulder. "In Glimmer's world that's four months."

The three of them laughed, Bow earning a slug in the ribs from Glimmer as she had tried to defend herself on her concept of time. "Are you saying you didn't miss me, Bow?" Adora teased as she threw a shoulder across both of their shoulders and began walking down the hall with laughter. Bow rolled his eyes and grinned.

"It' s not the best friend squad without our personal hero." He said, referring to her field name *she-ra*. Adora scrunched up her nose and opened her mouth to stop the words that she knew were about to tumble out of Glimmer's mouth with mischief laced between each syllable. They walked towards the Soccer team. "Our she-ra is *baack* !" She shouted excitedly , gaining more than just their teams' attention and almost everyone in the halls. Adora hated the nickname, she thought it was dumb but at the same time, she loved it because it defined who she was on the field. A strong, resilient *warrior.* Someone who didnt take the loss but instead fought for the win and *always* got it.

"Adora skipping school? Never would have guessed." Mermista teased, although Adora knew she was joking, her voice sounded unamused. But then again, that was just how Mermista talked. The blonde let go of Glimmer and Bow, the two immediately merging together like a wave, as she leaned against the lockers, shoulder pressed into the metal. "Oh yeah, you know how I absolutely hate school," She said, "My mother just lets me stay home whenever ."

They laughed. "Oh yeah, Marlena is a total rebel." Glimmer chimed in, only causing the group to laugh more. They all loved Marlena, she was like their second (or third) mom. But they all knew how cautious she could be, even before the accident happened. She was always worrying about her kids and even their friends. When Mermista came over and she saw the sunburn across her back, the woman created her own 'sun-burn' concoction and made her put it everywhere she was burnt and even helped her reach the spots that

she couldnt. It worked like a charm though, after only twelve hours it was no longer red and had faded into a nice tan with no pain.

“Adora!” A shrill voice yelled, gaining the attention of the group to a purple-haired girl who quickly made her way through the halls. Tablet in one hand and a piece of what looked like scrap metal in the other, Entrapta hurried towards them. Adora pushed herself off of the locker and smiled happily at the enthusiastic girl.

“Hey , Trapta.” She greeted, right behind her was Scorpia, who waved to the group before falling into the arms of Perfuma. They rubbed their noses together and Adora turned away with a slight grimace. “What’ s up?”

Entrapta looked up quickly . “W ell all I can see are the ceiling tiles but that’s not what Im here for .” She quickly placed the piece of scrap metal into Bow’s arms without much warning and by the look on his face, it was heavier than he had anticipated. She opened her tablet with fast typing fingers, putting in a password longer than Adora could even comprehend before it opened and was flooded by pages with what looked like data, mainly statistics and code. Bow stared down at it and his eyes sparkled.

“I came to ask you about Catra!” She shouted and the group of people around her seemed to shut down their conversations when her name popped up as if it was a forbidden word, long forgotten

until this very moment. Adora tried to hide the grin on her face. "What about her?"

Entrapta minimized a few tabs, scanning through seemingly endless lists until she found the one she had been looking for. Adora tried to catch a glimpse of what it was, but couldn't see it due to Entrapta swiping through *more* lists. "Well! You two hung out a few days ago, correct?"

More silence. She could feel Glimmer's eyes staring up at her and Adora was almost scared to meet eye contact. She gripped the straps of her bag tighter and nodded. "Y-yeah why?" Adora wasn't sure why Entrapta was asking, but she also wasn't sure why she felt so *nervous* to talk about Catra to her friends. Of course, her name was never mentioned unless it was by Adora herself but it felt like when she did, silence came quickly and the next topic of conversation came even quicker. "Great! My data is correct!"

Adora punched her eyebrows together. "Data?" Without looking up, Entrapta nodded her head as she began typing. "Yes. I record the data surrounding my friends and their environments so that I can be a better friend to them. Catra's has proven to be quite difficult, seeing as she doesn't talk very much." She trailed off. "But I've been getting a lot more since the two of you started hanging out! It's fascinating really."

She moved closer to Adora, showcasing her table. A bunch of numbers, percentages and scientific words were typed out that Adora had no idea where to start or even how to make sense of it. Entrapta seemed to pick up on this (or maybe she just knew that Adora wasn't understanding) as she pointed her finger at two different percentages, followed by countless numbers and decimals. The only thing that Adora understood was that one was significantly higher than the other. "See this one here shows Catra's ability to open up before you two started to hang out," She pointed to the lower number. "And this one shows after you two started to connect again! It was significantly boosted in the span of a month, which would connect with the timeline of you two talking, and now, hanging out!"

Adora cocked her head to the side and she felt a sort of *victory* installed into her. She may not have understood anything that Entrapta was showing her, but what she did understand was that *she* was the one to boost that number. Adora liked that. "It's all based on my own observations on how Catra acts, speaks and carries herself. All of which has changed since speaking to you. Knowing all of this, Catra has significantly opened up to me, which was very shocking but *very* exciting to be able to put into data."

"Okay wait," Adora paused as she looked at Entrapta, then to the tablet, back to Entrapta. "Why are you showing me?" The purple-haired girl shut her tablet off and held it to her chest. "I needed to confirm with you. It's allowing me to figure out what sort of birthday present Catra would like."

"Say , did Catra mention anything to you? It would *really* help with research!" Entrapta' s eyes pretty much glimmered as she stared up at the blonde. Adora got a feeling of nervousness from such close proximity. Although she had known Entrapta since they were children, they had never been very close. Entrapta was the one to tell her, although she had said it in a very 'well-known' manner that came off as rude. Adora never took it to heart. "W ait," She paused. "When is Catra' s birthday exactly?"

Entrapta didnt say anything, just pulled up what appeared to be *Catra' s file* on her tablet. Adora wondered if *she* had her own file. If she did, she wondered what Entrapta had on her. Maybe it would help her remember everything. And from the looks of it, Entrapta had *everything* written down. The blonde peered over and read the red letters, but Entrapta had shut her tablet off before she could even finish. "October 28th!"

"But that' s in two days!" Adora exclaimed. She wondered why Catra hadnt mentioned it, or even Adam. He always planned extravagant parties for everyone's birthday. Once he invited all of their friends over for his *cat's* birthday and gave him *presents*. "Y es, Im aware of that, which is why I'm going to my last resort. You."

Adora shook her head and stumbled over her words. "I- I- I- I dont *know*. Scorpia?" Adora looked over at her , who shook her head. "If Wildcat told me what she wanted I would have already gotten it."

The blonde frowned. Now that she knew that Catra's birthday was so soon, she felt the urge to find something that would suit her. Something that she would like. She would have to get with Scorpia, Entrapta and Adam to deep dive into everything they knew to get her the perfect birthday gift. Adora *loved* surprising her friends. Whether it was something as small as a rock that had a cool design or a little keychain, she would gift them to whoever it reminded her of.

"Well, that's all. Thanks!" And within that moment, she disappeared into the crowd of students. The bell rang, and the group split without another word, leaving Adora, Bow and Glimmer. The blonde avoided eye contact with them, knowing she was about to be chewed out for hanging out with Catra when she was supposed to be sick.

"Okay , what the hell, Adora?!" Glimmer screeched. *There it was.* "I thought no one was allowed to even step foot in your front yard, let alone *hang out* ?"

Adora turned to look at her and sighed. "No one *was!*" she defended. "I didnt even know Catra was coming over . My *Mom* invited her over!"

This caught the two's attention. With curious eyes, Adora explained. "My Mom apparently had got Adam to text her or something telling her to go check up on me. So she did."

They began walking to their first-period class. "Why would your mom invite *Catra* over?! You guys aren't even best friends!" Glimmer exclaimed in near frustration. Adora sighed and shrugged her shoulders lazily. "I don't *know,* Glimmer. I didn't exactly ask her why my mother invited her over. That would be... mean!"

"Plus, Catra and I *are* friends. I don't really care what you two say about it or what anyone says." Adora said, staring straight ahead.

Bow gave a slight nod, agreeing with the blonde-haired girl. "That's true. But I mean, Glimmer," He turned to her. "Adam and Catra are best friends, *right*?"

What Bow *really* wanted to say was that *Adora* and Catra were best friends. He and Glimmer both knew the real reason why Marlena had invited the girl over and not them, but they had to continue playing the part of the role they were destined for. "So, Marlena probably wanted Catra to do something at the house and checking up on Adora was just an easy win."

Glimmer cocked her head to the side and slowly agreed. She looked up at Adora whose face was stern. Her eyebrows were stitched together and Glimmer could tell she had *slightly* messed up with her

choice of words. "Okay okay . Yes, you guys are friends and that's… fine. I'm sorry Adora. Bow is right."

"As usual." Bow shrugged with a smug smirk. Adora cracked a small smile and wrapped an arm around Glimmer. "It' s okay, Glim.

I know you're just jealous." She said and Glimmer groaned. One thing that Adora was thankful to remember, was the *minuscule* crush that Glimmer had on Adora when they were fifteen. After remembering it, Adora tortured Glimmer with her new information. The much shorter girl thrashed out of Adora's grip and stalked off, throwing a middle finger behind her.

"I am *NOT* jealous!" She shouted as she took a sharp turn into the classroom. Bow and Adora shared a look before laughing loudly and quickly following behind.

"What is this about, exactly?" Catra asked as she was led across the soccer field by the hands of Scorpia, Perfuma and Entrapta. It was weird to be regularly hanging out with the blonde girl, but Catra didnt mind. In fact, in the classes they shared they often partnered up or

went out to the diner to study on an upcoming test. Perfuma has also helped Catra open up a *lot* , seeing as the way she's been more open with Adora and even her best friends. It was a lot to process in the span of one month, Catra never thought she'd be able to get there but she did. It was uncomfortable and jarring, but she was slowly making her way. Spending time with Adora and her family also helped.

"You'll see!" Scorpia shouted, almost in excitement. Catra furrowed her brows, but they were unnoticeable from the blindfold that covered her eyes. "Are you guys killing me?"

She asked, and she felt the group grow confused by the way their steps halted. "Why must you always think negatively , Catra?"

Perfuma asked, and it only drew her more suspicious as she was quickly pulled ahead. "Well, that is definitely not helping your guys' case."

"You're going to love it." Perfuma gleamed. "I hope"…

The crunching of leaves fell below her boots with every step she took as they slowly went deeper into the tree line. The tree line behind the

school was infamous for two things;hooking up and smoking pot. Catra hoped it was the latter, but knew the others most likely wouldnt as it was only lunch. Maybe Perfuma would. No, Perfuma was *definitely* already high.

Finally, after what felt like ten minutes, they stopped. Catra still held onto Entrapta and Scorpia's arms for balance. Not having her sight for that long made her wobbly and feel a bit nauseous. "Okay close your eyes."

Catra laughed. "What?"

"Just close your eyes!" Scorpia whined and Catra obliged, but not without a snarky remark towards the girl. She quickly apologized, not meaning to. That was another thing that she was working on. Being a better friend. Scorpia and Entrapta have always been there for her and never judged. She wasnt that bad of a friend, but she wouldnt be winning any *Friend of the Year* awards any time soon.

"Okay okay." Catra shut her eyes and reassured Scorpia that her eyes were shut after a lot of suspicion from the girl. Perfuma took the bind off, and behind closed eyelids, Catra could see the sun glaring down at her, leaving her vision black with spots of red. "You can open them now!"

Slowly, the brunette peeled her eyes open, having to re-adjust to the sun before her. When her gaze finally focused, she saw what her friends were so eager about. In the middle of the spot, surrounded by trees with a hole in the top, sat a picnic table. There lay a few trays of sushi as well as a large Big Gulp' from 7-11 filled with what she presumed was Root Beer. And how could she forget the banner that was fallen from a tree that vaguely read;

"Happy (early)birthday wildcat!"

"Oh shoot," Scorpia quickly rushed over to the banner, and attempted to put it back in its place. Catra rushed over to her, but not to help, to pull her back down flat on the ground. Scorpia turned to her, eyes filled with sadness as she glanced from the fallen banner to Catra. "Gee, Im really sorry Wildcat.

We tried to get it to stay up but, you know us." Scorpia scratched the back of her neck anxiously. Catra smiled and reached her arms around the much taller girl's neck and dragged her in for a hug. Having to go on her tip-toes just to reach. It was clear that Scorpia was in fact not used to such intimate contact from the girl that she tensed up. Catra sensed this and immediately felt terrible. As she was about to pull away to apologize, Scorpia wrapped her arms around her and pulled her in for a bone-crushing hug.

"Wow, this is interesting. Catra initiated the hu-UG-" Entrapta could barely finish her sentence before being pulled into the hug, squeezing between the two. Catra laughed as she pulled them apart. Perfuma had made her way over to them and Catra gave her a small smile, shoving her hands into her pockets.

"Thank you, uh, Perfuma." She said, looking around the designed spot. Flowers were plucked and placed around the trees and even some rocks that spelt out the number 18, the age she would be turning soon. Perfuma gave her a pop of her shoulders and shook her head, "Don't thank me. Scorpia and Entrapta pulled it all together.

I just placed a few flowers." Catra looked back at her friends who were both trying to make the picnic table perfect. There was even a small blanket folded on the seat for her to sit. Suddenly, Catra couldn't help but let her eyes water . Scorpia and Entrapta had been there for her more times than she could ever count, being the best of friends she could ever ask for and all she had to offer them was rude remarks and distance. She couldn't understand why they had stood by her side. She had been a terrible friend after the accident and even before then. She didn't deserve them. She didn't deserve any of this, but yet, here she was, surrounded by beautiful Autumn trees and her favourite food.

Perfuma seemed to notice her regret-filled face and placed a hand on her shoulder. Catra looked at her and quickly tried to wipe the few fallen tears. "It' s hard to open up to people," She leads. "But from what I can see and from where you started, you've come a long way , Catra." She feels her eyes water more, even letting a few tears willingly slide down her face. She gives Perfuma a hug, which the girl happily returns, rubbing her upper back in a comforting manner. Catra wasn't sure why Perfuma had been so nice to her , after all, she was the one at fault for their team losing one of their best players and captain. She assumed Scorpia had persuaded her into something, or perhaps what Perfuma was saying was coming directly from her heart. Catra wasn't sure, but she was inclined to believe the words the girl spoke.

They pulled away, Catra wiped her tears and they all sat down, talking about whatever came to their minds as they shared the food (*and smoked a little*).

It was with the help of her friends, and the people who stood by her side through it all that Catra was slowly starting to forgive herself for the accident. She could only hope that Adora would too.

Chapter End Notes

birthday chapter next?

End Notes

hey guys!coming from 2023, im editing this entire book since when I first started to write there were a lot of plotholes, grammar mistakes and spelling errors so I will be going over it and fixing these <3

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